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claimed by another

Max Sebastian

hotwife erotica

OBSESSIVE 3

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ONE

A NEW THERAPIST

‘Does it bother you, that I’m a woman?’

‘No. Not at all. I mean, I don’t mind. Is it okay with you?’

‘Of course it’s okay with me. Actually, it’s very common for men to have female therapists.’

‘Oh, it is?’

‘There’s a shortage of male therapists in the industry these days. But the important thing is whether you feel comfortable here.’

Jens nodded, and tried to keep calm, focusing on breathing normally. It wasn’t the fact that his new therapist was a woman that made him feel anxious. It was that he had a new therapist at all. Anyone new was going to make him feel uncomfortable.

‘You come very highly recommended,’ he said, attempting a smile. ‘My wife has been seeing one of your colleagues for a while...’

The new therapist nodded, smiled warmly. ‘Perfect,’ she said, glancing at the notes open in front of her on her large leather-topped desk. Jens could detect her perfume, even from all the way over here, on the green leather couch. Her office was large, a high-ceilinged chamber in one of Copenhagen’s many opulent nineteenth-century apartment buildings. The kind of place that, in any other city center in Europe, could have been

turned into a nice little two-bed abode for young professionals. This room was similarly lined with shelves and books, but it smelled differently—gone was the musty hint of cigars and floor polish. Here, he could smell flowers, and a hint of his therapist's perfume.

Out of the window, he could see across Israel Plads. This place was closer to his office, but he missed the view over the Peblinge Sø. Sometimes it was nice to look out over the water while he talked to his therapist.

'So you've been making an extraordinary amount of progress in recent years, Jens,' the therapist said, still reading her notes.

'Yes.'

Jens found himself blushing furiously. What had his previous therapist written about him? In their sessions, all they seemed to have talked about was how Jens managed to open up to new people when they were dating—and fucking—his wife. That had been progress of a sort, but Jens wasn't sure about how it would be to share such information with this new therapist.

'It's unfortunate what happened in your last session,' she said, as though she thought Jens might feel somehow responsible for causing the cardiac arrest that had seen his previous shrink hospitalized and given a double bypass operation. 'But you know, that's nothing to do with what you were discussing with your therapist.'

'I know,' Jens interrupted her.

'My point is,' she said, 'that you ought to feel that we can pick up exactly where you left off. I don't want you to feel... guarded about the nature of what it is we talk about during our sessions...'

Chanel Cristalle. She was wearing Chanel Cristalle. He'd almost been thrown by the begonias growing in the window box just behind her, but now he was certain it was Cristalle.

His therapist took his hesitation as further evidence that he was too nervous about talking to her.

‘You know it’s not uncommon for a man to want his wife to sleep with other people,’ she said. ‘It’s perhaps a little uncommon for someone with your condition to respond to it the way you have. But if you feel this is something you’d be more comfortable talking to a male therapist...’

Jens felt embarrassed, but then he would have felt embarrassed talking to a man, too. He’d gotten used to talking about all kinds of things with his previous therapist. His new therapist was an attractive woman—fifty-something, long blonde hair, a pleasing face—but the issue he had wasn’t that he wanted to flirt with her. It wasn’t that he needed her maternalistic approval, either. It was that he didn’t want to shock her, or disgust her.

‘Do your other patients talk about their sex lives?’ he asked her.

‘Some of them, sure. If it’s relevant to what they want to talk about, to how they feel about their lives, their issues.’

‘It seemed to help, when I talked about it previously in my therapy.’

‘So talk about it with me. If you would like.’

‘You’re not going to be shocked? Offended?’

She smiled. Shook her head. ‘I’m not going to have a heart attack, if that’s what you’re worried about.’

‘I would hope not.’

‘Whatever you say is completely confidential between the two of us,’ she said. ‘I’m not even allowed to talk about it with your wife, if I ever happened to see her outside waiting to see Dr Leppatz.’

‘Even if a lot of what I talk about *is* my wife?’ Jens grinned.

‘Your wife has been an important part of your progress—she’s the center of your support network. But no, I couldn’t share with her even the details you’ve shared with me about her.’

Jens nodded. There was an odd tension in the air now, as though his new therapist wanted him to test her, to see whether she could, in fact,

handle the kinds of things that were on his mind.

He took a deep breath and said, 'Recently, my wife's had this idea that if I sleep with other people, perhaps it will expand my horizons—you know, help me to get better at coping with the presence of other people generally.'

'And has it helped?'

'I suppose so.'

'But I sense that it's not as simple as that,' his therapist said.

Jens sighed. 'But she doesn't want to date other people. Or at least, other men.'

The therapist gave a little nod and glanced at her notes. 'She's still reacting to what happened when you were with... what was his name...?'

'Viggo. He tried to make her... do something she didn't want to do,' he explained.

'And he lost his temper when she refused?'

He sighed again. He didn't want to get into all that. Just wanted to move on. 'And now Effie's lost her confidence... you know... when it comes to dating other guys.'

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TWO

SIDESHOW

He was sitting on the couch, talking to Effie on FaceTime when the front door opened, and in walked Andrea with another young woman—an Asian woman, Andrea’s age, certainly no more.

‘Hey,’ Andrea said to him, but then saw he was talking on FaceTime.

‘Hey,’ he said back. No big deal these days, Andrea coming into their apartment. They’d even given her the code to the front door.

‘Is that Andrea?’ Effie said on FaceTime, grinning as she looked out from the screen of his laptop. She was away on another one of her business trips. This one was a conference in London, where she was attempting to find out about the impact of Brexit on the markets.

‘Hi, Effie!’ Andrea called out, and Jens tilted the screen so that they could see each other and wave to each other.

‘Are you guys going out on a date tonight?’ Effie asked him, and Jens felt himself blushing, since he wasn’t alone with Andrea just then. He looked up, and Andrea seemed to be fixing a drink for her friend in the kitchen area.

‘I don’t know what’s happening tonight,’ he said, worried that Andrea’s friend would think it odd that a married man was talking with his wife about going on a date with the 25-year-old blonde from upstairs.

‘Who’s that with her?’ Effie asked him.

‘I don’t know,’ he murmured quietly, now feeling embarrassed that they were talking about the newcomer while she was in the room.

‘She’s pretty,’ Effie said casually.

Jens tried to glance over toward the kitchen, without looking as though he was checking anybody out. Like Andrea, she was wearing a pair of shorts and a tank top—her shorts were black, while Andrea’s were white, and her tank top was floral rather than peach-colored. But he couldn’t see her face just now.

‘Is there anyone you like the look of at your conference?’ Jens asked. He could ask. He always did, though it didn’t do much good these days.

‘Not so much,’ she grinned. ‘I just want to get back to you, my darling.’

He smiled. ‘I can’t wait for that, either.’

Could she tell he was disappointed? That the biggest thrill of all wasn’t the thought of sleeping with Andrea, or anyone else Effie would like to suggest—the biggest thrill for him was for his wife to sleep with some other man, and get the biggest orgasm ever. But she’d gone off men recently, other than her husband. She was almost born-again monogamous, except when they fooled around with Andrea, and only then if Effie didn’t feel like simply watching the blonde play with Jens.

‘Will you let me watch you with Andrea tonight?’ Effie asked right out in the open.

‘Shhh!’ Jens said, flashing his eyes at his wife. ‘Are you crazy?’

He laughed, as though Andrea’s friend might think Effie was joking if she’d overheard her.

‘What are you worried about?’ Effie was laughing, too, looking past him toward the kitchen area.

Jens turned again, and now saw Andrea making out with her friend. The two young women looked over at him and laughed, and now both of them peeled off their tops to reveal that neither of them was wearing a bra.

‘Uh... hi,’ he said, aroused at the sight of these beautiful women—and yet at the same time nervous.

‘This is Clara,’ Andrea said casually, as if none of this was a big deal. ‘I told her all about you, Jens. And you, Effie.’

‘Hi, Clara!’ Effie called out from the computer, which Jens had to put down on the coffee table in front of them because the bulge in his pants made it impossible to balance it on his lap any longer.

‘Hi, Effie!’ the newcomer said back.

Giggling, Andrea knelt down in front of Jens and reached for his belt buckle. Clara perched herself on the arm of the couch immediately next to Jens. He could smell her floral scent—Chanel No.5, just about the easiest perfume to identify, with its infamous blend of rose, lily, jasmine and so on. It worked well on her. He looked up at her, and she gave him the kind of smirk that made him realize he’d been staring at her breasts while sampling her fragrance. Well, what did it matter if she thought he was ogling her chest? It was right in front of his face, her small nipples stiff as pencil erasers.

Then she was laughing at Andrea, who dragged down his pants and his underwear to allow his hard cock to spring free.

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THREE

A SUGGESTION

‘**W**ait, so you had sex with two women—and your wife was watching you through your laptop?’

‘Uh-huh.’

‘And how is it that you’re not completely ecstatic about that right now?’

Jens sighed. He had to think for a while to find the right words for how he was feeling.

‘When you’ve watched your wife—your true love—receiving the most incredible sexual pleasure at the hands of a man who really knows what he’s doing... anything else is just... I don’t know... flat.’

The therapist looked at him all wide-eyed, and now scribbled something on his chart.

‘Flat. You’re saying it was *boring*, having sex with two younger women at once...?’

‘Not boring...’ another sigh. ‘I mean... it was nice. Sexy, even. I like Andrea, she’s a lot of fun, and her friend Clara... she was quite something, too...’

‘I’m sensing a "but" heading our way.’

‘But,’ Jens nodded, but then had to pause to think of what he was trying to say. ‘I don’t know... it’s like masturbating to a copy of *Vogue*—compared to the first time you have sex, or the best time you had sex. It feels nice...

and the woman you're looking at, while you're doing it, looks really hot... but at the end of the day it just feels a little... flat.'

'Have you ever considered the possibility that you have a sexual addiction?' the therapist asked him.

Jens laughed.

'No, hear me out: when you're addicted to something, often you crave more and more, and the more you have, the more intense the stimulus you need in order to generate the same pleasure you experienced in the first place.'

'I don't think it's quite like that.'

'So if you get addicted to cocaine, after a while you have to do more and more coke, and you have to have the drug stronger and stronger, maybe you get to the stage where you need to move on to a more dangerous drug to get the same kind of hit you originally did...'

'I don't think it's an addiction,' Jens said. 'I mean, it's not something I would find difficult to stop... if Effie never wanted to do it again, well, you know...'

'Addicts often believe they can just stop their addictive behavior...'

Jens shook his head. 'No, it's not like that. I just think it's a shame... we were both having so much fun before Viggo did what he did... it totally ruined her confidence. I just wish she could enjoy sex the way she did—'

'She enjoys sex with you.'

'Well, yes, but—'

'And she apparently enjoys it when you're having sex with other people.'

'She *says* she does, but...'

'It sounds to me as though she has a *perfectly* healthy sex life.' The therapist smiled, but somehow it irritated the bejesus out of Jens. Was he not explaining himself properly?

She said, 'You know, it's perfectly natural to want your partner to share your top sexual fantasy, but it's also perfectly common that she won't. That she'll have different drives than you, different fantasies.'

'Well, yes, but—'

'If it's not her thing, there's usually no point in trying to force her to feel the same way about your fantasy—'

'Hey,' Jens said, feeling a touch of anger rising. 'I would not force my wife to do *anything*. She does what she wants to do.'

'Okay, I'm sorry, I wasn't trying to infer—'

'It's just that when we used to... when she used to date other people. Other guys. It was a lot of fun for both of us. And now... I just think it's a shame she doesn't want to do that anymore.'

The therapist nodded. She appeared contrite, perhaps even mildly concerned that she'd stepped over the line with him. And Jens was the kind of patient who could so easily leave and never come back.

She cleared her throat and spoke quietly: 'You said, earlier, that you thought her confidence was ruined. Is that the case, even when she's with you and... Andrea, is that the name of your neighbor?'

'Andrea, yes,' Jens nodded. 'No, she seems perfectly fine when she's with me, and when we're with Andrea. It's just other men, she no longer...'

'She's afraid that things might turn out like the way they did with Viggo?'

Jens nodded.

The therapist said, 'Have you talked to your wife about this? Does she also wish she could feel more confident about seeing other men?'

'I think she does. I mean, the way she looks when we're with Andrea... it seems like something significant is missing—for her, too.'

'Has she talked with her therapist about this?'

'I... I don't know. We don't really... discuss our therapy.'

The therapist smiled, and paused to think. Then she said, 'Have you ever thought about, perhaps trying to take a step back? To try to help her build her confidence again, with other men?'

'A step back?'

'You know... suggesting, maybe, that she try spending time with a man she already knows, perhaps someone she was with *before* her date with Viggo.'

'Oh.'

'Is there someone, maybe someone she trusts? Someone she knows well enough to know that he would never, he *could* never treat her badly like that. Someone she wouldn't be afraid of being with, in the same way she's not afraid to be with you.'

Jens frowned, and scratched his head. 'Well... there was Nico. But he's not in Copenhagen anymore, and he never knew that I knew that they were seeing each other...'

'He didn't know?'

'He thought he was having a genuine affair with Effie. But then... there's no other man that she's dated that she knows *really well*...' Jens was thinking about Felix, about the fact that Felix didn't seem like the type who could ever get aggressive or forceful... but then Felix had a girlfriend these days, anyway.

'We really weren't doing the sharing thing for all that long,' Jens said.

The therapist said, 'What about someone she dated before you?'

'Before me.'

'An ex-boyfriend.' The therapist smiled. 'I can't believe I'm asking you whether you think there might be an ex-boyfriend out there for your wife to seduce. Really, perhaps the two of you need some couples' therapy...'

But Jens wasn't thinking about couples' therapy. He was wondering whether there was anyone Effie had dated before her nasty experience in college. Someone she might want to date again.

FOUR

A STEP BACK

She was livid, the first time Jens mentioned it. He was a little surprised at her reaction.

‘You talk to your therapist about... *our sex life*?’

Ever since that first session with his new therapist, he’d been agonizing about how to make the suggestion that she try hooking up with an ex. In Effie’s case, the past was fairly sensitive, anyway, so he couldn’t just attempt to delve. Asking her about past boyfriends would be like having a party in a dynamite storage depot. But the idea of her seeing a guy she’d dated before, someone she trusted not to mistreat her, did appeal to him immensely.

Eventually, though, the idea had drilled down so deep into his psyche that he just decided to come straight out and tell her that his therapist had suggested she date someone she’d been with before.

The surprising thing, perhaps, was that she seemed so violated that he talked to his shrink about their sex life.

‘Of course—don’t you talk to yours about it?’ he said, wondering what Effie talked about in therapy if she didn’t talk about that.

‘No, not really.’

‘Oh.’

That was the extent of their ‘argument’ about it. They didn’t like to argue, on the whole. Jens had read plenty in the media, and even talked to past therapists about the theory that arguments are perfectly healthy for relationships—but he and Effie just didn’t, generally. It felt all wrong, and whenever an extended disagreement broke out, it usually just fizzled. They’d always been a shelter for each other from conflict, from friction, from danger. They didn’t like to cause it themselves.

On this occasion, things fizzled quickly. And then, just as he was coming back from his next therapy session, Effie dropped a little reference that brought it all back again:

‘So you talked about our sex life again?’

‘A little.’

‘And does your new therapist approve?’

‘I don’t think she’s supposed to approve or disapprove of anything, right?’

‘Your new therapist is a woman?’

He scratched his head and asked her if that was a problem, and once again their argument fizzled into a silent tension between them that eventually, through the evening, dissipated. By this point it had been a couple of weeks since Andrea had been around, but even so, Jens was confused why Effie had been so interested in having him sleep with another woman—or even other women, plural—and yet she was upset that his new therapist was female.

No sex that night. Or the night after. A week went by, two weeks, and it seemed to Jens a little noticeable that Effie was uninterested in sex ever since that revelation about the gender of his therapist. The old Jens had been asexual. It came as another surprise, now, that the new Jens could not cope with abstinence for two weeks. He didn’t want to confront Effie about it, since the whole thing seemed rather embarrassing to him, and he didn’t

want to come across as needy, or like he would ever pressure her for sex. Masturbation in the shower would suffice to begin with.

After a while, though, he'd come to the point that he was going to go back to therapy and ask to change to a male therapist, even though it made him shudder to think about having to break in yet another new therapist.

Before he could think about a new therapist, however, Jens was given some terrifying news at work.

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FIVE

WORK TROUBLES

‘G ivenchy wants to buy Laursen’s.’

Jens had been summoned to the office of the company’s Chairman and CEO out of the blue, and for the duration of his journey up to the top of the building, Jens had spent his time wondering what he might have done wrong in recent weeks, what might have caused him to be fired unexpectedly.

But there was to be no firing. As the professional ‘nose’ of Laursen’s, Jens had created two of the company’s most successful fragrances—*Captivating*, and *Infidelity*. And now, Old Man Laursen told him, completely unexpectedly, that he wanted Jens to be his ‘nose’ regarding an offer to buy the firm.

‘I’m not selling, of course,’ said the company owner, instantly making Jens wonder why the old man had dragged him all the way up here to tell him about Givenchy’s offer.

‘No, sir,’ Jens said, trying to infer that he had every confidence in his boss, whatever he was up to. ‘Of course.’

‘We can be proud of where we’ve got to,’ the old man said. ‘I’m not going to wipe out my family’s good name in this industry for a few billion kroner.’

‘No sir.’

‘But I am interested to know how much they would offer us for the company,’ the old man said, surprising Jens again.

Jens did a poor job of hiding his confusion. The old man chuckled loudly.

‘We won’t sell the whole company to one of our rivals,’ he explained. ‘But that doesn’t mean we can’t think about a flotation. Fresh investment, right? Family keeps a controlling stake, but let the kind people from the Fondsbørs fund our expansion.’

Jens nodded. He felt as though he was a bit of a lemon, standing there twiddling his thumbs behind his back, really not knowing what to say. Business affairs were completely out of his comfort zone, completely beyond his job description.

But Old Man Laursen sensed that he was losing his employee’s understanding here. He said, ‘Well, here’s the thing: if we entertain Givenchy’s offer, we can gently test the waters for how much investment we might be able to raise in a public flotation. But also, we might just get a little teaser for what life might be like for us to join Givenchy.’

Jens said, ‘Excuse me?’

The old man grinned. ‘We’ve been invited to Paris, my friend. They’re willing to give us the full tour, to let us see exactly how things would be if Laursen’s became a part of the Givenchy empire. Or rather, the Moët Hennessy Louis Vuitton empire, I should say, since that’s who ultimately owns Givenchy.’

A tour. That interested Jens. And it also frightened him.

‘I’ll send William, of course, to represent the firm,’ the old man said, referring to his son, the man who would doubtless take over the company when the old man retired or, in the huge likelihood that he would die before accepting retirement. ‘But I want you there, too, Jens. I want you to tour the Givenchy facilities and absorb as much detail as you possibly can. How they work, how they operate—but from a fragrance point of view, a creative

point of view. William can observe how they work from a business perspective.'

Effie had been so impressed when he'd told her about being sent to Paris on behalf of the company. It had considerably thawed her attitude toward him after their little bust-up over his therapy sessions. But despite how long she'd known him, and his condition, it had surprised her, as the trip drew nearer and nearer, just how clearly terrified Jens was about the prospect of going to Paris.

'But you've been to France before,' she said one evening, a few days before wheels-up. 'You studied at Grasse, for heaven's sake.'

He nodded, 'And Milan, and London.'

Effie sighed. 'Before...'

He nodded again. A low, throbbing pain pulsed deep inside his chest. They didn't talk about what had happened to his parents, in the same way that they didn't really talk about what had happened to Effie at college. These were the centers of their personal pain, which had turned them into the people they were, like it or not. But they each knew of the other's pain, and it helped them support each other.

'You'll be okay,' Effie said, kneeling on the sofa beside him to massage his shoulders gently.

He tried to keep calm and focus on breathing. Drawing in a long breath, slowly, and then letting it out again. Enjoying the lingering remains of the scent Effie was wearing—*Captivating*.

'Do you want me to come with you to Paris?' she asked him. 'I'm not sure if I'll be able to take time off this late notice—'

'No, it'll be alright,' he insisted, not wanting to cause his wife trouble.

'You can call me every night,' she smiled. 'Whenever you want.'

'Of course.'

She leaned over to kiss him just below the ear. 'I'll help provide you some distraction from everything.'

‘Distraction? Like what?’

Effie giggled, stepped in front of him and peeled off her tank top, revealing that she wasn’t wearing a bra underneath. ‘I’m sure I could think of something,’ she said, and down came her leggings, followed shortly by her little blue panties.

Jens tried to focus on the silver lining to the cloud that was his Tour de France—it re-started his sex life with Effie with a bang.

At the same time, he still had to deal with his genuine fear of strangers and strange people, as he caught the 12.10 Air France flight from Kastrup—his fears intensifying as he landed at Charles de Gaulle, where he and William Laursen were met by a limousine for an extended meet and greet with the bigwigs at Givenchy. There were dinners in the finest restaurants in Paris, presentations from company executives, and tours of company facilities, and for Jens it was completely eye-opening. The food, the wine, the compliments from senior people at Givenchy regarding the new Laursen perfumes. By the second day, Jens was almost sick of the taste of luxury Champagne.

‘You know, I gave my wife a bottle of your *Infidelity* fragrance,’ one Givenchy board member divulged to Jens at one point. ‘I took her to the opera, and I swear every man in the place was turning to look. She was *delighted*.’

But through it all, Jens had to try to absorb some of the insights he received into Givenchy, while hiding the fact that he was completely terrified almost every second he was in France. All the new people he was meeting, the unfamiliar places he was taken to—at every moment, he was accompanied by dark thoughts that taunted him about the germs he was picking up, the diseases he would catch, the complete lack of trust he had in the hygiene of anyone around him.

Each evening, he returned to his five-star hotel with its views of the Jardin des Tuilleries, the River Seine and the Eiffel Tower, and felt so

exhausted from the effort of maintaining a ‘normal’ façade in engaging with the people from Givenchy that he just about collapsed.

When he called Effie each night on FaceTime, he was just about in tears.

‘I’m so proud of you,’ she would say, doing her best to boost his morale, despite feeling somewhat powerless since he was so far away from her. Of course, it made him feel better to talk to her. But she could do nothing about the fact that at nine o’clock each morning, he would have to get up, eat breakfast and leave the shelter that was his own private hotel suite, and once again venture out into strange places to meet strange people and expound an enormous amount of energy concealing his horror at shaking hands, at sitting on chairs that might not have been cleaned properly, of eating food without knowing the hygiene standards of its preparation space—and all the time, filling his nostrils with the stench of unknown people and places.

When he called her, she would invariably be wearing something vaguely sexy—underwear, or something so thin it was virtually transparent. She would get up from the computer screen to go get a drink or something, and purposefully give him a bit of a show—and yet, he was so upset, he just wasn’t in the mood to get into anything vaguely erotic with her.

‘Do you think I could call in sick?’ he’d said on the second night, and it reminded him of how he’d generally avoided Effie’s family over the years. Calling in sick. Pretty stupid, really.

‘You’ll be home, day after next,’ Effie reminded him.

It seemed like an age away.

Just before signing off, for a brief moment her expression slipped, and he saw how worried she was for him. It made him feel terrible that she might be stressed by how difficult he was finding this trip. The next day he did his utmost to buck up and try not to think about the hygiene issue, try to

suppress the dark thoughts that made him want to rush to a bathroom every minute of the day and wash his hands over and over and over again.

Then, the next evening, Effie completely surprised him.

Sitting on a plush chair gazing at his laptop computer, he pressed the green phone symbol below the FaceTime logo to accept Effie's incoming call, and was presented with the image of his wife wearing a sexy, smart outfit and full-on makeup.

'You look good,' he said, surprised, since it was hardly business attire that she might have come home from work wearing.

With tight black jeans, she wore a thin white top that clung so close to her skin that it almost looked as though someone had simply painted her body. It gave no doubt about the shape of her breasts and apparent lack of a bra. Jens felt himself stiffen up, just seeing her wearing it.

'Been somewhere special today?' he joked.

She said, 'I'm going out tonight, actually. On a date with a guy I used to know back in high school.'

He was hard so fast, it was like magic.

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DATE NIGHT

Jens was instantly aroused, sitting there gazing at his wife—seeing her with fresh eyes, now that he knew why she was all dressed up so nicely. He'd thought she'd looked good before, but now he knew she was dressed that way because she had a date, everything about her appearance took on new meaning.

She looked so sexy. Not full-on glamor sexy—or ballroom dancing sexy—but first date sexy, revealing-disguised-as-casual sexy. She was trying to impress another guy. She wanted to draw his eyes all over her body with that figure-hugging top and her tight jeans. She wanted him to gaze at her breasts all night, since that top left almost nothing to the imagination.

She wanted her date to desire her.

'Who is he?' he asked her.

'He's called Emil,' she said, fixing little diamond stud earrings to her earlobes. 'I've known him forever, but I guess I haven't really talked to him since college. I'm sorry—I can tell you all about him when I get back from my date, but right now I'm a little short of time.'

Her use of the word 'date' made his erection throb. She was using it purposefully, to confirm what she was up to tonight.

'So is he... an ex? Did you date him in high school?' Jens stopped himself. He didn't want it to seem as though he was trying to get her to

connect the dots—to confirm that she was following the suggestion of his therapist that she might be most comfortable dating an ex, if she were to get back into dating other men. Jens didn't like to feel as though he was pushing her to fulfill his own private fantasy. This had to be first and foremost about what Effie wanted.

She sighed, and glanced off to the side as though deciding whether to tell the truth or drop in a little white lie. 'I guess... we dated, yeah.'

He saw that she was blushing now—it was never startlingly obvious with her skin tone, but it was very becoming on her.

'Okay. So you liked him?'

She smiled. 'He lived next door. We were... friends, growing up. You know, scampering about building treehouses and stuff. Board games in the rain.'

'Oh, that was it?'

She smiled bashfully, took a deep breath, and admitted, 'I guess when we were in high school... we fooled around a little. Or... a lot.'

Jens felt the warmth of encouragement filling his chest. Was this guy her *first real boyfriend*? There was something really sweet about that. But also something kind of dangerous. What if they loved each other? What if they fell back in love?

'You slept with him?'

She glanced off to the side again, and then reached for something—a sparkly necklace that she now started to put in place around her neck. 'Uh, yeah... you might say that. Although I'm not sure there was much actual *sleeping*.'

'Did you lose your cherry to him?' Jens asked, and his heart gave a little skip.

'Uh-huh.'

She seemed so awkward, fiddling with the necklace, not quite happy with how it was sitting on her chest. Jens noticed how the little diamond

pendant sparkled, and basically drew the eye down to check out her cleavage.

‘You’ve never mentioned him before.’

‘Have you ever told me who took your virginity?’ she fired back at him, then before he could open his mouth again, she said, ‘No, I don’t want to know.’

Strange, that she didn’t want to talk about it, even though these days she was happy for Andrea to come downstairs on occasion to sleep with him.

‘I just... I don’t know. He wasn’t really a boyfriend.’

Jens was a little confused. The way she was talking things down, though this had obviously been someone special to her in the past. Was she worried about falling back in love with this guy, Emil? Or that she would upset Jens by talking about their past?

‘What happened with him?’ he asked, not really knowing what to ask her.

‘It ended,’ she said, standing up, now, making it seem like she needed to get going. ‘You know how it was—we were both young, it wasn’t like we were going to spend the rest of our lives together.’

‘Did you end it, or did he?’ he said.

She smiled, shrugged as though to say it didn’t matter anymore. ‘We didn’t really... hang out at school,’ she said. ‘Only when we were home. And then at school I saw him hanging around with another girl... and then at a party, I saw him... well, making out with her...’

Jens nodded. ‘You guys were young.’

She shrugged again. ‘I’m not even sure we were boyfriend-and-girlfriend, you know? I had a huge crush on him... we fooled around one summer at the end of high school. Then he went out with Anna Ølgaard, and who was I? I was just his next-door neighbor.’

‘You going to be okay seeing him again?’ he asked her.

She nodded. 'Water under the bridge, isn't that the saying? None of it matters anymore. It'll be nice to see him again.'

'You think you'd want to... you'd want to *date* him?' Jens asked, feeling as though he was prying again. Funny that it was his wife, talking about dating another man, and he was worried about infringing on her privacy.

'Isn't that what this is about? Finding out...' She smiled, fiddling with her top as though she needed to check how it was fitting in the mirror, though it was molded perfectly to her body. Her nipples were faintly visible pushing against the material.

Jens nodded, trying to appear calm. 'Is he... single? These days?'

'Divorced,' Effie said, slipping on a faux fur-lined jacket, looking very much as though she needed to rush. 'After the divorce, he joined Facebook for the first time, and... well, he friended me. We've chatted a little..'

She was nervous, quite obviously so. He loved it when she was nervous about a date, it made it seem so much more intense. And that nervous excitement was so becoming on her.

'Okay, well, fingers crossed,' Jens grinned, his tone indicating that he knew she had to be away now. 'You look gorgeous, honey.'

'I love you, sweetie,' she said.

'Good luck! Let me know how it goes!'

'Of course.'

She leaned down to blow him a kiss, and gave him a beautiful view of her cleavage as she did so, and then the FaceTime window went blank, leaving Jens on his own, shivering with anticipation.

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SEVEN
PACING

Jens was pacing around his hotel suite.
Nervous, nervous, nervous.
God. It wasn't as though Effie hadn't had dates before. It wasn't as though he hadn't gone through this again and again. But this time was different.

This time, Effie was seeing a man she'd known for years. A man she'd had a huge crush on, growing up. A man who had been her first sexual experience. Oh, he trusted his wife, but what if there were some remaining feelings of love between them that neither she, nor Emil, realized were still there?

His whole body was quivering, constantly. It felt as though someone had wired a car battery to his neck, his stomach, his loins, and there was no off switch. The tension was like watching your team in the most important game of the year, *of the decade*. Like watching Denmark play Brazil in the quarterfinals of the World Cup in 1998. The legend that was Brian Laudrup equalized in the 50th minute, and the possibility of winning was so tantalizingly close. That game, though, had not gone Denmark's way. Could Effie ever find herself tempted to crush his feelings, too?

Well, he told himself, at least it had taken his mind off the visit to Givenchy.

Room service. Now he was looking for a distraction from his distraction. Room service served with a glass of Akvavit. He wasn't a drinker, of course. But this evening required something beyond the norm. The alcohol did calm his nerves slightly. Not enough for him to focus on the television, even with some fairly good Hollywood movies available on demand.

Another check of his email, and a message came in about some friend of a friend of a friend he hardly knew posting a photo on Facebook. But it reminded Jens that Effie had reconnected with Emil over the social media site. And of course, he knew Effie's password—the two of them had no secrets.

He was curious, of course. But he started wondering whether he would be prying, by looking at what the two of them said to each other before this date. Surely it was implicit in their arrangement that he should be able to know everything about Effie's entanglements? And she knew that he knew her Facebook password.

Maybe everything was perfectly innocent, perfectly clean. Jens figured he still might find something out about Emil that he didn't already know, and how he felt about Effie.

He logged into Effie's Facebook account.

Emil Lund—here he was, Effie's newest friend. Jens clicked through to the guy's profile. Big, black and from the photos, very good-looking. Did he intimidate Jens? Of course. But at the same time, Jens could see what Effie saw in him. The guy's broad, bright smile. Even from a social media profile, Jens could tell the guy was friendly, popular. There seemed a lot of comments on his timeline from friends and relatives, perhaps giving him support after his divorce.

Jens clicked on Effie's message button, which drew up a list of her messaging conversations. At the top was her conversation with Emil. When he clicked on it, a small window opened up containing the conversation at

the bottom of the screen, with each message displayed in a little speech bubble—blue for Effie’s messages, and light gray for Emil’s, displayed beside a tiny avatar that Jens recognized from his Facebook profile. The latest messages were displayed:

Emil: See you there, 8pm okay?

Effie: Great. Can’t wait xx

Even just seeing the little kisses his wife had typed at the end of her last message re-energized the tension within Jens—but also thickened his cock once again. He knew it was just something people typed at the end of messages to friends, it didn’t necessarily mean anything. He clicked on the scrollbar to glance at earlier messages, and pulled the conversation down a fair way. The two of them seemed to have been chatting quite a lot on Facebook...

Effie: did we really do that outside Benji’s party? I remember lots of times in your car...

Emil: I remember the windows steaming up so we could hardly even see the light from the streetlamp outside, and you were constantly worried the police would catch us, and we’d never have any warning

Effie: Well now you have me steaming up again. No fair when I’m at work and you have a day off.

Emil: Love it. It’s so easy to get you wet :-P

Effie: Don’t you dare send me another one of those pictures. My boss can see my screen right now.

Emil: I won’t. But maybe I’ll tell you how hard you have me right now thinking about you getting all wet for me :-P

Jens kept feeling little implosions detonating inside his stomach. The two of them had been talking like this together? This was intimate. This was sex. Effie hadn’t said anything about the two of them talking about sex together on Facebook. She’d said they’d been chatting on Facebook, but she

hadn't said about what. She hadn't exactly lied, but why had she kept this to herself?

Jens felt his nerves jangling. She wasn't really *cheating*, he told himself. He wanted Effie to talk to other men, to talk to men she'd dated before, if that was how to take her fear out of the equation. He had been happy for her to go on a date with Emil this evening.

Maybe she had her reasons for not opening up more, during their FaceTime call, about what she'd been talking about with Emil. She'd been in a rush. It was still early days, she wasn't sure if things would work out when the two of them reconnected in person. *She didn't want to get his hopes up.*

But she'd known he knew her Facebook password. She'd expressly told him that she'd been chatting to Emil on Facebook. She had to have known he would get curious and try to find what the two of them had talked about.

The deal was that she could do anything she liked with other men, she only had to include Jens in the relationship as an observer. She had to tell him, before or after the fact, what was going on. Here, she was telling him. She had led him to her Facebook account.

And here he was looking at her trading sexy images with her first boyfriend, her first love. Jens scrolled up to find that Emil had sent her an image of his crotch—he wasn't naked, but he was wearing underwear so tight that you could see almost everything, a complete outline of a very large cock, which was at least semi-erect.

Effie commenting on the image immediately below it:

Effie: God. So gorgeous. Were you really that big when we were in high school?

Emil: Don't think it's grown since, so yeah. :D

Effie: I remember how good it felt inside me :-)

Emil: I bet you never stopped remembering :-D

Effie: God. Okay, no more. I have to get back to my desk before they start noticing how long I've been in the bathroom.

A little higher up in their conversation, Jens found that Effie had sent a selfie to Emil showing herself pictured from the waist up, her white shirt unbuttoned to reveal a white lacy bra, which contrasted prettily with her golden skin. She was smiling sweetly, with a hint of flirtation. The image suggested, as her conversation had later, that she was locked in a bathroom cubicle.

Emil: Damn, you look good. You must be such a distraction for the guys in your office.

Effie: I don't usually let them see my bra ;-)

Emil: Usually?

Effie: Well, there was one guy a while ago...

Emil: A while ago? While you were married?

Effie: Maybe ;-)

Jens felt his heart skip another beat. He was going to have to stop looking at this Facebook conversation soon, or he'd end up with some kind of seizure. So, Emil knew Effie had cheated on her husband before. Were they being open about the fact that Jens let her see other men? Jens skimmed through the rest of the conversation, which got cleaner and less forward the further back it went, naturally. There was no mention by Effie that she was in any kind of unconventional marriage, or that her husband was happy for her to reconnect with Emil.

The very start of the conversation had come not too long before, even though the two of them had chatted a lot since. Looking at the date, it had been the second day of Jens's trip to Paris, after the first time he'd called Effie and been so miserable about being there, so far from home, having to deal with all these strangers and strange places.

She had friended Emil, and Emil had almost instantly replied to question why it had taken her so long to accept his friendship request.

Effie: You're divorced now? What happened?

Emil: Oh, so you only friended me after you discovered I'm now single again? But your profile says you're married...

Effie: Yeah, I'm married. But I'm at work, and I'm bored.

Emil: We can't have that... so how have you been?

Effie: Good. You seem to have done well for yourself since I last heard. You made partner?

Emil: It's not the biggest firm, but yeah, I feel like I'm doing fairly well.

Effie: You have kids? There's nothing on your profile...

Emil: No, Ida never wanted kids, I guess I was okay going along with that.

Jens read the whole conversation, before returning to dwell on certain parts. After the initial introductions, with the basic information about their lives updated between them, came Emil asking Effie if she was happy in her marriage—her reply, thankfully, was that she was very happy—and then Effie gently asking what had gone wrong in Emil's own marriage.

Emil: I guess there was just nothing good about it anymore. There wasn't any passion left, we didn't seem to particularly enjoy doing anything together anymore, even spending time together. We just sat in the same room in between coming home from work and going back out again to work.

Effie: That's awful.

Emil: We were like roommates. And it wasn't as though we were staying together because of the kids.

Effie: Were you still having sex?

Emil: I had a feeling you'd want to know that ;-)

Effie: Is that too personal?

Emil: Can anything be too personal for you and me? After what we used to do together?

Effie: Well we haven't seen each other for a while :-) And I'm a married woman...

Emil: And while you've been a married woman, have you never thought about what we used to get up to? :-D

Effie: Oh, I sometimes think about it, sure. Like now, when hubby's away.

Emil: Where did he go?

Effie: He's in Paris for a few days, on business.

God, the two of them must have been chatting almost non-stop. There were often minutes, sometimes an hour or two between their comments in this conversation, but even so, Effie couldn't have gotten much work done at all—neither of them could have. Jens took a strange liking to Emil—he seemed like a nice, friendly guy, and Effie clearly trusted him. The flirty tone of their to-and-fro was mildly thrilling, and then fiercely exciting when they reminisced about the end of high school, when they must have spent most of a summer exploring their burgeoning sexuality.

Emil: You were always so horny after football.

Effie: Because I knew I was going to see you again :-)

Emil: No, because pretty much every day you knew you were going to see me again.

Effie: I scored a lot of goals, I always had a lot of adrenaline flowing through my body.

Emil: And that made you horny?

Effie: And I knew how much you liked peeling off my football strip.

Emil: You did look good in that football strip :-P

And then here was Effie sending him photos of herself, her shirt open to expose her bra. Telling him she remembered when they used to take naked pictures of each other with Emil's digital camera—it must have been one of the early ones, before people started getting cameras within their cellphones. Both of them regretting the fact that all those pictures had long

since been deleted. Emil cheekily asking her for an all-new sexy picture to help him get through the night, now he was divorced and on his own. Effie demanding something from him in return, to help her through the night considering the fact that her husband was abroad.

It was, kind of, cheating. In a way. For any conventional marriage, a husband would have viewed it that way—not just his wife texting an old boyfriend behind his back, but sending him a vaguely sexual photo of herself, and receiving one in return. Not nudes, but certainly sexual nevertheless. With the strong suggestion alongside that they would both satisfy themselves sexually while looking at those pictures.

It terrified Jens, while also thickening up his manhood all the way. He trembled, though he wasn't cold, and yet at the same time he sat on the end of the bed stroking his hardness, gazing at the photo Effie had sent her first love.

She was excited to reconnect with Emil. She was, quite clearly, aroused to talk intimately with him. For Jens, that was the core of his own elation. His wife's pleasure was his own. He just had to tell himself how much he trusted her, that she had to know what she was doing. She had started this to provide some kind of distraction for her husband, she had shown him via FaceTime that she was going out on a date with this man. It was all on the level.

The part he came back to, again and again, was the confirmation that they wanted to see each other again.

Emil: Can I see you again in real life?

Effie: I'd like that.

Emil: Would it be outrageous to ask if you might be available this evening?

Effie: Is that because you know my husband's out of town one more night? ;-)

Emil: Call it a happy coincidence ;-)

Effie: I like it when you're happy :-)

Emil: Me too. Dinner?

Effie: That would be nice. I don't think you ever took me to dinner :-)

Emil: I was grounded most of that year :D Kokkeriet?

Effie: Oh, they have good coffee.

Emil: And some good wine, usually.

Effie: But I'm not sure if I want you to get me drunk just yet ;-)

Emil: I thought you said your husband was only away for one more night?

Effie: Naughty boy :-P

He came, he couldn't help himself. And after he'd cleaned up the floor, and had taken a shower, he felt the fear more than the excitement. What if she did still love him? *She* hadn't been the one to leave him, *he* had moved on to another girl. What if she'd seen him as The One, and now those feelings might be rekindled, and she might feel as though she loved him so much she couldn't do without him from now on?

He ordered a slice of pie and another glass of Akvavit, and the only thing on TV he could keep his attention on was CNN. After a while, somehow he managed to get to sleep.

In the morning, he woke up terrified that he had missed a call or a text from Effie, and that she might think he was ignoring her, or upset for some reason, having changed his mind about her going out on a date with her ex-boyfriend.

He had missed a text, but it didn't seem that Effie was annoyed that he wasn't responding to her following her date. After telling him she hoped he was asleep, and before she said that she couldn't wait to see him the next day, she said something that chilled him to the bone:

Effie: Hey honey! Hope you're asleep by now! I had a great time with Emil. I'm sorry I didn't get to update you during the evening, it was pretty full-on. Anyway, I'm not sure how to say this... but... well, we really need to talk. Tomorrow? I can't wait to see you when you get back xxx

His heart rate picked up, but not in a good way. Those words felt like Kryptonite felt for Superman. *We really need to talk.*

That was how relationships ended, wasn't it?

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THE ARRANGEMENT

He took an earlier flight home the next afternoon, after telling his hosts that he wasn't feeling very well—*that* old chestnut—which wasn't entirely a lie, since he did feel excruciatingly nervous about what Effie had said following her date with Emil.

On the way to the airport, and on the flight back to Denmark, he kept glancing at that text she had sent him, and kept attempting to analyze it and interpret it afresh. He kept looking at the phrase 'I can't wait to see you when you get back' as some kind of testament to the fact that his wife still wanted him, that there was nothing amiss with their marriage after her brush with an old flame. And yet he kept running his eyes over those previous words, '*we really need to talk*'. That was too serious, too dreadful. And the fact that she had said her date with Emil had been so 'full-on'. What could have happened? He declared his love, and she had echoed it back at him?

He tried to dismiss his fears as paranoia, but then there was also the fact that she hadn't said she loved him at the end of her text, as she might ordinarily be expected to do. Was that also a paranoid thought? Maybe she didn't love him anymore.

He tried to act normally. He texted her that he was sorry he hadn't managed to text her back after the previous night, that his final morning in

Paris had been intense. He let her know he was headed for an earlier flight than originally planned.

Landing in Copenhagen mid-afternoon, he was too early for Effie to pick him up after work—but that was one reason why he'd taken an earlier flight. If they were going to talk about things, seriously, including the possibility that she might want Emil over him, then Jens didn't want to do it in the car on the way back from the airport.

The apartment was quiet and still when he returned. It was spotlessly tidy, as ever. Effie knew how he felt about mess.

Stepping inside, closing the door behind him, he felt a curious shiver run through his body. Had she brought him back here last night? There were no obvious signs—nothing obvious, like a pair of wine glasses left out on the kitchen counter, or even clean in the dishwasher. Had she even slept here last night? The bed was perfectly made, but that was no proof it hadn't been slept in. He put his nose to the sheets on her side of the bed—it smelled gloriously of her, and made him suspect she had spent the night. There was no hint of anyone else sharing the bed with her.

He went to the laundry closet. In the basket he found her clothes—the ones he'd seen her wearing as she'd prepared for her date. Thin, soft white top and black jeans, bearing the faint smells of a night out along with traces of her perfume. *Infidelity*. Beneath her jeans lay a pair of fancy white lace panties. Thongs, actually. *Date panties*. Wow. It just seemed unbearably hot that she had worn sexy underwear for her night out with Emil. No bra. Her first date outfit had been relatively understated: attractive, but not too showy. But these panties bore an unmistakable message: just in case we get that far, I want to be able to impress him.

He touched her panties to his nose. Her scent was strong—but it was the scent of her arousal, he thought, rather than the scent of sex. If she'd had sex with him, it hadn't been while she'd been wearing clothes. And she hadn't put her clothes back on afterward.

He was so hard. It was quite exciting, trying to figure things out. She'd tell him when she saw him what had actually happened with Emil, no doubt. But right now the anticipation turned him on almost as much as anything. Did she? Didn't she? And if not, when?

But now was not the time to get overexcited. He dropped the clothes back in the laundry and took a shower. He did his best to relax, and connect with the logic that said Effie was not going to choose Emil over her husband. After the shower, he dressed in comfortable but relatively nice-looking clothing, as though he might need to impress his wife in order to persuade her to stay with him. He ate a small sandwich and tried to rehearse what he might say if Effie came at him with suggestions about trial separations or some such solution.

Then, as the clock ticked down to the time she might be back from work, Jens tried to relax, stretching out along the sofa to read one of the English-language magazines he had picked up at Paris Charles de Gaulle before boarding his flight home. Thankfully, there was an article he could immerse himself within: a feature about the rise of perfumes that mimicked the actions of pheromones, which centered on the massive popularity of Jens's new fragrance, *Adultery*.

He was so immersed in the article that he almost missed it when Effie did arrive home.

He looked up to see her quietly hang up her coat behind the door, then wander over toward him like some kind of catwalk model, a mischievous smirk on her face.

'Hey,' he said, his nerves tingling all over, as that excruciating tension permeated his whole body.

'Hey,' she said, stepping in front of him before reaching behind herself to unzip—and then remove completely—her skirt.

She wasn't wearing panties, but Jens had no time to ask her where they were before she pulled the magazine out of his hands and unceremoniously

climbed over his head to straddle his face.

‘Mmm...’ he moaned, contented, as she wedged his head between her thighs and settled her soaking pussy over his eager mouth.

Gazing down on him, she said something that he couldn’t really hear, since her thighs were clamped so tightly against his ears. He wasn’t complaining. He was somewhat surprised by her unorthodox greeting, and just how desperate she apparently was for sex, but as well as being thrilling as hell, it seemed highly reassuring that the first thing she wanted, on seeing her husband was home again, was sex.

Jens spread his hands across her firm buttocks and licked for all he was worth, moaning loudly to show her his delight at her deliciously wet pussy. God, it was like she hadn’t had sex in a year, and now she had just ten minutes to make use of his mouth in any way she saw fit.

Her whole body trembled as he sucked on her pussy, as he lapped up her copious juices. She ran her fingers through his hair at first, but then she simply planted her hands down on the couch above his head and gyrated her hips gently, grinding her sex against his mouth. When she came closer to her orgasm, she sat more upright, her hands behind her on his chest. He stared up at her exposed stomach, and at the way her breasts strained against her white work shirt, her nipples just about visible through the material and her bra.

Oh, how he’d missed the taste of her sex, and that powerful scent of her arousal. He couldn’t get enough.

Then just as quickly as she’d straddled him, it seemed, she was crying out and shaking over him as she pressed her pussy down hard against his lips and his tongue, and came on his face with abundant wetness.

Climbing off him again, breathing heavily, brushing her hair out of her face and over her shoulders with her hands, she said ‘God, I needed that.’

He chuckled, his face cool as her wetness evaporated in the air-conditioned apartment. ‘Me too,’ he said, but his tone of voice was all *what*

the heck was that about, then?

She stooped to pick up her skirt, but she didn't stop to return the favor—went straight over to the kitchen area to fix herself a drink. Stood there, naked from the waist down, gulping down ice-cold orange juice for a while.

'Should I take it that you *didn't* have sex with him after your date last night?' Jens said, sitting up on the sofa and straightening his clothes as though to regain some kind of dignity.

'You should,' she said, and finished off the remaining juice in her glass.

'But I'm guessing... you wanted to? Or you want to now.'

She giggled. 'You're not guessing that I'm just happy to see my handsome husband again, after so many days away?'

'Well,' he grinned, 'that too.'

She put the glass down and took a few steps around the kitchen counter toward him. 'I wanted to talk to you before... you know... before things with Emil went too far.'

'Okay,' he nodded, feeling his anxiety surging again as the fear rematerialized, the feeling that this was it, this was them *really needing to talk*.

She perched on the arm of the sofa furthest from Jens. 'I think Emil wants us to have an affair,' she said, cautiously.

'Okay...'

'But I think it might have to be a proper affair.'

'Oh.'

'I wanted to talk with you about it, and of course if you have any doubts, I'll say 'no' and I don't need to see him again, not seriously. But—'

Jens felt a wave of relief. That she would contemplate telling Emil 'no', and never seeing him again. But what was that other part about?

'How do you mean, *proper* affair?'

She got up and slowly moved in front of him, so that she could kneel down at his feet. 'I tried to subtly sound him out about the whole concept of

open marriages, and he's really closed-minded to that kind of thing, I think,' she said, shaking her long, dark curls back over her shoulder before leaning forward to spread her fingers all over his lap.

'He wants you, but he'd be freaked out if he knew I was okay with it?' Jens asked.

'Something like that,' she said, her fingers moving skillfully to unfasten his belt and his fly.

'So that's okay—don't tell him.'

She sat up and sighed, 'You know how much I hate the lying. And I'm no good at it.'

'You just have to relax, and don't think about it too much,' Jens grinned, leaning forward to unfasten her shirt buttons. 'You don't necessarily have to lie... just avoid telling him I know everything.'

Her hands moved back to his loins, to stroke his hardness through his pants, and tease open his fly, but she let him pull open her shirt, and caress her breasts through her black satin bra. 'I get so awkward,' she said.

'So what's the alternative?' he stroked her cheek with warm affection.

She shrugged, then looked him in the eye. 'I think he's kind of excited about doing it... you know... in *secret*.'

Jens chuckled, 'So his marriage has collapsed, and now he gets to bring down yours?'

She shook her head, and now pulled her husband's cock fully from his clothing, before starting to play with it. 'I don't think he wants to end my marriage—our marriage. He's just after a little fun, you know? And to relive our youth, I guess.'

'Even though you already have a husband?'

She leaned down to give him a long lick from the base of his cock to its tip. 'I think he just assumes that when you've been married for a certain length, you know, you don't tend to have sex with your spouse anymore.'

'Because that's what happened to him?'

‘And his friends,’ she said, looking him straight in the eye before smiling broadly, and taking the top half of his manhood in her mouth as though trying to disprove Emil’s theory right then and there.

‘Well that’s... kind of sad, isn’t it?’ Jens said, before letting out a long moan as his beautiful wife sucked on the glans of his cock, while squeezing his shaft in her hand.

‘Mm-hmm,’ she agreed, her mouth full.

It felt so good, and Effie seemed so happy to be with him, pleasuring him, Jens felt completely reassured—and completely confident about this whole thing with Emil working out. He trusted her, didn’t he? Of course he did.

‘So this affair...’ he said, a little torn between wanting to sort out the whole thing and wanting to just lie back and enjoy the sensation of her mouth and hands on his cock. ‘...this is something you’d want to do with him?’

‘It would be fun, I’m sure,’ she said, jacking him in her hand. ‘But if you didn’t want me to...’

He said, ‘I’d want you to do, it if you wanted to.’

She went down on him, bobbing up and down a few times, taking him so deep it was a wonder she didn’t gag, and Jens found himself picturing a younger Effie, doing this to a younger Emil, perhaps on the floor of the bedroom of one of their childhood homes. Had she learned how to do this with Emil?

‘I think you were right,’ she said, ‘or at least your new therapist was right.’

‘Huh?’

She smiled, and kissed the tip of his cock. ‘I do feel more comfortable dating somebody I know already. Somebody I’ve been with before.’

‘Well then, this would probably be a good idea, right?’

She giggled, and sank down on his cock one more time. 'You're really crazy, you know that?' she laughed.

'Why, because I like the idea of you being completely satisfied, sexually?'

'With another man!' she laughed, and tucked her hair back behind her ear before sucking him into her hot mouth once again, making him groan like a starving zombie.

'Okay, so how would this work?' he asked her. 'This *proper* affair?'

She pulled herself up, turned, and then slowly sat in his lap, slipping his cock inside her soaking pussy as she moved into position. 'I think I start seeing him, but... you know... secretly.'

'Secretly?'

'So you don't know it's happening.'

Jens stroked her shoulders. 'But I'd know it was happening. The fact that we're talking about it right now...'

'But he doesn't know that we're talking about it.'

'I thought you said you didn't want to lie to him?'

'He's not going to ask me if I've talked it all over with you,' she laughed. 'He's going to make an assumption that you know nothing.'

'So what you're saying is, you need to make it seem as though you're having an affair with him,' Jens said, still trying to get his head around what she was saying.

'Uh-huh.'

'I don't get how it'll be different from... you know... what you had with Nico.'

'I think,' she said, wiggling her butt in such a way that Jens felt himself careening toward orgasm. 'I think it's that I'm not consciously telling you about my dates with him. I'm not coming straight home and reporting what happened. I'm kind of hiding it all from you...'

'You don't need to hide anything.'

‘I know you’ll find out. And afterwards, when we’ve had enough of it, I can tell you everything. But while it happens... it’s just something I do with Emil, so that I can tell him we’re safe, that you haven’t figured out what’s going on.’

‘You’re going to cheat on me,’ Jens pulled her back against him, hugging her tight as he felt his orgasm building. ‘And I won’t know about it until after it’s happened?’

‘That’s the gist of it, I think,’ she said. ‘Do you think you could stand it? Waiting to find out what happened?’

‘Probably,’ he said. ‘But you know... I’ll probably be assuming you’re doing it from now on. I’ll be suspecting something is happening...’

‘So you suspect,’ she smiled, squeezing his cock tightly with the walls of her pussy. ‘And then when your suspicions become too much, maybe you can catch me in the act, and we can have a big argument—’

‘Fake argument,’ Jens corrected her.

‘Fake argument. And then I’ll promise to end it all and be a good, faithful wife, and tell you whatever you want about what happened.’

Jens thought the whole idea was crazy. Basically, he’d be sharing Effie, except that while it was actively taking place, she wouldn’t tell him about what happened with Emil. He’d still know it was happening. There was no way she could completely hide it from him.

And it would be hot to know she was cheating on him, he was fairly sure about that.

‘Okay,’ he said, whispering in her ear as he held her tight against his chest, his hands squeezing her breasts. ‘You can cheat on me, honey... but if either one of us wants it to stop, it has to stop right then.’

‘Of course,’ she said. ‘You only have to tell me you know what’s going on... and it’ll stop.’

And then he came, hard, deep within his cheating wife.

DISTRACTION

‘**A**nd it’s really working?’ the therapist didn’t seem to quite believe it. ‘*Pretending* that she’s cheating on you?’

Jens shrugged. ‘I think so,’ he said. ‘I mean... the thing is, it started *really, incredibly slowly*. Like, as though she wasn’t seeing him at all. She stopped talking about him, stopped talking to him, as far as I could tell. I could detect absolutely no evidence that she was even in contact with him.’

‘Okay. So, she wasn’t going to tell you when the affair would actually start.’

‘No. She didn’t change her hours particularly—she’d come home at 9pm, usually, unless she was having drinks with her work friends, or her girlfriends. But when that happened, she’d come home and it would all appear to be true enough, she had just had a few drinks with friends.’

‘You think she was being clever?’ the therapist asked him. ‘She was good at hiding it from you?’

He shook his head.

‘She’d kiss me when she came in, and I could smell the alcohol on her. I could smell the hint of cigarettes, maybe. The fact that she’d been *out*—and there would be no traces of another man on her.

‘She hadn’t showered to hide traces of him?’

‘She hadn’t showered. I could smell the hint of the morning’s perfume on her skin—you can’t fake that.’

‘So you just had to wait for something to start,’ the therapist said.

‘It was driving me crazy,’ he chuckled. ‘When we made love, I found myself pretending that she’d just been with Emil. That they’d had lunch together, perhaps, or even just a coffee. That they had found some quiet, private spot to enjoy a little romance.’

‘Was she talking to him online? On Facebook?’

He sighed. ‘She’s changed all her passwords. I guess, it’s kind of sexy that she has, strangely. But it also makes me feel guilty in trying to check up on her that way.’

‘Even though she knows you’ll try.’

‘I guess so.’

‘How long were you waiting for something to actually happen with Emil?’

‘Three weeks? It seemed like months and months, but I think it was about three weeks.’

One morning Effie texted Jens while he was on the way home from work, to let him know she was having drinks with people from work, and that she would be late home. But it wasn’t her normal pattern: usually, when she was going out for drinks with people from work, Jens wouldn’t know until it actually happened, because only at the end of the working day would her colleagues decide they felt like going out for a drink or two. She couldn’t preemptively warn him about it the morning ahead of time.

Jens texted her back to let her know it was fine with him, adding that he hoped she had fun, as though he was hinting that he knew what she was up to. But now he felt his heart fluttering, his nerves tingling all over—he was certain she was selling him some excuse to cover up a date with Emil.

That evening after work, Jens returned home as normal, parked the car and headed up to the apartment. And when he did, another text came in

from Effie:

Effie: Hey honey, why don't you go take a nice swim? You know how that relaxes you. Xxx

It seemed slightly odd to Jens, not because Effie didn't ever suggest things for him to do of an evening, but because her texted suggestion came in association with the pattern-disrupting text she'd sent him that morning. But he replied back to her, *sure, why not?* And grabbed his swim things to head on up to the pool. It was as good as anything as a distraction. He was never going to entirely stop the thoughts from circling his head about what Effie might be up to, but a swim did help him to relax.

Perhaps only ten or fifteen minutes into his swim, he paused halfway through a length as he saw a pretty blonde woman venture out of the women's changing room, wearing a very revealing black-and-white striped bikini. She smiled as he stopped in the middle of the pool, gaping at her.

'Hey,' he said.

'Hey, fancy seeing you here,' Andrea laughed, stepping to the edge of the pool before reaching up to tie her long, golden hair back in a tight ponytail. She looked fantastic in that bikini, but it wasn't the usual kind of thing she wore to swim up here in the apartment building's pool—normally she opted for a one piece, something more designed for swimming than for posing on a beach.

'Did Effie tell you I'd be here?' he asked her, suddenly suspicious.

Andrea laughed again. 'Maybe,' she said.

Jens felt his manhood thicken within his swim trunks. As good as Andrea looked in her swimsuit, however, what really got Jens going was the sense that Effie might have encouraged the blonde to come here as a way to distract Jens from her date.

Andrea leaned forward a little, then bent her knees briefly before diving gracefully into the pool, soaring through the water past Jens, and over to the

shallow end of the pool. Then she pulled herself up out of the water, to sit provocatively on the edge of the pool.

‘What did she tell you?’ Jens asked her, moving slowly toward her.

Toying with her wet ponytail, she said, ‘Only that she was going out for drinks with some friends, and that if I was on my own, I might like to hang out with you.’

‘Okay...’

Jens approached her. It was really shallow down this end, the water dropping to mid-thigh level. His main thought was that, perhaps, Effie had let Andrea into her secret, and the blonde might be able to drop a few hints about what she was doing with Emil that evening.

But Andrea asked him, ‘What’s going on with you two?’ And she sounded genuine. ‘You haven’t been around recently.’

‘I was away on business for a few days,’ he explained. ‘In Paris.’

‘Wow.’

‘There’s a company there that wants to buy Laursen’s.’

‘Because of your amazing new perfumes?’ she said, beaming out admiration toward him.

‘Something like that,’ he said.

‘But that was only for a few days?’ Andrea probed. Now she was toying with her bikini top, stretching one of the straps so the material kept coming away slightly from one of her pert breasts. It had the inescapable effect of drawing his gaze down to her chest, whereupon he noticed how stiff her nipples were, poking out against the thin material of her bikini.

He shrugged, deciding there was no point in keeping the truth from her. ‘I think Effie has started seeing somebody.’

Andrea grinned wickedly. ‘You *think* she is?’

He smiled. ‘I guess you could say I *know* she is.’

She looked puzzled.

‘He’s an ex-boyfriend,’ he explained. ‘Her first real boyfriend, in fact. Maybe her first love.’

‘Wow. And you’re really okay with her seeing him?’ Andrea’s tone of voice both thrilled Jens and gave him little palpitations of doubt, confirming the likelihood that if this guy was Effie’s first love, the two of them would still share a formidable bond.

‘I encouraged her,’ he said. ‘I thought she’d...you know... enjoy herself. I thought... if she was with someone she knew, someone she trusted, she’d gain the confidence to date other men again.’

Perched on the edge of the pool, Andrea reached forward and took hold of the bow tied in the string that went around the waist of his swim trunks—then she pulled him toward her. ‘And did she suggest her first boyfriend, or did you?’ she asked.

‘She did,’ he said. ‘She connected with him on Facebook.’

Andrea nodded, mulling it over. She pulled him toward her some more, and wrapped her legs around his thighs, gripping the waist of his swim trunks in her fingers. ‘So how come she’s out tonight, and you only *think* she might be out with... what’s his name?’

‘Emil,’ he said.

‘Emil,’ she considered it. ‘Isn’t she supposed to tell you whenever she’s going on a date with someone else? I thought that was how it works?’

He noticed that Andrea was wearing makeup. That was something else she didn’t usually bother with when swimming here for the sake of the exercise. She didn’t need makeup to look good, but it did make her look sharper, more refined. Drop-dead gorgeous, in fact. It also looked as though she was making an effort for him.

‘Effie gets the feeling that Emil’s not the kind of guy who would go for it, if he knew I knew about him seeing her.’

‘He’s not the *sharing* type?’

‘He’s not on board with open marriages, let’s just say.’

‘He’s the one missing out, huh?’ Andrea giggled, and gave him a little squeeze between her thighs.

‘Anyway, so I figured rather than calling the whole thing off, Effie could see him... and tell me all about it when it’s all over,’ he explained.

‘When it’s all over,’ she looked quizzical. ‘So she doesn’t even drop little hints... you know... when she’s actually going out with this guy?’

‘No,’ he said. ‘She’s wary that Emil might ask if I know what’s going on between them... and she’s never been very good at lying.’

‘But now she’s hiding the truth from you?’

‘She can do that, and it doesn’t matter that I know she’s hiding something. In fact, it’s better that I know, because then I get to enjoy it, too.’

‘You get to enjoy her cheating on you?’

Andrea tugged on his swim trunks so she could take a peek down his waistband, which made her giggle again on seeing he was hard right now.

‘You *are* enjoying it,’ she said, highly amused.

‘Did she tell you what she’s doing tonight?’ he asked her.

Andrea shook her head. ‘Well, I mean, she told me she was out with her work buddies. But that’s BS, right?’

‘I assume so. Did she tell you to wear the bikini?’

She giggled. ‘No. I just bought this one, actually. I thought I’d see what you thought.’

‘Very nice.’

‘Good for distracting you?’

‘Uh-huh...’

She pulled him to her, kissing his lips. He didn’t stop her. He kissed her back, feeling grateful that she’d drop everything to come help Effie distract him during date night with Emil. She tasted sweet, as though she’d just been eating ripe fruit. He kissed his way down her neck, marveling at how soft she felt.

She moaned gently as he kissed his way over the upper slopes of her breasts, before slipping down her bikini top to take one of her nipples into his mouth.

Would Emil be doing something similar with Effie later? How would she respond to attention from her first crush after so many years?

‘So if Effie comes home tonight... are you going to tell her you know she’s been with Emil?’

‘Nope,’ he said, slipping Andrea’s other breast free of her swimsuit before taking her other nipple into his mouth.

‘Mmm... so she’s going to pretend she really went out with her work friends...’

‘Uh-huh...’ As he sucked on her breasts, swirling his tongue around her nipples, he slipped a hand down between her thighs, under the thin material of her bikini bottoms, his fingers brushing over the little patch of soft hair above her mound before discovering the slippery folds of her pussy.

‘God...’ she moaned. ‘Are you going to tell her what we did while we hung out tonight?’

‘If she wants to know,’ he said.

‘That doesn’t seem fair.’

‘I’m not the one having a secret affair.’

Andrea let out a delighted little yelp as he slid a finger inside her tight pussy, but then she was raising her hips for him to remove her bikini bottoms, clearly wanting more than just his finger. What if somebody else came in to use the pool? She didn’t seem to care.

‘So you’re just going to let her... sleep with her first love...’ she said as he kissed his way down her stomach, brushed his nose through her little patch of pubic hair, and made himself comfortable between her thighs, breathing in the sexy scent of her arousal. ‘And then you won’t even ask about it afterwards?’

‘I’ll find out eventually,’ he said, planting a kiss just next to her slit, before taking one of her pussy lips in his mouth.

‘Hmm... but can you wait that long? I mean, until she’s completely finished with him? That could take weeks. Months. Years, even. Ohhh...’

She moaned as he slid his tongue into her pussy, and lapped at her tangy goodness.

‘Not much else I can do, right now,’ he said, smiling up at her before taking her clit in his mouth for some gentle suction.

‘Oh God that feels so good...’ she moaned, then, ‘You could... suggest she date someone else... another of her exes. You know, someone who could handle sharing her with you.’

‘There’s no guarantee she’d want someone else right now,’ he said, stroking her pussy lips and clit with his cheeks, spreading her wetness across his face. ‘At least I know she’s into this guy. She’s having a lot of fun.’

‘You’re crazy... you know that?’ she laughed, and then let out a little shriek of joy as he penetrated her with his tongue. ‘You’re supposed to be having a lot of fun, too, aren’t you?’

He laughed. ‘I am having a lot of fun.’

He made her come with his mouth to the point where he was worried someone else who lived on this floor, or nearby, might call the police to report an attack taking place because of all the yelping and crying. She went down on him, reveling in the wickedness of this public debauchery, risking discovery all the time.

But then they went down to Andrea’s small apartment, where they could chill out on her sofa and she could suck on his cock some more while they ordered some pizza and waited for it to arrive. Once the pizza was out of the way, Andrea slipped off her swimsuit and climbed onto his lap, taking his hardness inside her.

‘If I were you,’ she said, kissing his neck. ‘I would probably want to know everything Effie was up to.’

Jens moaned as he felt her begin to stir her hips to move his cock deep within her pussy. ‘I do want to know,’ he said. ‘But there’s not much I can do when she tells me she’s going out for drinks with her work buddies, and I have no idea where she’s really going.’

‘You can’t... give up like that,’ she grinned, riding him as though she was trying to milk his cock with her pussy.

‘I’m not giving up... I’m just being patient.’

‘Patience is boring,’ she said, ramping up the speed of her rocking on his shaft until he was getting close to the point of no return.

‘So... what... do you say I should do?’

She smiled. ‘I think you need to try harder to find out what your wife is doing with her new man.’

And with that he came deep within her.

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EFFIE RETURNS

After that, they kept each other company watching a movie together—Jens didn't feel particularly rushed, considering that Effie had told him she was going to be late back.

But then when the movie credits rolled, and tiredness slipped in, Jens headed back to his apartment only to find Effie was already home—and taking a shower.

He heard the shower the moment he opened the front door, and at first he paused, holding the door so it couldn't bang shut behind him. Was she here in the apartment alone?

He figured she had to be. She wouldn't risk bringing Emil here, not knowing what time Jens would get home after spending the evening with Andrea. She couldn't even have guaranteed that Jens and Andrea wouldn't have come back here after swimming in the pool together, rather than going to her place.

He allowed the front door to shut as normal, knowing Effie would hear it.

A glance at his phone told him it was nearly midnight—that was enough time for Effie to have dinner with a guy and then head back to his place for sex, right? Jens felt himself shiver, in a good way, while his manhood began thickening up. She had to have had sex with him tonight. They knew each

other from way back, they were attracted to each other, they'd done it before. This was a secret affair—what was the point of having a secret affair if you didn't have sex? And they were old enough that sex between the two of them wasn't sacred enough to hold off until the third or fourth date.

'Hey!' Effie yelled over the noise of the shower, as though she needed to let him know where she was.

He took it as being a signal to him that it was safe for him to come in, although she really wasn't supposed to acknowledge to him that she had another man.

'Hey!' he yelled back, but he didn't go straight in to see her. He was scouting around the apartment, scanning with his eyes, searching for any possible signs that Emil had been here, even for a short amount of time. Or, for that matter, any signs at all that Effie had been with him, doing more than just dinner and drinks.

The apartment was spotless, not touched since he had left for his swim earlier in the evening. But her clothes were in the laundry basket.

These days, with the progress Jens had made, they didn't do laundry twice an evening anymore, like in the bad old days. Twice a week, perhaps, normally. So tonight, if she had come home from her 'drinks with co-workers' and immediately put her clothes from the evening in to be washed, it would have seemed suspicious. So she hadn't—her clothes were in the laundry basket.

Here they were. She'd been wearing her work clothes—white shirt, knee-length charcoal gray skirt and matching blazer—but date panties. And even before he picked those up, his nose was hit by the unmistakable scent of sex.

Wow.

'You have a nice time with Andrea?' Effie yelled from the shower.

'Uh-huh,' he replied, keeping his tone as casual, as normal, as possible.

The evidence in his hands seemed explosive.

There could be no doubt. Effie had done it all with Emil, she was certainly having a full affair in every sense of the word. Jens inhaled the thick, musky scent, reveling in the infidelity of his wife. He couldn't believe how sexy it made her, and how turned on he was by it. And yet more than ever before, it seemed dangerous.

She was sleeping with her first love. Her first crush. It wasn't just a random fling, it wasn't just a little fun with somebody from work. It was the guy she grew up with, the guy she grew up wanting more than any other.

Jens quickly replaced her clothes in the basket as he had found them, and stripped off his own clothes. He was hard as a rock, but that could have been from missing her, or from the fact that he'd just had an evening of sexual fun with Andrea. He wrapped a towel around his waist and ventured into the bathroom.

The quicker he was, the less time she'd have to scrub away the evidence.

She gave him a welcoming smile as he first laid eyes on her, as though she'd really done nothing more than attend a bar or two in the company of work colleagues, drinking and chatting, complaining about their boss or their client or that guy in the cafe at lunch who wouldn't stop staring at everybody's tits. As the water splashed all over her beautiful, naked body, rinsing away the traces of what she'd really been up to—sharing a bed with another man.

'Hey,' she said again as he opened the shower door, his eyes all over her, as though he hadn't seen her in a month.

She looked spectacular. Those curves in all the right places, the stiffness of her dusky nipples astride her pert breasts, her toned tummy, those long, shapely legs, the irresistible lines of her abdomen leading the eyes down to her hairless mound, her delectable pussy all freshly shaved for the benefit of another man.

‘Hey,’ he said, smiling. That touch of awkwardness in both their eyes that said, *I know what you’ve been up to tonight*, though neither of them could say anything on the record. ‘You have a good time?’

She nodded, folding her arms across her chest almost protectively, before changing her mind almost instantly, reaching forward to untuck the towel from around his waist, allowing it to drop to unveil his stiff cock.

‘I did,’ she said, her smile one of delight at the sight of her husband being all ready to go. ‘We just went to that place down by Nyhavn. Nebbiolo, I think it’s called?’

A lie. A white lie, and her face confessed all, of course, straight away. She could have taken Emil to Nebbiolo, but it was doubtful because her work friends did often go to that one, and would have queried why she was there with a strange man, flirting, maybe even kissing.

She was allowed to lie to her husband during this game. Well, it didn’t matter that he knew she was lying. That was part of it, that was his pleasure until the time came for her to confess all.

A kiss of her lips as he closed the shower door again. Sweetness there, and still a hint of alcohol on her breath. Perhaps something else, too, that might betray her infidelity, since she hadn’t brushed her teeth yet—though that could have been his imagination. Imagination was important, though, at times like these. Filling in the gaps that might otherwise have stolen the thrilling knowledge from him that his wife had been unfaithful that night, his wife had enjoyed the intimate touch of another man, had taken another man *inside her*.

‘Did you have a good time with our friend?’ she asked, as they parted again and he wondered if she could detect Andrea on him.

‘Oh yes,’ he smiled, and she returned it before turning her back to him, allowing him to reach around her and cup her gorgeous breasts with both hands.

‘I should be jealous,’ she smirked.

‘You were the one who told her to fuck me,’ he laughed.

‘Mmm-hmm,’ she closed her eyes and bit her lip, pressing her behind into him to feel his big, hard cock against her buttocks.

‘April says ‘hi’, by the way,’ she said, citing a colleague as though she really had simply enjoyed drinks with her work buddies.

‘Oh, she does, huh?’ he said, but stopped himself from saying more in that knowing tone, as her hand closed around his shaft and began to squeeze it. They weren’t supposed to acknowledge her affair. He could enjoy knowing she was doing it, but he couldn’t share that knowledge. Not for now.

That wasn’t the arrangement.

‘You know she’s always had a thing for you,’ she teased. Jens tried to picture April, who he met once a long time ago while they were doing an initial experiment with him attending a bar—which hadn’t gone particularly well, from what he remembered.

‘I guess I should say Andrea says ‘hi’,’ he said, standing in such a way as to shield her body from the flow of the water.

‘Did she take good care of my husband?’

‘Uh-huh.’

They kissed again, and his hand dipped down to seek out her mound, and the wetness beneath. She was very, very wet, and not in the sense that she’d been showering. His fingers glided into her soft groove, enchanted by how slippery it was. *Oiled by another guy.*

‘Did she make you come?’ she asked as he kissed his way down her chest, over her breasts and onward down her stomach, disappointed to smell only her shampoo.

‘Oh, yes,’ he said, having to bite his lip before the words popped out of his mouth, *did he make you come?*

She let the warm water run over her shoulders, down her back, as he knelt on the floor and kissed his way close to her stunning pussy, thrilled at

the scent of her arousal, even more thrilled that he could detect that unmistakable synthetic tang of the condom that slid into and out of her wonderfully unfaithful sex that night, as her first love slipped his hard penis into her again and again.

She lifted a leg, touching her foot up against the wall, to allow him easy access to cover her sex with his mouth. She stroked his hair as he flicked his tongue over her pussy, as he sucked hungrily on her pussy lips. Other men—even men who could appreciate the sharing of a wife—might think him foolish for allowing Effie to keep her affair secret from him, to tell him nothing about what went on. But for Jens, he could tell what was going on. He could breathe her in and know what was going on.

Here, between her legs, he could sense her wickedness, he could tell another man had been here before, enjoying her searing-hot pussy.

Effie's sighs and quiet moans slowly developed into a breathless panting, and her hand gently stroking his hair became firmer, as it switched from affection to desperation, until it was holding him, clamped against her throbbing sex. Did she know he could tell she'd been with Emil? She had to. Her orgasm was too quick and too powerful to be purely from the physical stimulation.

She knew.

She had a glint in her eye as he stood, a glint that said *you're the second man to do that to me tonight*, you know that? And she bit her lip as her fingers curled around his pulsing-hard erection as though to tell him outright I can't believe how lucky I am to take hold of my second beautiful cock of the night.

And when she sat on the floor and took his cock in her mouth, she wasn't just gazing up at him with the eyes of a woman who enjoyed the feel of a man's hardness between her lips, she was worshipping him with the gratitude of a wife given every freedom, to experience the full range of sexual delights, by a most unselfish husband.

He struggled to avoid coming in her mouth, just from how obvious it was that she'd had such a wonderful night fucking her ex. When she knelt up and had him slide his stiffness between her gorgeous breasts, it didn't seem like something she normally did—and proved another tell for the fact that she'd been doing it with someone else that night.

When she turned her back to him, bending over to offer her behind, and he finally slid inside her while she splayed her hands out on the tiles in front of her, he was thinking, *was this how he fucked her tonight?* He got the feeling her every move was recalling her time with Emil, either consciously or unconsciously reporting back to her husband what had gone on with the other man, even if she wasn't allowed to say so explicitly.

When she made him pull out, and come on her breasts, it seemed one hundred percent fact that she was repeating what had happened with Emil earlier that night.

'I'm glad she didn't tire you out,' she purred as they snuggled up together in their big bed later. 'You know, a younger woman and all that.'

He couldn't come straight back and tell her that he was glad Emil had left her with some desire remaining to share.

'It was nice,' he said, 'but I was saving myself for you.'

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SECRET DATING

‘**A**nd since then, she’s gone on more dates with Emil?’ the therapist asked him.

‘Yes. I mean, in secret. But I’m pretty sure she’s been dropping me little clues just to make sure I know it’s going on.’

‘Clues? Like what?’

‘I don’t know... like buying new clothes. Getting her hair done more often than usual. Making herself look seriously hot all the time. Things that I know she does when she’s dating somebody, because she’s done it before.’

It was almost role play, when it started, because he knew she was going to do it, and she knew he knew. And she knew he would be thrilled at any hint that it was going on.

But then, after a while, she began to forget about their little game. She was dating someone in secret, and it got so that she really was keeping it a secret from him. They slipped into their roles so well, it was almost like doing it for real.

Effie did adjust her normal routine to accommodate it all so that she might hide her dating. She was going out two or three times each week these days—often, she really was going out with her colleagues after work; but also, she reconnected with girlfriends she’d known as far back as college, and she would see them regularly, too.

Sometimes, she would text him from her nights out, and send him pictures of her with her friends that simply could not have been faked.

But then even though she was increasingly careful to conceal her dating in amongst her enhanced social life, occasionally some little detail would slip and he would know she'd just spent a night with Emil, rather than wherever she said she had.

She might come home later than usual, and when he took her in his arms and kissed her, the freshness of her skin and the hint of shampoo in her hair would tell him she'd just had a shower—hardly something you did while you were out at a bar with friends.

She might get dressed up to go out with 'friends' at the weekend, and instead of getting changed in the bedroom with the door open like normal, she'd change in the bathroom with the door closed, thinking him too busy watching TV to really notice. One time she didn't even close the bathroom door properly, and he saw her putting on sexy stockings and a suspender belt—hardly the kind of underwear someone might wear for an evening with colleagues.

'We're going clubbing,' she said once, when she came out of the bathroom wearing a nice, short dress that was a little too sexy for a girls' night out.

He liked it, to begin with. It kept him on his toes. He liked that she was enjoying life more now, anyway, going out more. And he liked the air of mystery about her nights out whenever she was gone for the night—was she really just on a night out with co-workers, or girlfriends? Or was she partying with Emil, going back to his place afterward for blistering sex?

He liked it best when he knew she was on a date while it was happening, or when she came back to him afterward. The time she ran out of her birth control pills and couldn't get more for a few days, and she had to start hiding condoms in her bag before a night out. The time her

boyfriend arranged for Uber to pick her up, and when the driver buzzed up to the apartment, he mistakenly said the car was for Emil.

One time she was too drunk to remember to shower after sleeping with Emil. Her words slurring slightly as she returned home late, ‘Hey baby! I... didn’t think you’d still be awake...’ Kicking off her high-heeled shoes as she stepped into the bedroom, running a hand through her hair, down her chest, telling him she’d lost track of time—that when girls got chatting, time could just fly by before anyone noticed. He smelled that stale sweetness from her night out, the lingering traces of cigarettes and alcohol from whichever place they’d hung out in before going back to Emil’s place. And of course, as he’d stood up to greet her, he breathed in a whole lungful of that post-coital dankness.

‘Hi,’ she said, surprised, as he kissed her mouth. Pleased, as she usually was, that he desired her, even after an evening full of Emil desiring her as well.

‘Somebody’s been missing me,’ she said, her hand brushing against the stiffness straining against his boxer shorts.

She was often horny after a date with Emil. That was often another easy way to tell it had happened. Still semi-drunk, her inhibitions were less controlled and she didn’t do anything to hide her lust.

‘You wanna fuck me?’ she said, not something she’d usually say to her husband.

She sank to her knees, hands gliding all over his crotch, around his hips, then slowly peeling his boxers down his thighs as she felt the need to concoct details about her night out—drinking wine with the girls, talking about the possibility that one of them might be getting engaged very soon: details that were too staged to be real.

Stroking his cock over her face, touching it as though she needed to re-familiarize herself with it, licking it as if she’d forgotten how to handle that

particular dick, moaning as though she rarely got the chance to sample her husband's cock.

The way she took him in her mouth, it was different now than it had been before. She sank deeper on it, she made more effort to gaze up into her husband's eyes than she used to. She seemed to enjoy it more, too. As though her time with Emil had taught her to slow down and enjoy it more. To really experience sex, to really explore her desires.

When she stripped for him, revealing tiny little crimson lace panties that were not designed for an innocent night out with friends—and matching thigh-high stockings that weren't, either—she reminded him that girls like dressing up smart and sexy to impress other girls on a night out, just as much as for guys they might want to attract.

But when she pushed him back onto the bed, and pushed her behind onto his lap, pulling aside her panties to allow his hardness to sink straight into her soaking-wet pussy, the smell of sex was so powerful on her that there could be no mistake she'd already slept with someone earlier that night.

And she was so wet when he entered her, her pussy so slippery as she bounced up and down on his shaft, that there could be no other explanation than the strangely exhilarating fact that she was full of another man's come.

Yelling, 'Oh fuck, oh fuck, oh fuck...' as she made love to him more like an exotic dancer doing a lap dance than the loving wife he was used to.

Did she know he knew? She had to, sometimes. But she certainly acted as though she didn't. As though she thought she was getting away with everything.

Even when he was fucking her with the energy of a man reclaiming his naughty wife, and she made little comments about how amazingly hard he was, how horny she made him, how much more passionate he was than she expected at such a late hour—it didn't seem to alert her to the fact that he

was so pumped because she'd just come home from fucking Emil, and he knew full well.

Even if she came home freshly showered, he was pumped for her, because he knew. But it was extra special when he could smell the other man on her, when he could see how mussed her hair was, how her makeup was smudged, and he could taste the perspiration on her skin and feel the come in her sex.

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TWELVE

PHONE SWITCH

Even though Effie was so good at keeping her secret affair quiet, and almost entirely undetectable for her husband, there were little signs that she simply could not hide, even if she was as diligent as could be. And these little signs constantly kept Jens on edge—and, as far as his wife was concerned, horny as a tomcat.

One of those signs was that she seemed so happy and self-confident all the time. It was heartwarming to see, and of course had always been one of the reasons Jens had been attracted by the idea of allowing her to see other guys. Her general bounciness around the place was enough to make Jens semi-erect, if he was thinking about it particularly as evidence of her affair.

There was the little habit she started to get, of asking Jens if she'd already told him things already. Often, it was to do with something about work, or something new that had happened to a family member. 'Did I tell you this already?' she might say, and he would know she was getting confused about what she'd told him and what she'd told Emil already.

She was more interested in sex than before, of course. That happened whenever she was seeing another guy. All that flirting through the day meant that even if she wasn't seeing her date in the evening, she would be all wound up and needing some serious fucking to defuse all her tension. But while she was dating Emil, it seemed to Jens that Effie suddenly

enjoyed sex doggy-style much more often than ever before—and Jens took that to be because Emil did. And that was a little bonus excitement.

She had changed her passwords so that he couldn't look in on her messaging, either her text messages or Facebook. That was frustrating to Jens, and if her adultery hadn't been pre-agreed, it might have been something that really saddened him. But for now, he just took it as evidence that she was flirting and perhaps even sexting with Emil, and it only turned Jens on to think that he could no longer monitor her personal life online.

And she was spending so much more time on her phone—in the evenings, when they were watching TV, she'd always enjoyed scouring the online news and playing Candy Crush, but nowadays when Jens subtly attempted a glance at her phone screen, it seemed she was often texting. And he knew exactly who she was texting, even if she tried to act as though she was simply playing games all the time. Sometimes, she'd smile at her phone before quickly trying to hide it, and it would only give the game away more obviously.

Then one Saturday night, the day before Effie was due to fly up to Stockholm for a conference, the importance of her phone really became obvious when Jens came home to find her frantically searching the apartment for it. The place was a mess, but Jens didn't say anything about that, even if it made his skin crawl. He helped her look for it, and neither one of them could find it.

'I must have left it at the office?'

'You can't just head back into the office to get it?'

'No, because Victor will be there, since he's working Saturdays at the moment, and I don't want to see him because I'm supposed to have done all these reports for him, and today I told him I was feeling ill, so I couldn't get them for him... it's too complicated.'

'So get it tomorrow, on your way to the airport.'

‘If I go in tomorrow, I’ll have to sign in, and Victor will see that I signed in at the weekend when he comes in on Monday.’

‘Oh, what a tangled web we weave, when first we practice to deceive,’ Jens chuckled.

Effie gave him a playful eye-roll.

‘Maybe you can do without it—you have your work phone, right?’ Jens said, feeling that little tingle of excitement inside whenever even the slightest evidence of Effie’s infidelity emerged. ‘I mean, you can use your laptop to call me...’

Effie sighed, and Jens knew she was looking at four days without regularly texting Emil, and it both thrilled and frightened him that she couldn’t do without it. She couldn’t text him on her work phone, and she couldn’t have her laptop open throughout the conference, and in bed. But neither of them could say that.

Part of him wanted to ask why Emil couldn’t just take a few days off and go stay with her in Stockholm for a day or so, but the realities of work were that the guy couldn’t just drop everything at a moment’s notice. And Jens couldn’t even hint at suggesting Emil go up to Sweden to visit his wife.

He could only joke, ‘You really have to play Candy Crush that badly while you’re away?’

‘It helps reduce my stress,’ she insisted, and blushed faintly, which exposed her lie easily enough, and proved her point when they’d talked about Emil in the first place that Effie found it hard to lie convincingly.

Jens felt his manhood thickening up, and now he was wracking his head for a way to allow Effie to play her ‘Candy Crush’ while away at the conference.

He was about to suggest going into town to buy her a new phone. Then an idea presented itself.

‘What about one of your old phones?’ he asked her. ‘You’d be able to run Candy Crush on one of those?’

They dug one of her old phones out, but switching it on, it appeared to need a sim card to set it up. Google suggested that you needed a sim card initially, to set up the old iPhone as a wifi-only device, and since Effie’s work phone was an Android device, that only left Jens’s sim card.

‘You can use mine,’ he said.

‘You’re sure?’

‘Sure, why not?’

They did get it to work, and beside a few warning messages telling her to insert a sim card, it allowed Effie to download the apps that she needed—Jens left her to set it up for herself, but it seemed apparent she wasn’t merely downloading Candy Crush.

‘Lifesaver,’ she said once it was all done, and she gave him a kiss on the cheek.

That evening, they were watching TV like most Saturday nights when she hadn’t concocted a suitable excuse to see Emil. As usual, while they watched TV, Effie had half her focus on her phone—supposedly playing Candy Crush, but no doubt secretly texting Emil at the same time. Jens ignored his phone, as usual, except when he briefly went to use the bathroom, and flicked it on to read the news while he used the facilities.

He noticed a new app on his home page—Messenger.

It wasn’t something Jens used, since he texted Effie with normal text messages, so he knew full well it was now installed because she had installed it on her own phone, which was set up with his sim card. Heart beating a little quicker than normal, he opened the app. Would she be able to tell he’d opened it? He wasn’t sure. Would he even be able to log into the app? Well, it turned out he could. Apple’s password management system remembered the log-in details from when Effie had signed into the app on her device.

He felt a jolt of heat shoot through his heart as the app opened up and presented a page of messages between Effie and Emil.

Emil: Can't you just fly first thing in the morning? Maybe you'll miss the first couple of presentations, but who cares about that?

Effie: I really can't. I'm supposed to be chairing one of the seminar sessions at 11. If I'm flying in that morning I'll be insanely stressed about it.

Emil: But you'd be completely de-stressed if you spent the night with me...

Effie: I'd get stressed in the morning as soon as I left for the airport.

Emil: Well, I can't believe I don't even get to see you tonight.

Effie: I told you, it would be too obvious. I never go out with people on Saturday nights. He'd start thinking something odd was going on.

Emil: You're missing out on a delicious linguine tonight.

Effie: That sounds yummy.

Emil: And my mouth on your sweet pussy :-P

Effie: Oh God, that sounds even more yummy...

Emil: You're sure you don't want to reconsider? My hot tongue sliding inside you...

Effie: Please don't... you're making me wet...

Emil: You could say there's been a family emergency... then you could sit on my lap... take my big, hard cock inside you...

Jens was getting hard, but he could only spend so long in the bathroom before Effie might start getting suspicious. He switched off the phone and pulled his pants back up before heading back out to the living room. Effie was playing Candy Crush as he returned, but she was also blushing, which made it fairly clear that Emil had heated her up with his text messages.

'You okay?' he asked her, just because it was something to say as he returned from the bathroom, without realizing that it would be interpreted as him suggesting something was up with her.

She looked up, surprised and then afraid that he had noticed something was up, before trying to hurriedly hide that emotion.

‘Uh... yeah,’ she said, faux-innocent. ‘I guess... I’m just a little stressed about the conference.’

‘I bet I know how to help with your stress,’ Jens said, a wicked idea springing to his mind.

‘Wait... what?’

He dropped to his knees in front of her, and slid his hands slowly up her legs, caressing her through the thin leggings she was wearing.

‘You’re playing Candy Crush like it’s hurt your mother.’

‘I told you,’ she said firmly, ‘it helps me with stress.’

‘I’m not saying you should stop playing.’

He leaned forward to kiss her knee, the soft material of her leggings warm against his lips. She opened her legs for him as he stroked her thighs with his face, breathing in that irresistible scent—her personal scent, along with a hint of long-worn perfume, and that wicked underlying darkness that he knew came from her arousal at Emil’s suggestive texts.

‘You’re going to help me with my stress, too?’ she asked softly, flirtatious in a way she wasn’t often with her husband these days, but which perhaps rubbed off from her attitude with Emil.

‘Uh-huh,’ he said, nuzzling gently up against her special place, inhaling the stronger scent of her excitement through her leggings and her underwear. He stroked her there, with his nose and his lips, and she moaned and parted her thighs wider, as wide as she could manage on that couch.

After a while, he felt the dampness come through the soft cotton, and it meant she must have been really soaking wet. Jens was aware that she was still clutching her mobile phone, looking at it even while he pressed his face against her so that she could feel the heat of his mouth, and she was making it look as though she was continuing to play her game, though he suspected she was really texting with Emil.

So sexy to know that she was texting her ex-boyfriend while her husband was pleasuring her. Sexting him. And Jens was going to have to start thinking of the guy hardly as an ‘ex’ anymore. She was flirting with, and teasing her boyfriend sexually via text while Jens was sucking on her pussy through her underwear.

She giggled, as though Jens had tickled her briefly, and yet he was being gentle, sustained, he hadn’t done anything differently for a few minutes, and it made him know she was giggling about something Emil had texted her.

‘Mmm... that’s nice,’ she said, reinforcing the idea that it wasn’t Jens that had just made her laugh.

‘Better than Candy Crush?’

She grinned. ‘I’m not sure,’ she teased. ‘Maybe you need to keep doing it a while so we can compare.’

She stood up, still playing her game—flashing her screen toward him subtly, as though to prove to him that she really was crushing that candy—and with the hand that wasn’t holding her phone, she began tugging down her leggings, her panties dropping with them.

Jens helped her pull them down, and as she sat back on the couch, lifting her feet, he helped her haul her leggings and her underwear from her calves and off past her feet, leaving her bare, other than her pink tank top.

She grinned as he folded her clothes and draped them tidily over the arm of the couch, and then he felt her foot gently press against his crotch, tracing out the shape of his hard cock, stroking it.

‘Mmm... very nice,’ she purred, ‘I wonder how that compares to Candy Crush?’

But then she sat back, lifting one knee to the side, to expose her gorgeous pussy to his hungry gaze. He ducked down and kissed her inner thigh, enjoying the heat, the subtle saltiness of her skin, the powerful scent of her excitement as he edged closer and closer to her glistening folds.

‘Mmm...’ she moaned as he ran his tongue along her soaking pussy lips, enjoying the tangy flavor, and the way she responded to his mouth on her sex.

She stroked his head gently with one hand as he ate her, and her cooing, sighing moans continued as he flicked the tip of his tongue against her clit, or drew her pussy lips into the suction of his mouth, but only as he glanced upward after a while did he notice that she was also looking at her phone, and tapping away on its screen with her other hand.

Just the hottest experience, going down on her while she sexted with her boyfriend.

Each time she moaned, he wondered if it was his mouth, or Emil’s words that made her do it. Every time she caught her breath, or sighed, or giggled, it seemed more likely to be from her boyfriend’s messages. But Jens had a little nugget of pure pride at his heart as he considered the fact that he was the one who got to wedge his face between her thighs that night, he was the one who could indulge in his desire for her.

And at the end of the day, he was the one who could end this affair, and be the one to walk off into the sunset with this gorgeous woman.

At least, that was the theory.

The best part was when she came, so hard, and she had to drop the phone, she had to hold on to his head with both hands, grind her pussy against his face, hump his mouth as she held him there.

So wet for him.

Afterward, breathless, she said, ‘Okay, you win. That was better than Candy Crush.’ She giggled, and Jens felt the heavy hint that she was saying it was better than Emil.

Well, maybe it was, maybe it wasn’t. The thing was, Jens was willing to let her have Emil as well. Emil didn’t want to let her see other men.

Afterward, she took him to the window, and had him slide his cock into her from behind as she placed her hands on the glass to support her body,

and who-knew-who from the apartment building across the street would be able to see him fucking her—but Jens got the feeling this was something she had done with Emil, either when they'd originally dated, or recently. One of the benefits of sharing her—she'd learned a thing or two in the sack. And it was always hotter with her when she was doing something she'd learned from another lover.

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THIRTEEN

A TRIP TO STOCKHOLM

Then she was flying away, up to Stockholm, and from the get-go, Jens found himself missing her immensely, even if she was only going to be gone for five days or so. It seemed like he'd never missed her more, and the feelings he had were decidedly stronger than when she'd gone on previous business trips.

Was this because he was sharing her with Emil, now? This guy seemed to mean so much more to her than other guys she'd dated before. It was the fact that Effie was so clearly fond of him that made Jen's feelings for her all the stronger.

That first morning, he woke up and his bed was empty, and he knew she'd taken an early taxi to the airport so that she could fly to the Swedish capital in good time, to get herself sorted in her hotel, and perhaps an early night before the conference started the next morning. But the bed did seem very empty without her beside him.

He hauled himself out of bed, and the apartment seemed empty, too.

That dark corner of his mind asked the question: *Would this be how it feels if she did leave you? If, one day, she chose Emil over you?*

It made him shudder. No, he trusted Effie. She was married to him. She would never just drop him for another man—that was the whole point of marriage, of her commitment. She had already consciously chosen to

forsake all other men and remain with Jens. It was just that Jens had given her a little flexibility when it came to sex.

After a shower, Jens fixed himself breakfast and picked up his phone to read the news. When he pressed the 'home' button, a list of recent alerts was displayed—and these included alerts from the Facebook Messenger app, which was apparently still logged in to Effie's account.

Jens felt a little jolt in his heart at the possibility that she was going to keep in touch with Emil on an app that Jens had access to monitor.

He opened up the app.

Effie: On my way to the airport! Wish you were coming too!

Emil: Coming or cumming?

Effie: Well, both.

Emil: Hmm... well, you know I can't get to Stockholm right now. But the other one, I can manage, maybe if you help me.

Effie: I'm not in Stockholm yet, I'll be at the airport in 10 minutes. What kind of help do you need?

Emil: There's nowhere we could go at the airport for any kind of privacy, you know that. We'd get arrested and then you'd miss your flight.

Effie: So you'll just have to cum on your own for now :-)

Emil: So will you help me?

Effie: Like how?

Emil: I don't know. Give me something sexy.

Effie: I'm in a taxi!

Emil: What are you wearing?

Effie: Jeans. A shirt. Nothing very exciting.

Emil: When you get to the airport, find a toilet. Send me a nice picture!

Xxx

Jens was so hard, so quickly. There was something so erotic about the tone of Effie's flirting with Emil. It wasn't just that his wife was being naughty with another guy—it was the secretive nature of it. The fact that

they were not supposed to be doing this. If the two of them were going to carry on texting each other like this all through the week, Jens wasn't going to get much done.

Ten or fifteen minutes later, Jens had finished his breakfast and was getting undressed ready for a shower, when his phone chirped to let him know another message had been received on the Messenger app.

Effie: How's this?

Effie had sent a picture of herself, clearly taken from within the stall of a women's restroom. She was smiling, looking pretty, wearing a white button-down shirt and a pair of blue jeans, sitting on the toilet.

Emil: Very nice. But now open your shirt :-)

Next came a selfie in which Effie had unfastened half of the buttons of her shirt, and now she held one side open to reveal one of her breasts. Her nipple was clearly stiff.

Emil: You're a tease, you know that? I don't have all the time in the world before work...

Effie: No fair, you should give me something in return ;-)

Emil: Here...

And now Emil sent Effie a picture of himself lying in bed, naked from the waist up. The guy was chiseled. He clearly spent time in the gym. The sight of him made Jens feel jealous, even if he liked the idea of his wife getting her hands on a guy like that.

Effie: Mmm...

Emil: Now you.

Effie: Okay...

Effie sent a picture of herself with both breasts showing, her shirt fully open, all buttons unfastened.

Effie: Am I helping?

Emil: You're starting to...

Effie: Show me! I wanna see :-P

The next image showed Emil from the waist down, the sheet pulled aside to reveal the guy's powerful legs—and his hand around an enormous, rock-hard cock.

Wow. Had the guy been this big when he'd been Effie's first lover?

Effie: I love it. I wish I could hold it for you :-P

Emil: I wish you could. I'm so hard for you, baby. Take off your jeans for me.

Now she sent her lover a picture of herself with her jeans pulled down her thighs.

Emil: You're driving me crazy, babe. Take them off!

Effie: I just love thinking how hard you are looking at me xxx

The next image showed her wearing her open shirt and a pair of yellow-and-white striped panties.

Emil: Big panties, huh?

Effie: I'm traveling! I wasn't planning on stripping for any gorgeous guys on my way. And anyway, they're not big, they're normal. You're just used to me wearing tiny panties.

Emil: Mmm... you look good in whatever.

Effie: Now something for me!

Jens watched as Emil sent her a close-up picture of his cock, which looked like a towering pillar of ebony, its tip glistening with pre-come.

Effie: No fair! You're getting me all wet, and my flight's in half an hour.

Emil: So take off your panties, babe.

Here was a picture of Effie standing up, her panties slid down past her hips to expose her mound, her triangle of pubic hair, but not her actual pussy itself. Her nipples were so stiff. She was seriously turned on.

Emil: Show it to me. Touch it.

Effie: I thought I was helping you to come.

Emil: We can help each other.

And here she was, wearing only her shirt, and that was only just on. Her cameraphone was held close to her sex, gazing up her body. Her pussy lips were in sharp focus, glistening with her wetness.

Emil: FaceTime?

Effie: Quickly. They're starting to board my flight...

Jens didn't have access to their FaceTime call, of course. But it was hot to think that they were on video chat, helping each other to come. Jens made himself come to the sight of that final image his wife had sent her boyfriend, and then afterward he was able to hop straight into the shower.

There were a few messages between Emil and Effie throughout the day, but Jens was thankful there was nothing to distract him from his work. Emil, at least, had to work a normal day, even if he had the occasional message from Effie updating him on her journey to Stockholm, settling into the hotel, a little lunch and then a nice walk across the Vasa bridge and around the old city.

Jens could get his head down and focus on developing Laursen's next big fragrance, which he had decided would be a refined, elegant scent to make a woman feel powerful, desired, worshipped. Its working title was *Goddess*.

That afternoon, he was asked to visit Old Mr Laursen's office once again, he assumed to give him an update on the development of *Goddess*—but his boss had news for him.

'Hot on the heels of Givenchy's interest, the other sharks are circling,' the old man said with no small measure of pride plastered across his face.

'Well, that's good, isn't it?' Jens said, wondering if the old man was still resolved to avoid selling his company.

‘Of course!’ Mr Laursen laughed loudly. ‘And now, my friend, you get to go on another little field trip—down to Milan this time.’

‘Oh, really?’ Jens’s stomach dropped. His nerves started tingling all over his body, and not in a good way. He had hoped not to repeat his visit to Givenchy in any shape or form.

‘Gucci. You’ll get to see their nice new HQ in Milan, and hopefully they’ll let you in on some of their work culture, you’ll get some more insight on how the big boys do it.’

Jens had nodded, agreed to do as the old man wished, but deep down he was somewhat horrified.

After work, he had returned home to do a monumental tidy and clean-up of the apartment. It didn’t really need it so much, but cleaning everything made him calm down, and kept out the dark thoughts that tormented him about the long journey to northern Italy, and all the strangers and unfamiliar places he would encounter along the way.

He showered, and when he still couldn’t keep his mind off things, he went up to try some forceful exercise in the gym.

Andrea was up there, using one of the elliptical machines, when he entered the gym.

At first, he thought perhaps Effie had engineered the blonde being here, as she had done so before, to make sure Jens was okay while she was away. But not only was his visit to the gym unplanned, entirely coincidental in fact, but the look of surprise on Andrea’s face when she caught sight of him was proof enough.

‘Hey, how are you?’

‘Good,’ he nodded. ‘Effie’s away on business again.’

‘Oh, yeah? You feeling okay? You look...troubled.’ Andrea stepped down from the machine. She was wearing a pair of dark blue leggings and a matching sports bra, her stomach left bare. Her flushed face and chest, and the perspiration on her skin suggested she’d been working out for a while.

‘Oh, no. I’m okay about her. My boss told me I have to go to Milan in a couple of weeks—’

‘Milan? You lucky thing!’

‘I’m not looking forward to it.’

She reached up to stroke his cheek, gently feeling sorry for his anxiety. ‘You’ll be okay, you know that, don’t you? You handled Paris okay...’

‘Paris. Paris was before she decided to hide her affair with Emil from me.’

‘Well, yeah,’ Andrea smiled. ‘So where’s Effie this time?’

‘Stockholm.’

‘And she’s with someone? Or on her own?’ she asked.

‘On her own,’ he smiled. ‘Her boyfriend has to wait for her, too, I guess.’

‘You know that for certain?’

He chuckled. ‘Look...’

He pulled his phone out of his pocket and opened the Messenger app, then showed her Effie’s conversation with Emil. Andrea’s eyes lit up.

‘Wow,’ she said. ‘You did good—how did you hack into her Facebook account?’

‘She lost her phone, and didn’t have time to get a new one before her trip, so we set up an old iPhone using my sim card.’

‘Oh, so she told you her new password?’ Andrea grinned, reading the messages between Effie and Emil. ‘Hmm... these guys don’t waste any time with the sexting, huh?’

He shook his head. ‘Because we used my sim card, when she downloaded the Facebook app and logged in, it saved the details to my

Apple account. And when you download a new app to one of your devices, it gets downloaded to your other devices, too, so...'

'So you have eyes on her messages to her boyfriend now! Way to go!' Andrea laughed.

The way she was standing next to him reading from his phone, arching her back, made it seem as though she was trying to get him to notice her cleavage. But his mind was on Effie, and it didn't help that Andrea was wearing the *Infidelity* perfume these days, which Effie wore as well.

But, there he was, looking down at her nicely pert breasts smuggled away in that sports bra, when the blonde looked up at him.

'I actually have a date tonight,' she said, her expression apologetic, as though she thought he might want to spend the evening with her.

'Really? That's good.'

She shrugged, 'He's just a guy from my university.'

'You like him?'

She laughed, 'I do, but he's a little... stuffy, maybe.'

'Stuffy?'

'I'm not sure he'd be on board with me seeing other guys as well, let's put it that way,' she grinned.

'I thought guys your age were supposed to be more... flexible. These days.'

Andrea laughed. 'The media would have you believe all millennials are all body-obsessed and pan-sexual, and will sleep with anyone with a pulse, right?'

Jens nodded.

'So you're going to talk to Effie later tonight?' she asked him.

'Uh-huh. I suppose so, when she's not talking to the other guy.'

'But now you get to see what they say to each other, don't you?' Andrea flashed him a wicked grin.

'I do,' he said.

‘Well, enjoy! I’ll see you later, huh?’

‘Enjoy your date.’

She kissed him on the cheek, and strangely enough he felt more attracted to her knowing she had a date that evening. Alone in the gym, Jens laughed at his own lunacy. Was this normal? Women were just more fascinating to him if they were seeing other guys as well.

He completed a full workout himself, and then returned home for another shower while he waited for pizza to be delivered. He monitored his phone fairly closely for any communications from Effie, or between Effie and Emil.

There was nothing until 9pm, and then Effie texted him.

Effie: Hey sweetie, how are you doing? The evening networking session is finally over—I’m so tired!

Jens smiled, feeling happy that she’d texted him first. He went onto FaceTime, and she accepted the call immediately.

‘Hey!’

‘Hey, honey, how was it?’ he asked her.

‘Good,’ she said, looking tired, though irresistible in her business suit, her long legs clad in dark nylon, her skirt showing a hint of thigh. ‘The evening networking session seemed to go on *forever*. I guess that’s what we do these things for more than the seminars, right?’

‘Right. So any hot guys at the event?’ he laughed.

Effie smiled warmly. ‘Well, I’m not sure. I guess I wasn’t really looking.’

God, it felt so strange to have this big elephant in the room that neither one of them could really talk about. She’s seeing another guy as well, and it was supposed to be a secret. Actually, it made the conversation feel slightly awkward, stilted. Jens didn’t like that.

‘How’s work going?’ she asked him.

He sighed. ‘They want me to go to Milan.’

‘Milan?’

‘Gucci. Would you believe it? After Givenchy came knocking, now there’s other fragrance companies looking at us, I guess. We’re small, easy to absorb,’ he said. ‘Maybe they’re thinking we’ll open the door for them more in the Nordic market.’

Effie smiled proudly. ‘They just want you, honey. Your talent.’

‘I don’t think they know who I am.’

‘They know your perfumes. They can’t fail to. They’re so amazing.’

‘Well,’ he nodded, ‘I guess the Old Man wants me to go along on the trip, see if I can get any hints from Gucci this time.’

‘Maybe they’ll offer you a job, we can move to Milan!’ Effie grinned. Jens wondered if she had any desire at all to move to another country. Milan was the fashion capital of the world, or one of them. But moving away from Denmark would be difficult for both of them.

‘Did you get something to eat?’ he asked her.

She shook her head. ‘Not really. I’ll probably get some room service sent up.’

‘That’s a good idea.’

‘Probably need to get to bed early.’

‘Yeah, you need some good sleep, right?’

She nodded. ‘Okay then. I’ll say good night, sweetie. I can’t wait to come home to you.’

‘Me too. Have a nice sleep, honey. I love you.’

‘Love you too.’

When she signed off, Jens felt strangely cold. Was she telling the truth, was she really tired? Or was she just giving him an excuse so she could chat with Emil instead? He was the new toy now, of course. Part of Jens felt the prickle of sexual desire from thinking about his wife wanting to go online and flirt and sext with the other guy, but part of him felt a touch of

melancholy over being, essentially, rejected. That wasn't how it was supposed to be.

But, you had to take the rough with the smooth. He had to accept there were risks and rewards to anything, especially this. Sometimes, he would feel like he was missing out.

Jens sat on the couch in the living room and watched his phone as much as the television.

Almost immediately, there were messages appearing on the Facebook Messenger app.

Effie: Hey gorgeous! I'm back from that networking thing. You around?

Emil: Certainly am. FaceTime?

Effie: Sure. Sounds good xxx

But then, to Jens's dismay, it all stopped.

They had gone onto FaceTime to talk. And to do whatever they were doing. That was all Jens was going to see of their interaction.

Jens sighed. His wife's affair was not going as well for him as he'd hoped. He had overlooked the lack of information from her. And the fact was, most of the time, she was too good at hiding her affair from him.

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FOURTEEN

GUILT

He woke up because there was a knocking on the front door. It took him a few moments to work out what the noise was, sleep apparently robbing him of his IQ. Then, he grabbed a bathrobe and dashed for the door. His first thought, confused and with logic stolen by fatigue, was that it was Effie, back unexpectedly early from Stockholm because something bad had happened at her conference.

Only as he unlocked the front door did he pause and figure that there was no way she could get back to Copenhagen in the middle of the night.

‘Finally!’

It was Andrea. She was wearing a white button-down shirt and pale blue jeans, and the shirt was see-through enough to see that she was wearing a black bra underneath.

‘Andrea,’ he said, holding the door for her.

‘I just thought I’d see how you were,’ she said, all smiley and bubbly.

‘I was asleep.’

‘I’m so sorry...’

‘Never mind. I’m awake now.’

He caught the smell of alcohol on her as she came in, above and beyond the remains of her *Infidelity*, and it reminded him that she’d been intending to go on a date that evening.

‘How was your date?’ he asked her.

‘It was fun,’ she grinned, walking into the apartment, slowly past the kitchen area to the living room.

‘Even though your date was a bit stuffy?’

She giggled. ‘I think I might have been a little wrong about him.’

‘So he’s actually a tiger in bed, huh?’ Jens joked, but as she sat on the couch, Jens did feel more of an attraction toward her than he could ever remember. His head was filling with questions about what she’d been up to all evening. *How far had her date gone? Had she slept with the guy?* He fetched some chilled white wine from the fridge, and two wine glasses.

She said, ‘I just figured that I’d met this guy on Tinder, you know? So if I told him the truth, and he wanted to leave the restaurant, what would I have lost? Nothing much? Right? I just go on Tinder, find another date.’

‘So you told him what, that you could never settle for one single guy?’

She giggled. ‘Uh-huh. Something like that.’

‘And how did he feel about that?’ Jens sat on the couch next to her, and put the two glasses down on the coffee table to pour them both some wine.

‘At first, I think he was surprised, but he tried to hide it. He asked me all these questions—did I have a boyfriend already, did I cheat on guys? Did I tell other guys I was with that I was dating him? That kind of thing. I guess he was genuinely interested.’

‘He probably never dated somebody like you.’

‘I guess we had a drink or two, and things calmed down, food came, and I found out a little about him, he found out a little about me. And then when it got later, he was back to asking me about my dating life, my sex life.’

‘What did you tell him?’

‘Well... you know... that I like seeing various people. I don’t like to pin myself down.’

‘And he was horrified?’

‘Not really. I think, maybe, he got used to the idea. He was asking me these intimate questions... so I started asking him intimate questions...’

‘Like what?’

‘Like, who was the last person he slept with; what’s the craziest thing he’s ever done, sexually; has he got a nice cock...’

Jens laughed. ‘Has he got a nice cock?’

‘I was getting a little drunk by then.’

‘And what did he tell you?’

‘He told me he slept with his first and only girlfriend last year, and nothing since, he once had sex with her in an elevator... and he said he never had any complaints before about his cock.’

‘But only one person ever saw it,’ Jens pointed out.

Andrea flicked her eyes away briefly and giggled. ‘Well, now two people have...’

‘You *did*?’

They both laughed.

‘So are you going to see him again?’ Jens asked her.

‘Next weekend,’ she grinned.

‘Even though you told him you see other guys as well?’

She shrugged, ‘He told me he wants to challenge his preconceptions, you know? I think maybe he’s secretly like you.’

‘Like me?’

‘You know, he likes sharing.’ She laughed. Then, ‘Hey, but what about you? I came here to find out what happened with Effie.’

‘Nothing much,’ Jens admitted.

‘No?’

‘We chatted a little, said goodnight. She said she was tired. Then she messaged Emil and asked if he wanted to go on FaceTime.’

‘And you didn’t watch them on FaceTime?’

He shook his head. ‘I don’t have access to her FaceTime calls.’

Andrea sighed on his behalf. 'And they'd probably know if you were connected on their call as well,' she nodded. 'Oh, that sucks.'

'Yes.'

'But you know they're doing something, though, don't you? Doesn't that make you feel... at least a little... something?'

Jens shrugged. 'I suppose so. It's nice knowing she's having fun, she's... you know...'

'*Cheating* on you.' The cheerful blonde seemed to try the words out on him, to see how he reacted to it. He simply smiled and shrugged, trying not to feel downhearted. It was exciting, still, this feeling of being cheated on. It wasn't quite the same as it had been, somehow.

Andrea said, 'Maybe it feels a little more real now, right? Because she's really hiding it from you. Not letting you find out what's going on.'

'Maybe.'

'Do you feel different? Jealous?'

He sighed. 'Not really jealous. Well, maybe a little. It's still kind of exciting, but in a slightly different way. I can't really explain it, but somehow it's more... serious.'

'You're still okay with her doing it?'

He thought. And considered how it would be if he put his foot down and stopped it all. 'I still want her to do it,' he said. 'It does make me want her even more, I suppose. It's just... there's a little more angst to go along with it.'

'But, you know, on the bright side, maybe after Emil... she'll be more comfortable with dating other guys so that she can share all the details.'

'Maybe,' I agreed.

'Hey, can I use your bathroom?'

'Sure.'

He waited, and his mind turned to Andrea. He wondered if she was going to spend the night. It would be nice to have company, for sure.

Should he feel guilty, because he hadn't told Effie about Andrea spending the night? But then perhaps Effie already knew. Effie had asked Andrea to distract him from her absence before.

The blonde re-emerged from the bathroom minus her jeans.

Jens said, 'You forget something?' and smiled.

Andrea walked over toward him, toying with the hem of her shirt to give him little glimpses of her black panties beneath.

'I thought you needed to take your mind off things with Effie for a bit,' she said, standing in front of him, shaking her hips a little, playfully.

'I'm not sure...' he said. 'I mean, I didn't tell Effie...'

Andrea tilted her head. 'You know she's okay with you seeing me, right? I mean, she told me she likes me checking up on you when she's gone...'

He nodded. She started unfastening buttons on her shirt, revealing more of her lacy black bra.

'You wear this outfit on your date tonight?' Jens asked her.

'Apart from this shirt,' she said, turning around, lifting her shirt to give him a full view of the black lace thong hanging nicely on her shapely derriere. 'The shirt is his.'

'His?'

'He was wearing this. I stole it after he got come all over my top.'

'He got *come all over it*?' Jens laughed.

'I told you, didn't I?' she said, turning toward him again, slowly stroking herself all over. 'Our date went surprisingly well. By the end of it, he was desperate to sleep with me.'

She pushed him back on the couch and climbed onto his lap, pushing herself down on the hardness inside his boxer shorts as she unfastened the buttons on her shirt—or, her date's shirt.

Jens kissed her soft, warm skin just below her bra, and the shirt fell around his head. He kissed her, and he breathed in the smell of her body, of

her date's shirt, of the sex she'd had with him earlier that night.

'What's his name, your date?' he asked.

'Johan.'

'He wears the new YSL Eau De Parfum.'

Andrea giggled. 'You're amazing, you know that?'

She pulled herself off his lap and turned around, lifting her shirt to show off her hips and her behind, before bending over slightly, shaking her tushy at him cheekily. Jens reached out to touch her, gently cupping her buttocks, before she dropped, sitting in his lap but facing away from him as she ground herself down against his hardness again.

'You must have been pretty amazing to get a guy like that into bed,' he said, pulling her against him, leaning in to kiss her neck, while reaching to unfasten the rest of her shirt buttons.

'Mmm...' she moaned. 'I told him about this married guy I see sometimes... who likes to share his wife with other men...'

'You did?'

She giggled and stood up to remove her shirt before dropping down to wiggle her butt against his crotch like a professional performing a lap dance. 'He'd never heard anything like it,' she said.

'Really? He really was an innocent.'

'Oh, he'd heard about swingers, you know?' she rubbed her pussy against his shaft, and he felt the heat of her body even through her panties and his boxers. 'But he always thought that kind of thing was about the guy getting to sleep with other women.'

'Oh, okay.'

'He never realized guys could enjoy the part about their partners being with other men.'

Andrea turned around and climbed onto his lap, this time facing him, kneeling up to press her chest up against his face. He inhaled a chestful of

her sweet, musky scent, shivering slightly as he registered that wicked piquancy of sex gone by.

‘Do you have a secret life as an exotic dancer?’ he asked her.

She grinned, ‘You’d probably like that, wouldn’t you? Sorry to disappoint... I just learned a few things from porn...’

She lifted one knee, above his shoulder, and now he could press his lips to her stomach, just below her navel and just above the waistband of her panties, and the smell of sex on her body grew stronger. She sighed as he tasted her skin, his hands fondling her behind.

‘So how long are you going to let Effie see her ex?’ she asked him.

‘Tonight?’

‘No, I mean for the whole thing. You guys never set a limit for how long she gets to date him?’

‘Not really,’ he said.

She slid her knee back down again, and now kissed his mouth lightly, and it gently thrilled him that he could tell based on his experience with his wife that the blonde had gone down on Johan earlier that night.

‘But there must come a time when you’ll get tired of not knowing? You’ll want her to tell you everything?’

‘Maybe,’ he said, slipping her bra down to expose her breasts, before kissing his way down between them. ‘But for now, I’m getting to find out a few things...’

‘Do you think she pulled that trick with her phone so you *could* find out a few things?’ she asked, and now slowly slid down his body, trailing herself all over him as she dropped, gradually, to her knees on the floor between his legs.

‘I suppose she could have done that,’ he said, enjoying the feel of her hands on his crotch, pressing at his hardness, exploring the shape of his erection through his underwear.

‘I’ll bet she did,’ she grinned.

‘It’s a shame she didn’t let me have access to her FaceTime calls,’ he chuckled.

Andrea pulled away, then stood to remove her bra with the same grace that made him feel she’d had some secret career at some classy gentleman’s club somewhere deep in the middle of the city.

‘You know,’ she said, ‘you should be a bit more proactive.’

‘Like how?’

‘I don’t know...’ she perched on the edge of the coffee table, fondling her breasts as she glanced around the room. ‘You know she’s going to bring him here, right? When you’re in Milan.’

‘I suppose she will.’

Andrea’s hands dropped between her legs, and she stroked herself as she seemed to examine the apartment. ‘You should get some cameras,’ she said.

‘Cameras?’

‘You can get some really discreet ones nowadays,’ she said. ‘You know, hide them around here so you can watch what happens when you’re away...’ She moved back to him, slowly sliding over him again, rubbing her body against his before moving up for another kiss on the mouth.

‘Are you really a spy?’ he asked her.

‘No,’ she giggled, and pulled his bathrobe off his shoulders to leave him in only his boxer shorts. ‘I told you before, I like people to watch me, didn’t I?’

‘Uh-huh.’

She dropped slowly to her knees again, and this time she reached up to grab the waist of his underwear, and peel it down, kissing his abdomen as she went, gradually exposing his stiff cock.

‘I can show you how to do it,’ she said, brushing her long, blonde hair back over her shoulder before ducking down to lick his shaft from base to tip.

‘How to do it?’

She smiled, and kissed the tip of his cock. ‘We’ll set up some secret cameras, and then you won’t miss a thing.’

He moaned as she took his manhood inside her hot mouth, her hands playing with his balls and the base of his cock while she sucked on him.

‘Mmm... you like the sound of that, huh?’ she said. ‘Watching your wife with her ex?’

He did like the sound of it, but as the pretty blonde bobbed down on his cock, he also liked the thought that she had done this with another guy already tonight. It made him feel strange, and it also made him feel guilty. Before tonight, Andrea had merely been a little gift that Effie had presented to him, someone to add variety to their sex, to take his mind off her business trips, and someone to test her own feelings about his being with other people. Jens had only ever seen her as a distraction from the main event, his wife.

But now, he found himself wanting this little sex kitten like never before. The thought of her dating someone else tonight had somehow opened his eyes to Andrea as more than just a toy.

‘What?’ she asked with a puzzled smile. She must have seen him pondering her while he watched her going down on him.

‘I just... I guess I feel a little guilty,’ he said, hiding the true extent of how he really felt, perhaps because he couldn’t get his head around it himself.

‘Don’t!’ she laughed. ‘You know Effie asked me to keep an eye on you when she’s away.’

‘Yeah, but...’

‘No ‘but’s, mister.’ She pulled away, and sat back on the edge of the coffee table again. ‘She’s okay with me taking care of you. Just like this.’ She gestured for him to stand up, and to give her his dick again.

He moaned as he fed her his cock, and held her head carefully, so that it was more like fucking her face now. She seemed to like it that way, judging by her own moans.

But he wanted more than just her mouth on his cock. And wanting her like that made him feel more than just guilt about having sex with her without Effie's express knowledge.

Did he have feelings for her? Was this a line being crossed, in the same way that Effie was in danger of crossing a line with Emil, because she clearly still had feelings for him?

Jens pulled out of her mouth before she could make him come too early, and now he had her lie back, on the coffee table, as he kissed his way down over her chest and her stomach. He told himself it was only because Andrea was riding his particular kink just now, that it was only because she'd told him she'd been with another man that night that it made him feel more desire toward her. It wasn't feelings, it was just that Andrea keyed-in to his particular fetish.

The smell of sex on her body was strong as he kissed his way to the edge of her panties, and it was exhilarating for him. Peeling off her underwear, that wicked scent grew stronger still, and the giddy, fierce craving he now felt for her helped him to resolve his guilt, at least in part. *This was only because he was so turned on by promiscuous women, by sharing a lover.*

She lay out on the coffee table—hardly the most comfortable piece of furniture to lie on, but at least it was fairly robust—and he knelt down to part her legs and kiss her just above her glistening pussy.

Her little giggle as he touched her there soon turned into a low moan as he sucked on her sex, tonguing her pink pussy lips, flicking her clit gently.

He loved the noises she made as he ate her—the gasps, the sighs, the little cries. The 'Ooooh... yes...'

She dragged him to the bedroom when she was about ready to come, so she could straddle him and ride his cock that final furlong, until she was yelling and screaming out, her body shivering over him as the orgasm took her.

They fell asleep, but Jens woke up shortly afterward, feeling troubled.

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FIFTEEN

MILAN

‘**T**roubled? But you know your wife is okay with you seeing Andrea,’ the therapist said.

‘It’s not so much the fact that I was seeing her,’ he said. ‘It was... what I was feeling when I was with her.’

‘You feel like you’re falling for her?’

‘I don’t know if it’s love, or what. But, you know, it’s not just sex with her anymore. I feel good about myself after I’ve been with her. I look forward to seeing her again.’

‘That could just be friendship. With benefits.’ There was a twinkle in the therapist’s eye.

He just stared out of the window, across Israel Plads and the rooftops of the old city.

‘You’re feeling guilt,’ the therapist said. ‘Even though your wife’s always been fine about you seeing Andrea, you feel guilty because your feelings for her have developed. It’s only natural for your feelings to develop for someone after seeing them so much.’

‘But it was only ever meant to be sex.’

‘You think it’s only about sex between your wife and Emil?’

‘I... I don’t know...’

Jens was almost too frightened to think about that question.

Milan.

Once again, it was Jens and the Old Man's son, William Laursen, flying out to effectively spy on another company. It was slightly easier this second time around—he knew William a little better, so it was less frightening having a familiar face along for the ride. And, having been through Givenchy's corporate courtship, the two of them also knew a little more about what to expect from the Italian fragrance and fashion house in terms of the presentations and facility tours.

Gucci showed them the company's new headquarters in Milan, a converted aircraft factory that now housed offices, a showroom, a fashion runway and a restaurant. Then there were tours out of town, where some of the firm's laboratories and manufacturing facilities were located.

After being questioned about his Givenchy visit, Jens also had a better idea what kinds of things Old Man Laursen was interested in, so it helped him to pay attention to certain aspects of Gucci during the tours.

Back in the hotel that first night after a lavish dinner with the people from Gucci, he was tired and it actually felt good to get some alone time. He was able to keep the thoughts about being so far away from Effie at bay by opening up his laptop and logging into the webcam application that would allow him to look directly into their apartment in Copenhagen.

Thinking about her being with Emil gave him a nice warm feeling of arousal as he waited for something to happen in the apartment, so long as he didn't think too much about whether his wife was getting too close with him, and falling for him in a serious way.

It got to 10pm, 11pm, and there was no sign of Effie, let alone Effie and Emil, in their apartment. Jens was starting to feel a little alone, a little anxious. He could believe that she might go back with Emil to spend the

night at his place, but wasn't this week the opportunity for them to sleep over at Effie's place?

He wondered what Andrea was up to that evening, but didn't want to text her out of feelings of guilt.

As the night wore on, he started to think that it was strange Effie hadn't even called him that evening. She knew he hated these business trips, she knew it freaked him out coming to a strange country, to a strange city, to meet so many people he'd never met before.

Hadn't she started seeing Emil as a way to provide Jens with some distraction on the Paris trip? So how come she wasn't even going to give him a little hint now that he'd flown to Milan?

The thoughts made him feel terrible. He knew it was mostly paranoia that made him feel so awful, the sense that he was losing Effie. Anxiety, depression—part of the problem was a chemical imbalance inside his head, he knew that. He tried to think happy thoughts, to blank out the bad thoughts.

He sat on the floor to meditate, sitting cross-legged as he tried to empty his head of any thought. Concentrate on breathing. In... out... in... out... Every time his thoughts took him away from focusing on the breathing, he brought his attention back to slow, calm inhaling and exhaling. He found himself gazing at the suitcase, something he figured wouldn't start inspiring any ideas or thoughts—but after a while he noticed a lump in one of the pockets, and believing there was something he had failed to unpack and put away in its proper place the moment he had arrived in the room, he had to get up and investigate.

It was a phone. An iPhone. And of course, he recognized the floral case—this was Effie's lost phone.

Had she lost it while she had been packing her things for her Stockholm trip? It could have slipped into this pocket while she was packing. It just seemed odd for her to lose it in a place like this.

Jens tried to turn it on, but of course the battery was long dead. He did have an iPhone charger, though, and perhaps when he told Effie that he'd found her old phone, she'd want to know whether it still worked—even if she had replaced it with a new one by now. He plugged it in, and the phone displayed the battery symbol briefly to confirm it was being charged.

It took a few minutes before the phone had enough charge to switch on. And when it did, the phone switched on fully—there was no demand for a passcode.

Jens caught his breath. Why had Effie taken the passcode off her phone? He swiped the screen, and it all seemed normal from what he remembered of her phone. He figured, either she had removed the code because she trusted that he wouldn't sneak a look at her phone—although, why she would trust him like that was debatable, since she had to know he was going to look for evidence of her affair wherever he could find it—or she had deleted anything on the phone that could be incriminating.

But here, as he dipped into her text message app, were messages between her and Emil. The latest messages confirmed that the two of them were going out for dinner that very evening, in a classy restaurant somewhere north of Copenhagen. No wonder she was unable to FaceTime with Jens that evening. Somehow, that made Jens feel better.

Scrolling back, most of Effie's text messages to Emil were merely functional recently—confirming dates, agreeing where to meet, what they might do during their date nights. Had they gotten to a new phase of their relationship where they didn't need to send flirty text messages every other hour?

Jens dipped into Effie's photo app—and struck gold.

Here, among various boring selfies with various friends, were some racy pictures that she had taken in the mirror for Emil. And some pictures he had taken for her.

And here, Jens found video.

His cock stiffened, quite suddenly.

Jesus.

The first one showed Effie in someone's bathroom—either Emil's, or that of a hotel room—wearing only a pair of lacy white panties and a tank top that left her midriff bare and her stiff nipples obvious. She seemed to be doing her makeup in front of the mirror, and checking out her hair.

When she laid eyes on whoever was behind the camera—presumably Emil—she didn't look too pleased.

'What are you doing, videoing me?' she demanded to know.

'Uh-huh. You are one foxy chick,' replied a male voice, Emil.

'You can't make a video,' she said, facing him, but now her nipples straining against the thin tank top were even more obvious, and she was doing nothing to try to hide herself from the camera.

'Why not?'

She folded her arms in front of her chest, but without actually covering anything up. 'Because some day, no doubt, it'll get leaked out to the Internet, and then everyone in the street will recognize me from that dirty video that went viral.'

'It won't ever get leaked,' Emil said. 'Don't you know guys can get jailed for doing that nowadays? It's called 'revenge porn'.'

'Why do you even need to video me, if you can have me practically whenever you want?'

'Because sometimes I can't see you. When hubby's around. When you go on those business trips. So this way, I get to see you then, too.'

She sighed, but with the kind of smile that suggested he was persuading her. Her nipples made it seem as though she was secretly turned on.

'The truth is,' she said, 'You're just a pervert, aren't you?'

'Uh-huh,' Emil said with a chuckle. 'I am a pervert. I like looking at sexy women without any clothes on.'

'I have clothes on.'

‘Well, hopefully soon you won’t.’

‘Aren’t we going out to dinner tonight?’

‘Or we could stay in. Make a sexy video.’

She signed, rolled her eyes. ‘Okay. What do you want me to do?’

‘Turn around. Give me a spin...’

‘Okay...’

She turned, slowly, showing off her body to him. From the rear, her panties appeared sheer.

‘Bend over,’ Emil directed her. ‘Why don’t you lose the clothes?’

She shook her head. ‘Well now you’re just treating me like a piece of meat.’

‘Lose the clothes... *please?*’

Another eye roll, but you could tell Effie was getting into this. She brushed her hair back over her shoulder, turned around to face away from the camera again, then slowly peeled her panties down, exposing her beautifully shaped derriere.

‘Mmm... just like that,’ her director said.

She wiggled her butt a little, massaging and fondling her cheeks, teasing the camera. Then she dropped her panties the rest of the way.

The camera roamed all over her body, as she turned back to face him again and ask what he wanted her to do.

‘Here,’ he said, and at first Jens couldn’t figure out what was going on.

Then Jens watched as his wife got down to her knees, and then there was a large, stiff cock in her hands—and quickly in her mouth. She gazed at the camera as she sucked on that huge thing, and the twinkle in her eye made it seem almost to Jens as though she was thinking about the possibility of her husband one day watching this video.

She was smiling as she took him like that, breaking off briefly to say, ‘If you leak this on the Internet, you know I’ll kill you, right?’

‘Uh-huh.’ Emil replied, too distracted by her mouth on his cock to really show that he cared.

Jens watched his wife quietly moan as she sucked on her ex-boyfriend’s cock, and he found himself wondering if she’d totally set this up so that he could watch this. Faked losing her phone, and everything.

‘Mmm... that’s so good,’ Emil whispered.

‘Hmm... yeah?’ Effie giggled. ‘So are you going to video us fucking?’

‘God yeah.’

Jens watched his wife get up from the floor, and then she was directing Emil back onto the bed so that she could sit on his lap, facing away from him, steering his cock between the perfect orbs of her behind, and into her soaking pussy.

‘Oh my God...’ she moaned as she slid down on him.

Emil moved the camera back to see her face, apparently delighted to have him inside her, and then he zoomed in on his cock entering her as she bounced up and down on him.

‘Oh...yeah... fuck yeah... oh my God...’

After a while, she pulled away from him, and Jens watched her lay back on the bed, spreading her legs for Emil. He penetrated her, and then started to fuck her missionary-style, but his camera action soon fell into chaos as his attention was totally focused on fucking Effie. After a while, the video just cut to black.

Now Jens found himself looking among Effie’s photos for more videos.

Here was another one. Effie lay on her back along a long white couch, naked apart from a thong, Emil kneeling at her feet, peeling off her remaining underwear before going down on her. Perhaps learning from the previous production, for this one the camera was clearly set up on a surface nearby to video them without interference. The camera had been set up a little too far away to see much in detail, but it was still heart-stompingly

thrilling for Jens to watch the big, powerful frame of Emil preparing Effie with his mouth before moving up to slide his cock inside her.

On this video, there was a lot more kissing and slow affection caught between bouts of more energetic fucking. Jens didn't like to think of it as lovemaking, but toward the end, with Effie draped all over him, riding his cock slowly, it seemed more like lovemaking than fucking. He wasn't sure if he liked it like that so much. The jealousy got a little unwieldy.

Here was another video. This time, the camera was set up at the head of Emil's bed, giving a view down the mattress and some of the man's apartment, which seemed relatively small and quite untidy. The video started with Effie already on top of her boyfriend, riding him. Both of them were naked. Effie had her eyes closed and her mouth open, clearly in ecstasy as she fucked him.

After a while, she sat up to ride Emil, and offered a much better view of her beautiful body, her breasts, her stiff nipples, as she continued to ride him.

Several minutes later, the camera was picked up and shaken about a little, before settling to see Effie lying on the bed, Emil apparently straddling her chest, feeding his cock to her. She pumped him with one hand, and occasionally sucked on him, while he concentrated on holding the camera vaguely still.

When Emil took his cock back in his spare hand, pumping it over her himself, Jens watched as another man came all over his wife's face, spurting white cream over her cheeks, her lips, her nose, and into her open mouth.

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HOPEFULLY NOTHING

The second day, Jens got profuse apologies from Effie about not calling him the night before. She'd been out with her friends from high school, including people she hadn't seen for years. Things had gotten very drunk, and she'd gotten home much later than she meant to, and was too drunk to even remember to call.

Jens waved it all off with a 'no problem' text message. Even though it had been a lie—sure, it was possible she was out with friends from high school; Emil was a friend from high school; but Jens knew for a fact she didn't make it back to their apartment that night, drunk or otherwise.

But that was par for the course, wasn't it? She was supposed to be having an affair.

Cheating is all about lying.

The second night, Effie did call Jens on FaceTime after he returned from another nice dinner with the people from Gucci. It was very nice to see her, and how cheerful she was, despite the fact that she told him she'd had a normal day at work, and was so tired she was going to get an early night as soon as they were done with the call.

'So how was the tour today?'

'Oh, they offered me a job,' he said, feeling a little gloomy.

'Of course they did—they know what you're worth to Laursen's.'

‘But it would mean moving to Milan, so.’

‘Do you think you could use it as leverage with your boss? With Old Mr Laursen?’

Jens smiled. ‘I doubt it.’ Maybe normal people could do something like that, but Jens could never tell Old Mr Laursen what Gucci had offered, and certainly could never do it with a view to trying to persuade the old man to give him a raise.

Effie sighed. ‘Well, you like your job in Copenhagen, honey. We do okay.’

‘We do,’ he nodded.

But when Effie wished him a good night, and blew him a kiss, it felt different than it had when he’d been in Paris. He felt like she was rushing to get rid of him so she could spend the rest of the night with Emil. He felt like Clifford compared to Lady Chatterley’s lover, Mellors. The unwanted third party in this relationship.

And when the FaceTime call was over, he was able to switch to the webcam feed and watch, in startlingly detailed high-resolution, his wife decidedly not settling down for an early night.

He watched her in the bedroom stripping off her work clothes in front of the mirror, before taking fancy lingerie out of her bottom drawer, putting on a black and crimson lace suspender belt, black thigh-high stockings, outrageously high-heeled black shoes, then a bra and panties that matched her suspender belt.

She was having an affair. She was cheating. Of course she’d lie about what she was planning for the evening. Especially when it was an evening of sex with Emil.

He watched her spending extra time getting her makeup just right, splashing on *Infidelity*—her husband’s fragrance, which made any male putty in her hands. She was really looking forward to Emil coming over. She really hadn’t bothered to talk with Jens for long on that FaceTime call.

He sighed.

But then, to his surprise, FaceTime started bleeping at him again. He nearly clicked on the red decline button without even glancing at who it was calling him at such a time—but then he saw it was Andrea. Well, he felt less guilt about talking to Andrea now, since Effie was so much more bothered by Emil.

‘Hey, how’s it going?’ he said after clicking the ‘accept’ button.

‘Jens, my man!’ the pretty blonde chirped cheerfully. ‘Is it working?’

‘The cameras?’ he asked her.

‘Of course the cameras! What did you think I meant? Her birth control?’ Andrea giggled, before adding, ‘I’m sorry, that was uncalled for.’

Jens said, ‘The cameras are working fine. I’m watching her getting ready for another date, right now.’

‘Getting ready for a date? It’s late for getting ready for a date,’ Andrea said, and since it was already 9pm, she had a point. ‘So it’s a booty call she’s getting ready for?’

‘I guess so.’

‘What’s she wearing?’

‘Black and crimson lingerie. Suspenders. Stockings. The whole deal.’

‘Wow. Special night. You’re going to watch the whole thing?’

‘Not sure. As much as I feel like it. Assuming Effie’s not going out to his place.’

But Jens could see Effie in her sexy lingerie going around the apartment with a duster, checking all surfaces for even a hint of dust. There was no doubt Emil would be coming here tonight.

‘Can I watch with you?’ Andrea asked.

‘Sure.’

They set the system up so that Andrea could log in to watch the webcams as well, from where she was in her apartment in Copenhagen.

‘I like her clothes,’ the blonde said. ‘Very sexy.’

‘You should buy some like that to wear for Johan.’

‘I should. We should set up spy cameras in my apartment, too, then you could watch me with Johan.’

‘We should,’ Jens said, and he meant to say it like a throwaway line, that didn’t mean anything. Except that he did like the idea of getting to see Andrea with her date. That kind of feeling crossed the line for him, into the realms of guilt.

But now, there was a knock on Effie’s front door, which she went to answer wearing only her sexy lingerie. Here was Emil, wearing a smart purple shirt and black pants.

‘Hi,’ Effie said. Jens was impressed by the quality of the tiny microphones built into their spy cameras.

‘Don’t you look gorgeous,’ Emil said in his deep voice.

He was holding something in his hands, but from the nearest camera in the living room, Jens couldn’t see what it was. He reached up to put it on Effie. A necklace?

‘You’re going to me my beautiful pet tonight,’ Emil said, and they heard Effie catch her breath. ‘Does that sound good?’

‘Yes,’ she said. It seemed to be taking an age for Emil to fasten the necklace around her neck.

‘You say ‘yes, sir’.’

‘Yes sir.’

Now it was Jens’s turn to catch his breath. Effie took a step back inside the apartment, and he could see that it wasn’t a necklace—it was a black leather collar around her neck, with stainless steel studs around it. And Emil had a leash connected to it.

‘You’re going to do whatever I tell you tonight.’

‘Yes, sir.’

‘Down on all fours,’ Emil said. Effie did as he told her, going down onto her hands and knees as though she was an animal—as though she

really was his pet.

The front door was still open. Jens felt tense. What if one of their neighbors walked by? Old Mrs Pollitt would have a heart attack if she happened by and caught sight of Effie in lingerie being led into her own apartment by the powerfully-built Emil.

‘Wow,’ Andrea said. ‘Kinky, huh.’

As they watched Emil walk Effie into the apartment, Jens felt a growing sense of unease. Was Effie okay? She trusted Emil, didn’t she? But the thought of a man controlling her like this... it brought back fears of what happened with Viggo.

‘You think she’s all right?’ Jens asked Andrea.

Emil was walking Effie around the living room as though testing out their new power balance.

‘She’s loving it,’ Andrea said.

Jens said, ‘But you don’t think... I mean, after what happened with—’

Andrea said, ‘No, I think they’re all right. I think Emil’s doing it properly.’

Emil had Effie stand over by the windows. She did as he told her, standing all prim and proper as though on military parade, awaiting further instruction.

‘Properly?’

‘He’s dominating her, but she’s consented to it. And she knows she can stop it any time she wants to.’

‘If she gets in real trouble...’

‘I can go down and knock on their door,’ Andrea said. Jens didn’t like how she said ‘their’ door.

They watched Emil inspecting her—touching her, here and there, as he gazed on her body; tugging on her underwear, snapping the elastic in her panties. Giving her ass a playful little swat.

‘Is this how you like doing it?’ Jens asked Andrea.

‘Not so much,’ she said. ‘I’d prefer the other way around.’

‘What, with Johan wearing the sexy lingerie?’

The blonde laughed. ‘Maybe not the lingerie. But he’d be on the floor doing whatever I tell him. Or maybe you would.’

Jens chuckled, but he felt a slight throbbing in his hard dick at the thought of Andrea telling him what to do in the bedroom.

They watched Emil let go of Effie’s leash, and then went to sit over on the couch. He ordered her over to him, and she crawled slowly, on all fours, across the carpet toward him.

‘Good girl,’ Emil said as she arrived in front of him. ‘Now why don’t you unzip my pants?’

‘Yes, sir.’

Effie seemed honored to have been chosen to put her hands all over Emil’s crotch, and now worked on unfastening his fly. Next he told her to pull his cock out of his pants, which she did so eagerly. He told her to stroke his cock a while, and she was only too happy to do so.

‘Would you like to suck my cock?’

‘Oh, yes, please, sir.’

She moaned, and took his cock into her mouth, and it seemed like she was the one being pleased, rather than him. Emil sat still, holding her leash, watching her imperiously as she bobbed up and down on his exposed cock.

‘I don’t know...’ Andrea said, ‘Maybe I’d try it with the right guy.’

‘Oh yeah?’ Jens chuckled.

‘I just think every time someone else told me what to do, I’d want to call it quits on the whole thing.’

They watched Emil tell her to kneel up, and then he stood up and pushed her bra down, pulling her breasts free of it. He started slowly stroking the tip of his cock all around her face, as though marking her as his

territory. Then he slid it between her lips, and for a while was fucking her mouth.

‘He *does* have a nice cock,’ Andrea said. Then, when Jens didn’t say anything, she added, ‘I’m not saying I like it more than *yours*...’

After that, Emil led Effie into the bedroom, showering her with praise for her oral skills, before telling her to lay down on the bed and begin touching herself. He stood back and watched her running her hands all over her body, before slipping her panties aside to begin stroking her pussy.

He had her remove her bra, and move closer, to the edge of the bed, while continuing to masturbate in front of him. The guy removed his necktie and started swatting her with it while she grew increasingly frantic in the stroking of her pussy. Jens didn’t like that, but it was clear the guy wasn’t hurting her.

‘You like that?’ he kept saying to her.

Then, apparently just before an orgasm hit, he ordered her to stop.

‘You want me to make you come?’ he asked her, and swatted her sex with his tie.

‘Yes, sir.’

‘You really want me to make you come?’

‘Oh, yes, *please* sir...’

Emil knelt down in front of her, pulled her by the hips closer toward him, tugged her panties further out of the way of her soaking pussy, and now ducked down to flick his tongue over her sensitive flesh. Jens quietly stroked his hardness as he watched his wife start panting, tilting her head back as her first love ate her.

‘Are you touching yourself right now?’ Andrea’s voice cut through the air.

Jens smiled. Her presence was comforting, somehow—cutting out some of the sense of isolation and loneliness he felt—and yet sometimes she was distracting from the main event.

‘I suppose so,’ he answered truthfully.

‘Me too. See?’

He watched the FaceTime window on his computer screen as Andrea tilted her webcam away from her head and shoulders, and down toward her lap. She was wearing a gray sports bra and leggings, as though she’d come straight from the gym. After a few moments and the webcam coming back into focus, he saw that there was a large wet spot in her leggings. Her hand was buried inside, strumming against her sex.

‘You know you’re so good at licking pussy, Jens,’ Andrea said, completely out of the blue as they watched Emil servicing Effie with his mouth.

‘It’s why she’ll never leave you,’ she added. Then, ‘Show me yours! Show me yours!’

‘My camera’s built-in,’ he said. ‘If I move it, I won’t be able to see what’s on screen.’

‘Party-pooper.’

On screen, Emil lifted Effie’s hips so that he could pull her panties off her. But then he stuffed the panties into Effie’s mouth before resuming his oral onslaught on her pussy.

‘Kinky,’ Andrea commented. ‘You know, you’re so good, that when other guys go down on me... I imagine you’re doing it.’

That made Jens chuckle.

‘I’m not bullshitting!’ she insisted. ‘I think of you when I watch porn stars doing it.’

Emil was using his fingers on Effie, working her into quite a state, though her cries and yells were muffled by the underwear stuffed into her mouth. It was still a huge turn-on to watch her being so fulfilled. But Jens was beginning to feel a little more jealous than before, that it was Emil making her feel this way.

Was it getting to the stage where he would have to call a halt to this particular adventure?

On screen, Emil ordered Effie to touch herself again, while he watched her and stripped. Then he held her by the leash and slid his big, hard cock inside her dripping-wet pussy. She was soon gasping for breath as he plunged that great thing into her again and again, pulling on her leash as though to remind her of his control.

Telling her over and over, 'You better ask me if you want to come.'

And she was begging, pleading with him, 'Please sir... please let me come...'

Until finally he said, 'You may come.'

And she was screaming, all sweaty and red in the face, as he pushed that thing as deep into her as he could, hammering her, pushing her over the edge until she was shaking under him.

'Intense...' Jens heard Andrea, whose webcam showed that she had dispensed with her leggings and was now thrusting her fingers into herself, caring little for what she was showing Jens.

Emil lay down on the bed and led Effie by the leash over to him, to straddle him and ride his hardness. He slapped her behind as she rode him, but it was gentle, it wasn't hurting her. After that, he was fucking her from behind, doggy style and then kneeling up, holding her by the leash, holding her arms behind her back as though she was his kidnap victim, or perhaps he was a cop who had just arrested her.

Jens was riveted to the sight of his wife being pleased like never before. It was strange, because this had never seemed like Effie's style—and yet, with Emil it seemed like she had been doing it this way all her life. Perhaps they had done it like this when they were young.

When Emil was done, he had her sit on the carpet like a 'good girl', and then he sprayed his come all over her—all over her face, her neck, her breasts.

Then he left her there in the bedroom, and went into the living room to watch TV, as though she were a paid employee and he was simply done with her.

‘Okay,’ Jens heard Andrea. Her webcam was being moved, back up to show her somewhat flushed, sweat-shiny face and shoulders. ‘So maybe I would try it like that sometime. That just looked *insane*...’

Andrea signed off, wishing him a good night, and Jens was left to watch his wife step under the shower.

It struck him that they had not taken any pictures, they had not videoed any of the scene of Effie being dominated. Was it not something she ever wanted to reveal to her husband? That didn’t make him feel comfortable. He pushed that thought away.

Jens watched his wife clean off in the shower, looking happy and entirely untroubled by what was going on. Her attitude reassured him to some extent. Out of the shower, Effie put on a pair of vaguely sheer panties and a small tank top that left her midriff bare, and quietly went out to sit with Emil on the couch, curling up against him to watch Netflix.

They didn’t talk much, though they very much seemed to act like a couple, watching TV together late at night.

Jens found himself watching them just to try and figure out what he was feeling about Effie being with Emil.

He felt *intimidated* by them being together.

It wasn’t just the affection they displayed for each other, it wasn’t just the contentment they displayed spending time together. Watching them enjoying dominant-submissive sex together had seriously shaken Jens. But he wanted Effie to have experiences, a lot of experiences, a whole range of different experiences. He liked the idea of her learning new things, of expanding her perspective on life and sex.

But seeing it with Emil, so different to how it was with himself, made Jens feel deeply vulnerable. What if she *needed* that? What if she wouldn’t

end this affair when he asked her to, because she needed a lover who could make her feel like that?

Then just before Effie and Emil went to bed, she said something to him that Jens didn't quite understand.

‘What’s your mother going to say?’

He thought it was some kind of in-joke where he didn't get the reference, because he hadn't been there for its origins. But Emil had looked at her and shrugged, his expression serious, and now it didn't seem to be an in-joke.

‘I don't know,’ he said. ‘Hopefully nothing.’

That night, Jens made a decision. Perhaps it was time to bring a halt to the affair.

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A BUMP IN THE RIDE

C oming down in high winds, the plane landed at Kastrup with a bump.

Suitcase in hand, he came out through the arrivals gateway ready to look for a taxi home when he heard his name being called. At first, he assumed it was somebody else named Jens being called—but then as the voice drew nearer, he recognized it.

Effie was waiting for him just behind the barrier, being somewhat crushed by the various families and minicab drivers awaiting other arrivals.

‘Hey sweetie, what are you doing here?’

‘I thought it might be nice to come pick you up from the airport,’ she said, giving him a kiss on both cheeks, which seemed formal for a greeting, but then perhaps it was best not to get into a long French kiss right in the middle of the airport.

Actually, it was still fairly early in the day—not yet five o’clock, so she would have had to have left work early to get there to meet his flight.

‘Well that’s very nice of you,’ he said as they walked out to the short-term parking lot, where Effie had her car waiting—a red Tesla Model 3.

But when they were safely inside, Effie said: ‘We need to talk.’

Jens felt his stomach lurch into his feet. *Oh God*. Was there a more terrifying phrase in the English language? We need to talk. What was going

on? Had she had a change of heart about Emil and their marriage? Was he losing her?

‘What is it?’ he asked, nervous. Well, he was good at nervous.

Now he was thinking, what if she found the spy cameras in our apartment? Was that one intrusion too far? Does she think I’m a Bad Person now because of that? Or, what if Andrea let slip that we’d slept together without telling her?

Effie sighed, long and clear. Then, ‘I’ve been having an affair.’

Jens thinking, *did you forget that I know already?* But he let her speak.

‘I’ve been sleeping with a guy called Emil, one of my ex-boyfriends,’ she said, again, sounding as though this was news to Jens.

‘Okay,’ Jens nodded. ‘You know that that’s okay with me, don’t you?’

And now he was thinking that in their arrangement, if either one of them came out and said she was having an affair, that would trigger the end of the affair. So was this Effie having enough of her relationship with Emil? Jens felt strangely relieved.

He leaned over and stroked her cheek gently, making her briefly smile. ‘You know, I don’t mind if you have an affair,’ he said to her, feeling a strange quiver of dark excitement as he realized what he was offering her. A blanket consent for any relationship she wanted to undertake in secret. Permission to cheat on him.

Well, it had been so exciting, knowing that she was cheating.

‘You know, if there was ever another guy you... wanted...’

Again, her face flickered with a brief smile, and there was a sparkle of gratitude and excitement in her eyes. But then her expression felt flat again, troubled.

She sighed again. ‘Emil took me to dinner last night at a really exclusive restaurant up past Hellerup,’ she said. ‘I guess we had a few glasses of really expensive wine, and we felt we were far enough out of

Copenhagen to be safe... so we were getting a little too... friendly... together...'

'Okay,' Jens nodded, thinking, *what are you going to confess to having sex with him? I know that already. That you took him round the back of the restaurant for an illicit blow job?*

'I guess... we were kissing a lot. Holding hands,' she said. 'We went for a walk after dinner...'

'What happened?'

Now Jens was worried that Emil had hurt her, that something bad had happened that would switch her off any sexual risks for the rest of time. But he had seen her with the guy late last night, hadn't he? And they were more than good together.

Effie sighed yet again. 'His mother was there.'

'What?'

'Emil's mother was there. Total coincidence. She saw us walking around together, and I guess she saw us kissing at one point...'

'She saw you two kissing?'

Jens wasn't sure what to take from all this. *What did he care if someone had caught sight of Effie making out with her son outside some posh restaurant?*

Effie said, 'She recognized me. And we had to tell her we've been dating. And I had to tell her I've separated from my husband. From you.'

She looked across at Jens. Jens felt strangely numb, cold. He'd lost the hardness in his cock from the part where she'd confessed to her affair.

'Why did you tell her we were separated?' he asked his wife.

'Because she wanted to know how come I was free to date her son now...'

Jens shrugged. 'What does it matter, anyway?' he said, feeling stupid, so stupid. He felt like the whole world knew something about Effie, about

their relationship, and he was the only one who didn't because he was too stupid to understand.

A tear escaped Effie's eyelid, and dribbled down her cheek. It sent a jolt of pure fear through Jens, the likes of which he had never felt before. At least, not since he was a boy, when he'd realized what the doctors were trying to tell him about his parents.

'She knows *everyone in my family*,' Effie said, in barely more than a whisper.

Jens felt a twinge of nausea in his stomach. 'What are you saying?'

She looked at him, and now there were tears trickling down both of her cheeks. She said, 'Mor called me this morning. Asked if I was okay. You know... because of our separation.'

'She... she did?'

'She asked if you were okay, too.'

'That's nice of her.'

Effie sobbed. 'I'm *sorry*. I was so *embarrassed*. Mor told me everyone knows I'm with Emil now—everyone in my family, and everyone in his. Everyone in *Søndervig* knows by now. Everyone in the Midtjylland region probably knows. It spread like wildfire.'

Jens nodded, and felt so cold. 'Because you two were childhood sweethearts,' he said. 'Everyone knew you back then, and everyone thought you were adorable together.'

'I'm sorry,' she whispered again.

'It's okay,' he said, but he wasn't sure how he was supposed to feel about all this. He supposed he was embarrassed, too, that Effie's entire family knew he'd lost her to Emil.

'I don't know why... I was too scared to tell my Mor it was only an affair. Or that I haven't separated from you, that you've been letting me see Emil.'

Jens sighed. ‘You couldn’t say anything because Emil believes you’re having an affair, and you don’t want him to know of our little... deception.’

Effie looked down at her feet, totally dejected. ‘I don’t understand how it’s all unraveled like this. The whole thing’s a mess.’

Jens took a deep breath. It felt weird to think that so many people—Effie’s entire family, most importantly—believed that he and Effie had split up. He felt mildly relieved that they didn’t all know that he had allowed Effie to date Emil. Or that he had allowed her to date so many different men during this latter stage of their marriage. That would have been much more humiliating.

He asked her, ‘What’s Emil said about it all?’

She dipped her head slightly. ‘He doesn’t care who knows,’ she said, seemingly more than a little bitter at her boyfriend’s attitude. ‘I guess we had a small argument. He said maybe it was time to take the next step, to admit to the affair. To walk out on my marriage.’

Jens felt his heart seize up, and he tried desperately to act calm. ‘Easy for him to say,’ he said. ‘He’s already walked out on his marriage.’

‘Well, I told him he was being a prick about it,’ she said.

A long pause. Lot of pauses in this conversation. Pauses, interspersed with sighs.

Jens said at last, ‘So you’ve admitted the affair. To me, at least. This was what he wanted?’

‘He wanted me to talk to you, yes.’

‘Did he tell you what he wants to happen now?’ Jens felt the bitterness rising again, realized it was showing a little in his tone.

‘He said I should move out of our apartment, move in with him. But I said I haven’t decided what to do.’

‘And now? You still haven’t decided?’

She was silent.

Jens said, 'Originally, we said that when one or other of us spoke of the affair, that would be the end of it.'

'We did,' she said. Was she angry with him?

He said, 'So. Do you still want to see Emil?'

She turned to look at him. 'I'd like to,' she said. 'But I'd rather be with you. You know that, don't you? *Always* you, honey.'

The way she said it made him feel better. She seemed genuine.

'If I asked you to walk away from him, right now, never to see him again...'

'Of course I would,' she said. 'You want me to text him right now? Call him?'

Jens shook his head. 'No,' he said.

'No?'

He rubbed his chin. 'It's not your fault any of this happened,' he said. 'You dated Emil to help me cope with my Paris trip.' She was going to say something, but he held up a hand to ask her to let him speak. 'It's been fun, you know? Even after you stopped telling me what was going on with him.'

He reached into his jacket pocket, retrieved her lost phone, and gave it to her.

'Here,' he said. 'The one you lost.'

She smiled. 'I knew you'd find it.'

'You took the security code off it.'

'And you looked at some of the pictures on it?' she gave him a sly grin, and now her hand snaked its way over his lap, discovering his thickening cock there.

'Pictures... and videos.'

'Did it... help with your Milan trip?' she asked.

'Very much so.'

She nodded, and expertly unfastened his fly while he was sitting there in the front seat of a car parked in the airport's short-term parking lot, which

was hardly a very isolated, private space. He didn't stop her.

'But you didn't need to wait for those videos to... to appreciate my affair?' she said.

'No,' he agreed, and now his hand crept across her thigh, under her skirt.

'You knew every time I was with him, didn't you?'

'Uh-huh.'

'I could tell. When I got home... you could smell him on me, couldn't you? You could tell we'd had sex... even if I showered at his place.'

'Well, that was always a dead giveaway,' he said, his fingers sliding between her thighs, grazing up against her panties, which were already soaked through.

'You were always extra hard whenever I came home after sex with him,' she said, moaning as his finger slipped under the edge of her panties and plunged into her well-lubricated pussy.

She let go of her husband's cock, and now reached for a different stick, slipping the car into drive. He was impressed at how well she drove one-handed, although it was an automatic transmission. He coated his finger in her pussy juices, and now brought it up to his mouth to taste her.

'You've been with him recently,' he said.

'We both took a sick day,' she said. 'After calling Mor this morning... I couldn't face work.'

'So you stayed home and fucked him all day?' he chuckled.

'Not *all* day.'

He sank his hand back into her panties, stroking her sex, her mound, as though trying to spread her wetness further.

'So what now?' she asked him.

Jens shrugged. 'My guess is, we stay 'separated' for a while. Until we can figure things out.'

'Seriously?'

‘What will everyone think if you drop Emil right now? Not long after separating from your husband.’

‘They’ll think there’s something wrong with me.’

‘They’ll think something’s gone wrong somewhere,’ he nodded.

She squeezed his cock. ‘But I still get to see you.’

He nodded. ‘But you can’t tell Emil that you are.’

‘I’ll be cheating on him.’

‘I guess you will.’

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EIGHTEEN

ALONE

He felt nervous and alone after watching her pack her things in two large suitcases and then walk out of their apartment, in order to move in with her boyfriend.

Sure, she left him with an orgasm.

She left him with a warm smile, a lingering kiss, and the panties she'd been wearing on the way home while his finger had been buried deep inside her soaking pussy. But she still left him. Her wardrobe was empty. Her underwear drawer. There were none of her toiletries in the bathroom.

They talked again, before she went. She cried. She didn't like the feeling of people believing that she would ever leave Jens. She was shocked when her mother had hinted that it must have been 'difficult' living with him.

'It was never difficult,' she said. 'And anyway, you've made so much progress these days, you're easier to live with than most guys, I bet.'

He'd chuckled at that. 'You just have to tell people we're on a break,' he said. 'We're still best friends... we're just taking stock of our lives, you know?'

She nodded. 'I don't think Emil would like me to say that.'

'So don't say it when he's around. Does he think... you're going to stay with him... indefinitely?' he asked her.

‘I’m not sure. It seems like he kind of assumes that.’

Jens mostly hid his annoyance at that.

‘Well,’ he said, ‘You’re not marrying him.’

‘No, I’m not.’

She sighed.

He said, ‘Look, it’s only you and me who know that I’m sharing you.’

‘And Andrea.’

‘And Andrea,’ he nodded. ‘But we’ve got that, haven’t we? It would be more difficult if people knew the whole truth.’

She nodded. ‘Are you going to see her? Andrea? While I’m gone, I mean.’

‘I don’t know. She’s dating some new guy. Johan, I think his name is.’

‘She’ll never stick to one guy,’ Effie grinned.

‘No, probably not.’

‘It’s probably why you like her so much.’

His wife gave him a funny little look, which he couldn’t quite interpret, but seemed to be approving of his seeing their blonde neighbor.

She still went out for drinks with her co-workers fairly regularly—when you worked in something as dry as finance, it was practically required. She also saw her various female friends, some of whom she’d known as long as Emil, and who were apparently pleased she’d reunited with him.

But it gave her leeway to see Jens once or twice a week.

It felt different, being ‘the other man’ in this relationship. When she came over to the apartment, it was no longer a finishing point for her at the end of an exciting night out—it was the pinnacle of her exciting night out. She was all dressed up nicely for him, not the other guy. She was all fired

up and aroused to see him, rather than simply happy to be home after her sexual adventure was mostly done.

And there was a hint of mischief, a soupçon of wickedness in her dark eyes now, every time she saw him, because she wasn't supposed to be there, she wasn't allowed to be with him, she was cheating just to see Jens, let alone strip down to her underwear and give him the sexual ride of a lifetime.

Most of the time, they didn't even go out when she came over. Just stayed in the apartment and fucked like they hadn't seen each other in forever.

'You are okay with all this?'

'Sure,' he said. 'As long as you are. I mean, you still want to see Emil, right?'

'I still have fun with him...'

That night she'd really had dinner with her work friends, which had been something she'd been able to use to her advantage talking with Emil about what she was up to—because she was still bad at lying. But the dinner hadn't lasted too long, and then she swung by Jens's apartment. Almost immediately she arrived, she slipped into the bathroom and changed out of her work clothes. When she stepped out into the living room again, she was wearing black lingerie—bra, stockings, suspenders, sheer panties and high-heeled shoes.

'You do a lot of... different things with him.'

She'd laughed at that. 'What do you mean, 'different things'?'

'Well, like you don't with other guys. Usually.'

'How do you... I mean... we haven't even really talked about *that* yet.' She put her hands on her hips, pouted at him, and Jens had blushed fiercely.

He took a deep breath. He had to tell her. But would she hate him for spying on her? Would she turn her back on him for real?

‘Andrea showed me... how to set up cameras,’ he said, and glanced around the living room, and across to the bedroom, to indicate that there were, indeed, cameras everywhere.

‘Seriously?’ Effie caught her breath. ‘Where are they?’

‘Well, in here... there’s one in that fake smoke detector in the kitchen,’ he pointed.

‘Jesus. I never even noticed that before.’

‘Who notices smoke detectors? There’s another camera in that clock over there.’

‘God.’

‘That new smart speaker I got?’ he pointed to it. ‘That has a camera in it, too.’

‘God, honey...’

‘In the bedroom, you know, there’s one in the box of tissues on your chest of drawers. There’s cameras in the bedside lamp, and one mounted on the window blind. There’s an air freshener in the bathroom...’

‘Jesus,’ Effie said, her eyes wide. ‘That must have cost a small fortune!’

He sighed, ‘It wasn’t too much. And I was so... desperate...’

Then, to his surprise, she smiled. ‘Ingenious. I knew you’d figure out how to enjoy it, even if it was a secret affair. So... what did you see through your cameras?’ She sat down on the armchair opposite him.

‘I saw him... put you on a leash,’ he said, feeling a little nervous talking about this in front of her. As though she could get angry at him, or publicly humiliate him if he revealed too much.

‘Okay...’ she nodded, toying with her hair.

‘He treated you like his personal pet, ordered you to suck his cock...’ Jens trembled.

‘And how did you feel about that?’ she asked him, as though she was his therapist, except that she was dressed up like a high-class call girl.

‘It was... sexy,’ he said, not quite knowing how she wanted him to answer. ‘I liked... how much you seemed to be into it.’

She smiled. ‘I like doing different things from time to time.’

‘It doesn’t scare you when a man... takes control like that?’ he asked her.

She saw through his concerns almost immediately. She said, ‘He’s not Viggo. It’s all consensual. I trust Emil, he knows what he’s doing.’

Jens nodded. ‘My therapist has this idea that I’m afraid of Emil because... you get to have interesting sex with him.’

Effie laughed, ‘You’re still seeing her? Well, you need to pass on a message to her for me: *I get just as much interesting sex from my husband.*’

‘Yeah, but, you know, I can’t do the same things he can...’

She looked indignant at him—offended, but too dignified to get visibly angry. Jens felt awful. He’d questioned her loyalty. She’d shown him nothing but devotion, even when their relationship was capsized by an unfortunate accident, she had risked things to be with him. And he’d effectively asked her if she was in danger of choosing Emil over him.

Then she said, ‘Get on your knees.’

Jens was confused. What did she say?

‘On your knees. Right here in front of me.’

He dropped down to the carpet, breathing in that irresistible scent of *Infidelity* from her body. What did she want, some kind of oath of fealty from him? It felt like she was going to pull out a sword. She’d either knight him, or behead him.

She wouldn’t tell him to kneel on the floor just to shout at him, surely?

She grabbed his tie. Pulled him toward her so his face was right up against hers. ‘You’re going to do everything I tell you,’ she said, her voice stern but not angry.

He nodded. Swallowed.

‘Tell me.’

More confusion on his part, but he was smart enough to understand she wanted him to confirm what he was agreeing to. 'I'm going to do everything that you tell me,' he said.

'Good. Take off my shoes.'

'Yes, my lady,' he said, picking up one of her feet to remove her shoe.

She smiled. 'I like that.' He removed her other shoe and she said, 'Kiss my feet.'

'Yes, my lady.'

He did as she asked, kissing her gently through the black nylon of her stockings, stroking his face up against them as though he were a cat trying to ingratiate itself with its owner.

He kissed his way up her shins, enjoying the feeling of the nylon against his face as he went, the elegant scent of her perfume, fresh on her skin now that Jens was the headline act for the evening, rather than merely lingering remnants left over from her time with Emil.

'Take off my panties,' she said, pulling him close to her by the necktie. As though his tie was that leash he'd seen Emil use on her.

'Yes, my lady.'

She put her hands back behind her on the couch to support herself as she lifted her hips to help him slide her panties down her thighs, over her suspender belt and stockings.

'Put them in your mouth,' she said, and he complied, stuffing part of her lacy panties into his mouth, tasting a hint of her arousal in the thin material.

'Taste good?' she asked him. He nodded.

'You know why I'm so nice? Because I'm going to let you taste some more...' She wrestled him onto the couch, and he let her manhandle him, though at first he didn't know what she wanted. She wanted him lying there, on his back—where she could straddle him, then crawl up his body until she was kneeling over his head, thighs either side of his cheeks, pussy directly over his mouth.

She pulled her sodden panties from his mouth, and dropped down onto his lips, and he opened up to taste her sweet sex directly.

‘You like that? You like how my pussy tastes?’ she asked him, her hips beginning to rock gently, rubbing her beautiful pussy over his mouth,

‘Mmm-hmm...’ he said.

‘So lick it...’ she ordered him, and as she gyrated her hips to stir her pussy over his lips some more, she reached behind herself to pull his hands off his lap.

‘You don’t touch your cock until I let you,’ she said.

He loved how she sighed as she rubbed herself against him, how she moaned when he managed to kiss her pussy at just the right moment, or get his tongue into just the right place. How she cried out,

‘Oh yeah... yeah... yeah... just like that...’

How she said, ‘Your tongue feels so good, honey...’

He adored the feeling of her heat pressing down on him, the control she had, the way she seemed to just use him for her pleasure, and she knew exactly how best to use him for those ends.

He adored her flavor, and the stickiness as she rubbed herself over his whole face. He adored her scent, filling every breath with that dark spiciness, even when she moved a few inches away from his mouth, wanting a break from it, wanting to just touch herself gently, and let his gaze wander over her glistening petals while she stroked them.

‘You like doing what I say?’ she asked him.

‘Yes, my lady.’

‘Mmm... I like it, too,’ she smiled. ‘And I like it best when I tell you to lick my pussy.’

‘Yes, my lady.’

She sat forward again, but this time remained still over his mouth, letting him lick and suck her pussy at his own pace, flicking his tongue

against her clit, sliding it between her slippery folds, sucking on her lips, taking her clit in his hot mouth.

When she climbed off him, she had him take off his clothes, except for his necktie, which remained in place around his otherwise bare body, like the leash he had seen Emil use on her. She took hold of it and ordered him down onto his knees again in front of her, while she sat there on the couch in her bra, stockings and suspender belt, parting her legs to offer up her pussy again.

‘Lick me... yeah... just like that...’

She’d never been like this with him before. It was Emil’s doing, he was sure of it. Emil had opened her up, somehow, given her the confidence to do things the way she wanted to do them, removed her inhibitions when it came to sex, even with her husband.

‘Oh my God... oh yeah... oh my God... yeah...’

He lapped at her exquisite, tangy wetness, and she held his head, giving him direction where she needed it, offering a few motivational words when she felt like it.

‘Oh yeah... taste my dirty little pussy... just like that... you know how often my boyfriend puts his dick in there and fucks me with it? Every night... over and over again... how does it feel to taste my pussy knowing he’s been there before you? Sliding his big, hard dick inside me... making me come with it over and over and over...’

She stroked his cock with her nylon-clad feet and asked him whether he wanted to put it inside her pussy, and then when he said that was what he wanted most of all, she had him eat her some more for good measure.

When she eventually came to walk him like a dog into the bedroom, ordering him to climb onto the bed, his knees felt as though he was kneeling on red-hot glowing coals, burning from overuse.

She had him lie down, and gently brushed her body over his, over his hard cock, though without dwelling to give him real pleasure there. She

knelt up on the bed in front of him and removed her bra, fondling her gorgeous breasts as she let the thing fall away.

Then she ducked down, teasing him with light little touches over his hard cock, blowing on it, letting her hair fall over it.

‘Do you want your cock in my mouth?’ she asked him.

‘Yes, please. Yes, my lady.’

‘Well, I suppose you have been a good boy...’

She took his cock in her hands, stroking it, squeezing it. He had to focus on what he was doing to avoid coming straight away.

She added little teasing licks. Little kisses, up his shaft, and on the tip of his cock.

‘You know I like to do this with Emil?’ she said, and now sank onto his shaft. Jens felt his cock throbbing in her hot mouth as he imagined her doing this to her boyfriend.

After a while, she seemed to need his cock so badly she dropped it and moved up to straddle him, to sit smartly down on his hardness, and begin quickly pumping her hips to move it deep within her.

She rode him hard, and turned around to ride him reverse cowgirl style, having sat briefly on his face again as though to reassert her own dominance.

As much as he’d always enjoyed pleasuring her, and making sure her needs were satisfied before his, this was all new. Her attitude. Her confidence. Her strength. The way she used him for her own personal purposes, the way she ordered him around, telling him exactly what she wanted him to do, the way she rode him like a beast of burden, grinding herself against him, rubbing herself against him, almost smothering him.

She came, again and again, while always holding back from allowing him to come.

And then when she was done, she wrapped her sodden panties around his hardness, gripped him firmly in her hands and pumped him until he

exploded all over the place, thick white cream shooting in streaks all over her, all over the bed, all over him.

‘Wow. You do that with him?’ he said afterwards, when they were lying side-by-side on the bed, recovering, feeling completely spent.

‘Not really,’ she laughed. ‘But when he dominates me... I guess I wondered what it would be like to do that with you.’

‘Wow,’ he said, rubbing his aching jaw.

‘Good ‘wow’ or bad ‘wow’?’

‘Good ‘wow’. Definitely. But wow.’

She grinned. ‘You always liked the idea of me learning things from my adventures.’

‘It’s a perk,’ he nodded.

But then she had to hit the shower, and as always when she came over to cheat on Emil, the clock approached twelve and she had to leave before her coach turned back into a pumpkin, her horses into mice, her footmen into rats and her dress into rags.

‘Dream of me,’ she might say as they parted again on the threshold.

‘Always.’

And then she was away until the next time, leaving his apartment smelling of her, leaving his senses ringing from her, leaving his memory scorched by her.

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FAMILY REUNION

It was one of those ideas you say ‘yes’ to because it’s so much easier at the time, and you figure it will be so easy to change your mind later, closer to the time.

They had been lying in bed one evening, after another marathon session together, while Emil believed Effie to be out at the movies with one of her old friends from college. Effie was quietly stroking her husband’s cock as though hoping to get one more orgasm out of it either before, or during her shower prior to heading back to her boyfriend and the ‘real world’.

‘Will you come to the family reunion with me this year?’ she asked.

He said, ‘You’re not going with Emil? I mean, everyone knows you’re with him now.’

She said, ‘I am. But I just thought... maybe it would be nice if you came along, too.’

‘With Emil?’

She sighed. ‘I don’t like everyone believing that you somehow lost me,’ she said. ‘Or that I chose Emil over you. Or that you’re not still a huge part of my life.’

Jens shrugged. ‘Surely if I’m not there, people will hardly remember I even exist?’

She shook her head. ‘But I don’t want that.’

‘What about Emil? Won’t he get jealous if I’m there?’

‘He knows that I see you every now and then,’ she said, and it was news to Jens. ‘I tell him I’m having coffee with you, things like that.’

‘But not that we fuck like rabbits once or twice a week, and you really love shoving that sweet, cheating pussy in my face every time you see me?’ Jens laughed.

‘Hey, be careful, Mister, or I’ll withhold my sweet, cheating pussy from you, and then you’ll be sorry.’

Jens said, ‘He thinks we’ve got some kind of sexless BFF thing going?’

‘Something like that,’ she agreed, and sprawled over his body to slip his cock in her mouth for a few moments, as though to make fun of Emil’s impression of their relationship.

‘You know it would be weird,’ he said. ‘The three of us going to your family reunion together?’

She came up for air. ‘But when Emil and I call it off,’ she said, ‘And I go straight back to you, I want it to seem entirely natural that I would do that. You know—as far as my family’s concerned.’

And the thing was, Jens didn’t want to discourage that whole idea of her breaking off things with Emil and going back to him. So he agreed to the whole family reunion thing. But then when spring turned to summer, and time was running out before they would actually have to do it, suddenly there never seemed a good enough excuse for Jens to pull out.

So here it was, the three of them were all going to climb into Emil’s large, black, smoke-belching diesel SUV and drive across the country together to visit Effie’s family.

It was weird enough meeting Emil, properly, shaking his hand, knowing that this tall, powerful man was not only sleeping with his wife at the

present time, but also having a relationship with her completely out in the open.

Emil seemed nice, but seemed to view Jens as Effie's gay best friend, or something like that. But though he consciously treated Jens as an entirely unthreatening hanger-on during their drive over to the west of Jutland, subconsciously it seemed Emil needed to constantly prove his status in the relationship. In the car, he gave Effie lots of little touches—on the leg as he drove, on the arm, around the shoulders. It was almost some kind of territorial thing, the guy claiming her as his own property, in the face of the threat from Jens.

Jens quite liked seeing Effie with him. Happy, flirty; though the adrenalized energy of the early relationship had worn off.

When they eventually arrived at the family pad down in Søndervig, Jens assumed he'd be a virtual stranger—he'd visited Effie's family so rarely that he was certain none of them would even know him. Meanwhile they knew Emil so well, and had known him for so long, he would fit in with the family as though he was already part of it. But they arrived and got out of the car, and there was hugs all around, and Effie's father shook Jens's hand and escorted him inside the house behind the others, as though he was the important one. And then inside, all Effie's sisters, and her cousins, her uncles and aunts were all greeting him like an old friend, while Emil was treated as someone new they'd just met.

Despite all the friendliness, Jens felt intense embarrassment. *They all know I've lost my wife to another man. Do they suspect I'm a cuckold? That I get sexual thrills from her being with him?* It was a new feeling for Jens, because on the whole he was a very solitary person, and did not spend much time around other people. There had been few opportunities to feel anyone else might suspect him as being different to a conventional husband.

The embarrassment waned, however, as he felt sure they didn't suspect him of being a sexual deviant. Just a husband in an unconventional

marriage.

Early on in the long weekend, Emil spent the whole time with Effie, holding her hand, and the two of them acted very much like a couple. And that Emil was staying with Effie, in her room, while Jens was given the room above the garage—little more than a workshop for Effie's father normally, but it was comfortable enough as an impromptu guest bedroom.

Dinner was a lively affair, and Jens felt a real part of the family throughout, and the friendly atmosphere really helped him to forget about his anxieties, his fears of being around so many people.

'You're doing so well,' Effie said quietly at one point, as everybody went to fetch dessert. 'I can't believe it.'

He smiled. 'You've helped me to make progress. So, here I am.'

'How's your room?'

'Fine.'

'Can I see it later?'

'Sure.'

There was a little twinkle in her eye, and Jens felt good that she wanted to see him that night, even if it did seem a little risky.

After supper, there was a big family walk on the beach, and Jens didn't even worry about the sand getting everywhere. He just walked quietly with some of Effie's cousins, chatting politely where needed, taking in the pleasant scent of the sea air.

He even walked with Effie's mother for a while, and things seemed warm between them.

'You know, Effie and Emil were together for so long when they were kids, they were really inseparable,' she said at one point, as though trying to say to Jens that he should have no hard feelings now that she wanted to see Emil again.

'Yeah, that's the impression she gave me,' he nodded.

Effie's mom said, 'When Emil's mom, Natasha, told everybody that they were back together again, it wasn't a huge surprise to many in these parts.'

'No?'

Effie's mom chuckled. 'But Natasha's attitude is that, *hey, you see my boy and Effie together again? They'll be getting married soon, mark my words.*'

Jens felt his heart skip a beat, and not in a good way.

But Effie's mom continued: 'She's always wanted those two to be together. But they won't be together long.'

'No?' Jens raised his eyebrows at that.

Effie's mom laughed. 'Candle that burns brightest, burns half as long, am I right? You stick around, my Jens. Then she'll come back to you.'

It was nice, feeling that, somehow, the family had the belief that Effie would rethink her affair and return to her husband at some point. It made Jens feel much more relaxed, much more comfortable with the whole clan out there in Søndervig.

But it was Katherine, one of Effie's older sisters, who seemed to understand what was going on with Effie, Jens and Emil. Wandering back along the beach toward the family home, Katherine walked with Jens and piped up conversation by saying: 'I've seen the way you look at her. And the way Effie looks at you.'

'You have?' he smiled.

Katherine had the wry smile of a real gossip who believes she knows of a scandalous story but is still working out how best to make use of her knowledge.

'You and Effie aren't breaking up at all, are you?' she said.

'We're separated,' Jens said, truthfully enough.

'But not permanently,' she said. 'I mean, it's not like you're working toward a divorce, is it?'

‘I hope not,’ he said.

Katherine’s grin broadened. ‘You let her, don’t you? You’re letting her date Emil. Get it out of her system.’

He shrugged. ‘It’s not for me to *let her* do anything. It’s up to her.’

Katherine laughed. ‘But... I mean, you’re okay with her sleeping with him. Right?’

He shrugged.

‘Do you like it?’ she said in a conspiratorial whisper. ‘Do you like that she sees him? Or other men in general? I’ve heard that some men...’

‘As long as she’s happy, I’m happy,’ he said.

‘Jesus. Where can I get a man like you?’

Jens waited in his above-garage guest room for ages, believing that perhaps Effie would sneak away from Emil, even just for five or ten minutes. But she didn’t. He was disappointed, even though on the whole he felt good that the general feeling around her family was that he was still part of them, that she and Emil were not destined to be together as man and wife at any point.

Giving up, he slipped out of his bedroom in order to use the bathroom to get ready for sleep.

Then while he was brushing his teeth, Effie walked straight into the bathroom and locked the door behind her. She had a towel wrapped around her, but as soon as they were alone in that locked room, the towel fell to the floor leaving her naked.

‘Hey,’ she said, reaching into the shower booth to switch on the flow of the water.

‘Hey,’ he said, surprised at her appearance. ‘I thought everybody was already asleep.’

‘Oh, I think they are,’ she said, putting her hands around the back of his head, pulling him toward her. ‘I know Emil just rolled over after we... you know...’

She kissed him, and he breathed in that strong aroma of recent sex. God. She really had just fucked him. She held onto the back of his head and sucked on his lips, kissing him passionately, and he could smell the guy on her breath, on her body, on her lips. Effie's hands moved down to his crotch, and she was exploring his hardness through the jeans he was still wearing.

'You just fucked him?' Jens asked her.

'Uh-huh,' she said, kissing him so hard, he couldn't remember her wanting him this badly for a while.

Jens's own hands drifted down her body, skirting over her damp, clammy skin, her stiff nipples, her shapely curves, down to briefly brush over her mound and her pussy. She was seriously wet.

He lifted her up onto the counter, and she spread her legs to allow him access to slide his fingers inside her, to check out this wicked pussy, in which another man had been so recently thrusting, no doubt.

'I thought you were going to come to my room,' he said, breathless as their kiss came to a pause.

'Risky,' she grinned.

'And this isn't?'

He dropped down to kiss his way over her breasts, sucking her nipples into his hot mouth. God—he could taste the saltiness of perspiration, feel the clamminess of her skin, smell that spicy earthiness that told of another man lying with her, thrusting inside her, perhaps even coming all over her.

She leaned back, her mouth open in a long, silent moan as he dived down to kiss her bare pussy, to suck on the tangy goodness of her slippery folds.

He got the impression that she had waited for this. She'd looked forward to it. As much as they did together, Emil didn't do this for her.

She bit her lip to try to avoid making too much noise as he slid a finger or two inside her while sucking carefully but firmly on her clit. It would

always seem wrong, taking her so soon after another man had been with her. But it never seemed anything less than unbelievably thrilling. Taking her, winning her back, making her his.

They switched positions, and she went down on him for a while, enjoying the feeling of his cock in her mouth as though she hadn't experienced it for a while. Giving him the impression that he was the perfect size for her, at least orally, while Emil might be too big.

Then she was on her feet, leaning over the sink, lifting one leg to make it easier for him to glide into her. Fucking her gently as she held onto the mirror above the sink.

He thought of the other man, Emil, lying in their bedroom, probably asleep already after fucking Effie. He thought of the big guy stretching her pussy as he pounded her. Was her pussy more stretched than normal? Perhaps. It only made it seem hotter for him to reclaim her, though. He slammed into her again and again as she gasped for breath, her fingers quietly strumming away at her clit while he fucked her.

She had him lie down on the floor, which was no mean feat in a bathroom that size. He just about managed it, though his neck was crooked to avoid the toilet, and she rode him hard.

'Come in me... come in me... come in me...' she implored him, and he did as she demanded.

As she stepped under the flowing water of the shower, he picked up his wash bag, ready to go.

'Your family seems to think the whole thing with Emil is just temporary,' he told her.

'It is,' she said.

'But... did you tell them it was?'

She shook her head. 'Nope. I guess... they just see us together, and interpret how things are between you and me.'

He laughed. 'I think your sister Katherine knows everything.'

Effie shrugged. 'I don't think I care too much. I love you. I love fucking other guys. You love me fucking other guys. We're all adults, aren't we?'

'I suppose so,' he said, feeling embarrassed, nevertheless.

They wished each other good night, and kissed once more, Effie remaining under the shower. Jens surprised himself completely by being able to wait until first thing in the morning to shower. He slept all night, accompanied by the smell of sex with Effie.

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TWENTY
ANDREA & CO

‘So it must be nice to feel you have the support of Effie’s family?’ his therapist asked him.

‘It’s nice,’ he nodded. ‘Strange, but nice.’

‘Strange?’

He shrugged. ‘They all seem to have the feeling that she’s getting a good seeing to from this guy she used to date a long time ago, and when she’s done she’ll come straight back to me.’

‘Isn’t that the truth?’

‘Well, I would hope so. But having the family... feel that way... it was weird.’

‘Why weird?’

‘I don’t know. The women in the family treated me like I was some kind of rock star.’

‘Because you’re the kind of husband they wish they could have,’ the therapist said, and gave him a funny little look, which he couldn’t quite fathom, until she then realized how she was looking at him, and then she blushed fiercely.

Jens concealed his amusement. Was his therapist wishing she could have a husband who would let her have fun with other men?

‘But the men in Effie’s family all seemed kind of nervous around me,’ Jens said. ‘Like, they didn’t really know how to be around me.’

The therapist nodded. ‘They’re uncomfortable around you,’ she said. ‘You’re a threat to them, to their way of seeing relationships. Maybe they think you’ll influence their wives or girlfriends, so they’ll demand some kind of open arrangements, too. And yet they don’t hate you, because you’re still clearly important to Effie—and the women in the family adore you.’

‘Well,’ he said, ‘I’m not sure how to take it all. Effie seems to act like she’ll be staying with Emil for a while...’

‘You’d prefer that she didn’t?’

He shrugged. ‘I don’t know. I suppose I’d like her to move on. I mean, I like that she’s still having fun, you know. I want it to be her choice.’

‘Because you don’t want the responsibility for making her end it with him?’

He sighed. ‘No. I think... it’s because if I’m telling her who to see, when to stop seeing them, and so on, it would seem kind of selfish of me.’

‘But she’s been plenty selfish, hasn’t she? You think you’d seem selfish wanting her to end things after all this time?’

‘If she’s not ready to move on... I don’t know, I’d feel like this was all about fulfilling my sexual needs, and hers would only be secondary.’

The therapist was writing plenty in her notes, and Jens wondered what she was observing. Was he displaying classic signs of some kind of problem?

She said, ‘So you say your wife doesn’t look like she’s ending things with Emil any time soon? Why would you say that?’

‘Just the feeling I get when she talks about him. And she’s always trying to get me to see Andrea some more.’

‘Your blonde friend from upstairs?’

‘Uh-huh.’

‘But you feel uncomfortable being with her, still?’

‘I haven’t talked to Effie about how I feel about her. It still feels like... cheating.’

When Andrea appeared on his doorstep, he couldn’t ever bring himself to refuse to see her. Often, he got the feeling that Effie encouraged the pretty blonde to come down and visit him, because she knew he’d never turn her away. When he kept telling Effie that he was okay, that he really didn’t need to bother Andrea just because he was on his own a lot more now, that was when he suspected his wife engineered a little Andrea drop-by.

When she came by, he’d invariably ask how things were going with Johan, her new boyfriend. He liked to hear that things were going well between them.

What he didn’t like was when she came by for a late-night booty-call, and revealed that she’d come straight from her date with Johan.

‘You *don’t* like it when that happens?’ his therapist asked him, confused. He shook his head. ‘It makes things... more complicated.’

‘Is it a turn-off, when she tells you she’s just been with Johan?’

‘Oh no. Quite the contrary,’ Jens laughed, but without humor. ‘When she comes straight from a date, that’s when I want her most. She tells me about her date and... well, I think she’s figured out how to get me going whenever she wants to.’

The therapist nodded, and couldn’t quite conceal a wry smile on one side of her mouth. ‘And you say this is something you *don’t* like?’

‘I don’t feel as though Effie means for me to feel that way about Andrea. Or about any woman except for her, I’d say.’

The worst was when Andrea turned up at a completely reasonable hour, and she confirmed that she hadn’t been out with Johan for a few days—and then an hour later, there was a buzz on the intercom, and to Jens’s complete surprise, Andrea was welcoming Johan himself into the apartment.

‘Uh... hi,’ he’d said, shaking the young man’s hand but feeling incredibly self-conscious and awkward. ‘How are you?’

‘Good,’ Johan had been very smiley, shaking his hand with confidence.

Jens had poured wine for everyone, and there had been a good amount of small-talk, even some TV watching, before the elephant in the room was even hinted at: why the hell Johan was sitting in Jens’s apartment on the couch beside Andrea.

Was Johan here just to get a look at one of the other guys occasionally sleeping with his girlfriend?

Was he here to ask Jens to stop seeing Andrea?

Were Johan and Andrea here to announce their engagement?

After a while, Jens had felt obligated to try and force the issue by popping little probing questions into the conversational mix.

‘So things are going well between you two, Johan?’

Johan smiled broadly. ‘Oh, yes. I mean, it took me a while to get my head around... you know... who she is.’

Andrea grinned and blushed faintly, but gave him a little affectionate squeeze.

‘But now I’ve figured it out... I kind of like it.’ Now it was Johan’s turn to blush.

Jens caught the look of mild excitement in Johan’s eyes, particularly when he glanced sideways at his girlfriend. Was he turned on by her promiscuity? It seemed like it to Jens, and Jens felt like he could recognize something he saw in himself.

‘He’s always asking me about my dates,’ Andrea said, all smiles and giggles as she clutched her wine glass. ‘You know... if I’ve been with other guys.’

Jens laughed. ‘Should I be feeling embarrassed?’

‘Oh no,’ Andrea said. ‘Not at all. It’s why he wanted to... you know... meet you.’

Blushes all around. The atmosphere in there seemed totally awkward. Ice needed breaking, but it was two miles thick. Everyone was sitting oddly straight, as though they were on TV being interviewed for some news segment on unconventional relationships.

Jens noticed that while Johan was wearing a fairly simple black AC-DC t-shirt and jeans, which he could have worn to a rock concert or a sports bar, or simply for a night at home alone, Andrea was all dressed up in a nice red dress, an enticing hint of cleavage on display, plenty of leg, her long, golden hair nicely brushed and flowing down over her shoulders, her makeup done perfectly. The two of them were out of balance.

‘You want to watch her,’ Jens said, somehow impressed at Johan’s boldness, while at the same time feeling suddenly nervous that he was being put on the spot.

‘I just wanted... to see if it was something that might be possible...’ Johan said, nervous himself.

‘Do you think you’d be able to do it?’ Andrea asked Jens, all smiley and flirty, almost batting her eyelids at him.

She glanced across at Johan, and seemed so thrilled by the prospect—it only made Jens want to be able to help them out.

‘Uh... I don’t see why not,’ he said, and caught the little spark of real excitement in both Johan’s and Andrea’s faces. It didn’t stop Jens from feeling nervous about having to potentially *perform* in front of another guy, but he felt a real evangelical zeal to encourage this other guy to find the pleasure in sharing, as he had himself.

‘You’re sure you can really handle this?’ he asked Johan, and they were all laughing. Somehow, the ice had been broken. Jens was, after all, on board.

‘I think so,’ Johan said.

‘You’ve been wanting to do this for ages,’ Andrea said, brushing her hair back out of her face with her hand, clearly anxious about whether her

boyfriend really would be able to cope with seeing her with another man right in front of him—but so obviously wanting to try it.

‘You want to do it now?’ Jens asked.

Andrea and Johan looked at each other with unabashed surprise on their faces. Had they been expecting a long dinner and then plenty of drinks first? To ease themselves slowly, and perhaps drunkenly, into the bedroom with Jens?

And yet Jens seemed to be asking if they wanted to try it now. After a moment, their surprise turned into the kind of expressions that suggested they were considering whether it might be better all-around to get this thing over with. To at least try something, first off. Avoid an evening of nervous build-up.

‘Sure,’ Johan said, almost trembling with nerves.

‘Okay,’ Andrea nodded. ‘We could try something now.’ She seemed to be breathing deeply, a slight flush in her cheeks suggesting perhaps she was beginning to get aroused already. She looked so good that way.

‘We’ll just try a little...’ Jens said, trying to act confidently, since he felt someone ought to. ‘And if we’re not comfortable with it... never mind, right?’

‘Right,’ the other two nodded.

‘And I can just... you know... sit in the corner...’ Johan said, and Jens could see that he was still carrying the emotional baggage of the complete beginner—probably worried that Jens had some kind of secret bisexual designs on him, or that Jens would see him as somehow less of a man because he would be willing to sit by on the sidelines as his girlfriend was taken by another man.

‘However you want,’ Jens said, trying to be reassuring. ‘And you know, there’s no judgment here, right?’

‘Right,’ Johan nodded, and seemed grateful. Acknowledging, perhaps, that Jens had experience in this field that he did not.

‘We can stop whenever you want,’ Andrea told Johan. ‘The moment you start feeling too uncomfortable.’

Johan nodded, and they went through to the bedroom, closing the door behind them as though it made them even more secure from the world outside.

‘Why don’t you tell me what you want to do first?’ Jens said as Andrea and Johan sat on the end of the bed.

‘Take off your clothes,’ Andrea told Jens.

It seemed fairly abrupt, and yet Jens could see the logic in it.

‘Sure,’ he said, trying to seem casual about everything. He stood up and started pulling off his clothes, dropping his shirt, his pants, his socks. Glancing over to the two of them before deciding whether to dispense with his underwear as well. Andrea was quietly asking Johan whether he was okay with this, and he was trying to seem completely relaxed by it all, and the whole thing amused Jens immensely.

Feeling that things were going okay, Jens slipped off his boxer shorts, exposing himself completely.

‘So, you’re okay?’ Andrea was laughing.

‘Sure,’ Johan blushed like a schoolgirl, and tried not to seem as though he was in any way checking Jens out, even though it was perfectly natural to wonder what the guy about to fuck your girlfriend was like.

‘Great,’ Jens smiled, and didn’t really need to ask the obvious: *so, what’s next?*

To Jens’s surprise, Johan stood up and signaled for Andrea to stand up, too. Then he carefully stepped behind her, pulled her briefly to him for a little kiss on her cheek, before he started to peel off Andrea’s red dress, and then her crimson lace bra, as though showing Jens what he would be getting—or as though he was offering his girlfriend as some kind of sexual sacrifice. He left Andrea’s panties on.

Smiling, a near-naked Andrea kissed her boyfriend and gave him one more ‘*are you okay?*’ expression, and Johan went to sit in the little chair over in the corner of the room by the windows.

Andrea gestured for Jens to sit on the edge of the bed furthest from Johan, as though the extra distance might make it easier for him to handle things. Then she knelt on the floor in front of him, so beautiful with barely a hint of clothing on, her nipples stiff in the air-conditioned chill.

She smiled up at Jens, silently thanking him for letting them do this. Then she took his thickening cock in one hand, and ducked down to guide his tip to her lips.

‘Mmm...’ the blonde moaned as she took him inside her hot mouth. Jens tried to remain silent, as though any noise he might make could interfere in the pleasure Johan would get from the noises Andrea made.

She brushed the hair back out of her face and started bobbing up and down on his shaft, closing her eyes to enjoy the sensation of a hard cock in her mouth, though taking occasional peeks to check that Johan was okay watching.

After a while, she gave Jens’s cock a long, slow lick from base to tip, and then looked over to her boyfriend to ask him if he was enjoying watching.

‘Yes,’ Johan said, not quite knowing what to say. ‘I’m enjoying it.’

‘You like seeing your girlfriend with another man’s cock in her mouth?’ Andrea grinned, her tone teasing Johan for apparently finding this a challenging experience, when she was the one doing all the work.

‘Uh-huh,’ Johan said.

She continued sucking on Jens for a while longer, finding it more of a thrill to gaze across at Johan as she did it, a devilish darkness in her eyes as though she was trying to find the very edge of Johan’s tolerance.

Then she was up on her feet, urging Jens to lie down on the bed.

‘Are you ready for this?’ she asked Johan, who seemed delighted, if not somewhat astonished by it all, and then she stooped to peel off her panties. She threw her underwear at her boyfriend, and then climbed up onto the bed to straddle Jens.

Lying underneath her, Jens slid down the mattress until his head was between her thighs, so that instead of taking her straight away on his cock, he could pleasure her a while with his mouth.

He couldn’t see how Johan was taking this, but the way Andrea was twisting her body made it clear that she kept turning to look at her boyfriend over her shoulder. Jens enjoyed Andrea’s clean, subtle flavor, lapping at her beautiful pussy as he held her hips. With touches on her hips, he encouraged her to take the lead in taking from his mouth exactly what she wanted. But after a while, the blonde lifted off, turned around, and lay back over Jens with her sex over his mouth, while her own hands and mouth went to Jens’s cock.

She was performing for her boyfriend, that was clear enough. It felt good for Jens, although he couldn’t quite hear what Andrea was saying to Johan each time she broke off from sucking on Jens’s cock.

When the blonde finally lifted off again, Jens looked across the room to see that Johan had finally given in to temptation. He had his jeans undone and pushed a little way down his thighs, his dick hard and clutched in one hand. The guy had an absolutely huge cock, Jens was mildly startled by it, and he’d seen some big ones.

‘You’re so *hard*, Jo-honey,’ Andrea said, slowly pumping Jens’s cock in one hand, gazing across the room at her boyfriend with clear delight on her flushed, sweat-shiny face.

‘Are you going to fuck him?’ Johan asked her, and both he and Andrea seemed suddenly surprised that they had reached this point, and that they were really going through with it.

‘You want me to?’

Johan was up on his feet, reaching into his jeans pocket. Pulling something out. A condom. He tore open the little packet, and then handed the thing to the blonde. Andrea slipped it onto Jens's shaft, and then climbed onto him, facing away from him, toward her boyfriend as she directed the tip of his cock to her pussy.

She moaned as she sank down on his full length. Jens thrust his hips up to drive his cock deep into her.

'Oh my God...' she gasped, and slowly started to ride Jens, reverse-cowgirl style, gazing at her boyfriend as she moved.

Jens moaned at the feeling of her riding him, but though it felt good, he also felt a hint of envy for the connection between Andrea and her boyfriend. Johan had taken his shirt off, and was fairly openly pumping his cock as he watched his girlfriend fucking Jens.

Jens was happy for them. They both seemed seriously into it. But it made him imagine himself sitting there in Johan's place. And when he imagined himself sitting there in Johan's place, he went ahead and imagined it was Effie here on the bed, riding some other guy. Emil, perhaps. Perhaps somebody else.

Andrea disengaged and went down on all fours, facing Johan as she offered herself to Jens again. He lined up behind her and slid his cock back inside her slippery sex, holding her hips as he thrust into her again and again.

'Oh God it feels good, Jo-honey...' she moaned.

Johan was totally absorbed in watching his girlfriend being fucked, doggy style. But after a while, Jens noticed Andrea exchanging silent signals with him, debating something but without words, and then Johan plucked up the courage to dispense with his jeans entirely, and step on up to offer Andrea his cock while Jens continued to take her from behind.

Jens was happy enough to be directed, and as Andrea's climax approached, Johan was the one sliding his cock into her pussy, with Jens

giving her something to suck on, something to hold while her boyfriend did the final honors.

Afterwards, as the pretty blonde mopped his come from her face with a clean towel, Jens offered them dinner. However, the two of them seemed eager to head back up to Andrea's apartment, to work out their perspectives on their new sexual experience between themselves.

‘And you felt *envy* toward them?’ the therapist asked.

‘That’s what it felt like,’ Jens said.

‘You mean that you wanted Andrea for yourself?’

He shook his head. Outside, he could see through the window that a storm was brewing over the city. ‘No, I didn’t feel I wanted her. I wanted to be them. I still felt like I wanted Effie, but also...’

‘You envy them because they have youth on their side,’ she said. ‘And because it’s all new to them.’

Jens laughed. ‘Well, I suppose so. They’re not that much younger than Effie and I... I think it’s also the fact that things seem so much less complicated for them.’

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A WHOLE NEW WORLD

Something changed in Emil and Effie's relationship. It was clear to Jens, during one of the rarer occasions he got to see his wife, that Emil was becoming more and more possessive of her. Ever since the family reunion, when Jens had been around Effie like an old friend, Emil had demanded that Effie stop seeing him at all. No coffees, no lunches, nothing. Not even Facebook buddies.

That was quite hard to take. But there was something else that cropped up that made it all so much worse.

When Effie went around to his apartment in lieu of a girls' night out, and revealed Emil's new attitude to Jens, and she seemed completely torn. She did care about Emil, maybe even loved him, and wasn't ready to give him up.

'But you're married to me,' Jens said, feeling hurt that he even had to raise the issue. Feeling even worse that, perhaps, a major argument was on the way.

'I know, I know,' she said. 'I love you. I could never love anyone as much as I love you.'

'Then surely it's time to move on, right?'

She was in tears. Jens was surprised that she felt this strongly about Emil, even if he had been her first love, and she'd known him most of her

life. Maybe he'd been wrong about all this. Letting it go on for so long. The trouble was, he'd felt *safe*. He'd felt as though she was really only with the guy for the sex.

'I'm pregnant,' she said.

Jens felt his stomach implode.

'You're... you're sure?' he asked her after a long hesitation.

She nodded. 'I was late. Three weeks late. So I took the test... it was positive.'

Jens sighed. 'And you don't know who...'

She shook her head. 'I was on birth control,' she said, 'It shouldn't have happened anyway.'

And he was trying to remember what they said about the pill, in terms of its percentage effectiveness. It wasn't 100%, certainly. Later, when he looked it up, an authoritative source suggested that when perfectly used, one in 100 women would still get pregnant when using the pill. Typical use saw that rise to nine in 100 women. A lot higher chance than of winning the lottery.

They just hugged when she revealed that news, they didn't make love.

Eventually, he put the question to her: 'Do you know what you want to do with it?'

She was a little angry and upset, because it shouldn't have been just her having to make such a major decision—and yet Jens didn't feel he had the right to make any kind of decisions, either. He might not even have been the father.

'If it was yours...' she said, 'What would you say?'

Jens thought about the whole issue of raising a baby. He had little idea what it would involve, but he felt that skin-crawling, heart-stopping certainty that it would make a mockery of his clean, tidy, well-ordered lifestyle. Could he even handle all the mess, the poop, the vomit... everything so gross?

And yet, a baby. So special. Jens didn't feel they had the right to get rid of a baby if they had the financial means to support it.

'I would say I'd support whatever your decision was,' he said, 'but I'd... well... I'd probably say we were in a good position... financially... to raise a child...'

She smiled at him, and he thought he saw in her eyes a strong, but downplayed, desire to have this baby.

'What if the baby is Emil's?'

Effie sighed. 'Of course, as far as he is concerned, there shouldn't even be a question about whose it is. He doesn't know I've been sleeping with you as well. Perhaps that was my biggest mistake, not telling him.'

Jens shrugged. 'As far as he was concerned, he started all this by stealing you from me. You don't need to feel bad about not telling him anything.'

Effie said, 'If it's his... and he wants to raise it...'

Jens swallowed, and felt the ground opening up underneath him. 'Then perhaps it would be easier to be with him, and not me,' he said.

Effie looked shocked.

Jens said, 'You know—if you love him. And he loves you. And you'd enjoy being together. It would mean a stable home for your child.'

'And, what, we'd never tell Emil I was sleeping with you at the same time?'

Jens felt awful. Worse than he ever had. 'We wouldn't have to, would we?'

She said, 'You could take that job in Milan. With Gucci.' But she seemed sad about it.

'I could.'

'It would be so amazing.'

They showered together, but nothing happened. It was intimate, and yet not sexual. There was a lot of crying. For the first time, it felt to Jens like

things really could end—just like that. Their marriage would actually be dissolved. If the baby was Emil's, then she would be with him for the rest of her life.

Of course if the baby was Jens's, then Effie might decide to spend the rest of her life with Jens—and he would have to deal with the horrific prospect of having to care for a dirty, demanding, loud, mess of a tiny person, when his whole body screamed about the germs involved, the diseases he might catch, the dangers it all posed. And yet, much to his surprise, that seemed like the preferable fate than to lose Effie and the baby to Emil.

Later, Effie was dressing and Jens was sitting on his bed in a pair of sweatpants.

She said, 'What if it was his... and I didn't want to tell him it was his?'

Jens sighed. 'Would that be right to do that to him?' he said.

'Would you help me with the baby if... if we knew for certain it was Emil's?' she said. 'I mean... maybe I tell him it's his, and he says he doesn't want a baby in his life.'

'Of course. If you wanted me to.' She smiled so brightly as he said that, and yet he was clearly troubled at hiding things from Emil in such an eventuality.

They had to wait until the pregnancy reached 10 weeks to carry out a paternity test, but what immediately became clear to Jens in the meantime was how much happier Effie was, to settle the main question as to whether or not she would have the baby at all.

Having decided to bring the baby into the world, no matter who the father was, seemed to take a huge amount of stress off her shoulders. Even if she had to keep the fact that she was pregnant secret from Emil.

She was all smiles when she came to visit Jens on her regular ‘girls’ night out’ or ‘drinks after work’, as though only with him could she fully relax and be herself.

‘Do you still love me?’ she said, one night as she stood naked in front of the mirror trying to see whether her bump was showing yet, even though it probably wouldn’t until she was 12 to 16 weeks along.

‘Of course,’ he said, lying on the bed, enjoying the sight of her examining herself.

‘Even though I might have someone else’s baby inside me?’

‘Of course.’

‘Would you still think I’m sexy?’

‘Without a doubt.’

‘Even when I get huge?’

‘Even when you are huge,’ he laughed. ‘Although, maybe you’d have to stop sitting on my face if you get *too* huge.’

‘And how huge is *too* huge?’

‘I don’t know.’

‘I’d better make the most of it, then, before I get too huge,’ she giggled, and wiggled her butt as some kind of invitation. He turned around and dutifully slid his head in between her thighs so that she could drop her sex down onto his eager lips.

She seemed sad when the evening came to an end and she had to return to her life with Emil.

‘Isn’t it time to call an end to the affair when it becomes the part of life you want to escape from?’ he asked her at last, after seeing her reaction to leaving him so many times.

She sighed. ‘But *you’re* the affair now, darling,’ she said.

‘Then leave your boyfriend... and we’ll elope,’ Jens said.

Effie smiled. Kissed him.

What frightened him, when the door closed, was the prospect that the baby was Emil's, and that Emil wanted the baby. Emil wanted a family with Effie. It would be like cutting the last ties she had with Jens. How could she leave Emil if he wanted to raise the child with her?

And yet it was Jens to whom Effie went to when 10 weeks arrived, and it was time to visit the clinic. She still hadn't told Emil a thing.

It was a private clinic, in the center of town not too far from the royal palace of Amalienborg. It was discreet enough, though as they were shown through to the waiting room, there were quite a few other couples there, and some single women. Were they all here for paternity tests? Jens glanced around at some of the posters on the walls, and some of the literature lying around, and figured some of those in the room were here for fertility treatment—perhaps the older couples.

Everyone seemed to have a vaguely nervous expression on their face.

Jens glanced at Effie, and she gave him a small, but nervous, smile of reassurance—and of gratitude, that he was there with her. Could the others in the waiting room guess that he and Effie were there for a paternity test? That she slept with enough people for there to be doubt as to the father of her baby... there had to be a certain amount of shame attached to this kind of visit ordinarily. But Jens felt a strange kind of thrill at the possibility that people might look at Effie and guess that she was seeing more than one guy at a time.

Jens got the feeling that he wasn't reacting to all this as a 'normal' man might. Here he was thinking how sexy Effie was, because she was clearly so sexually active, and maybe people would think her promiscuous.

When somebody else coughed, it reminded Jens that he was sitting in a room almost full of strangers. Strangers with their own concealed germs.

Coughing and sneezing and spreading their diseases through shared magazines and newspapers, leaflets about the various treatments on offer at the clinic.

And he wasn't freaking out at all!

It was a good sign. But he did have to return his thoughts to the fact that Effie was pregnant, and that it was strangely sexy to think of her that way. She was fertile, giving life, a new mother.

Thinking of how much he wanted her was a good distraction against the dark thoughts of his obsessive-compulsive disorder. For him, it really was the best. Without it, there was no way he would have been able to sit through twenty minutes in that waiting room.

Then they went through to a doctor's office where a pleasant grey-haired woman drew blood from Effie and took a DNA sample from the inside of Jens's cheeks.

'When will we get the results back?' Effie asked the doctor.

'With this kind of test, usually we get the results back in about 10-14 days,' the doctor said.

Then they were back on the street, with nothing to do but wait.

'What do you want to do?' Effie asked him.

They'd both taken the whole day off from work for the paternity test, and now they had all afternoon free.

'Would you think me strange if I said I wanted to go home and make love to you right now?' he told her earnestly.

Effie broke out into the giggles. 'Seriously?'

But when they got back to the apartment in Østerbro, she didn't feel the need to question him as to why he would feel so horny after a visit to a clinic for a paternity test. She just helped him tear off their clothes and fall into bed together for the rest of the afternoon.

For two weeks, every time Effie visited, Jens would think about the possibility that she would have a baby with another man. It wasn't the fact that she was having a baby that drove him wild—it was the fact that they didn't know whose it was. That she was in this position in the first place.

‘What if you don't tell me the results of the test?’ he said one evening in the shower after another tumble between the sheets.

‘If I don't tell you?’

Jens shrugged. ‘You know, until the baby comes. Then you could tell me.’

‘Why?’

‘I don't know. I like the uncertainty,’ he said.

She giggled. ‘You get horny because my pregnancy could be proof that I cheat on you?’

‘You have a problem with that?’

‘If it ends up with you encouraging me to get pregnant with other guys, then yes.’

‘I'd never want that,’ he said. ‘But for now... you're just so sexy like this...’

She smiled, and her hand naturally moved to his crotch, where she found him thickening yet again. That made her laugh, too. ‘But you know, if the baby's yours, you'd know because I'd have to tell Emil—and he'd probably want to end our relationship, don't you think?’

Jens shrugged. ‘Maybe. Maybe not. You don't have to tell me what happens with Emil.’

‘If I broke up with him, you don't think I'd move straight back in with you?’

‘Hussy,’ Jens joked. ‘Or you could move in with one of your other friends, temporarily.’

She gently stroked his hardness. ‘If it's Emil's...’

‘If it’s Emil’s, you don’t have to tell me, either,’ he said. ‘We just go on seeing each other... from time to time. As long as you wanted.’

She sighed. ‘You could go on believing it might be yours... but the day would come when I’d have to tell you.’

‘I suppose so.’

‘When the baby comes... I can only have one birth partner at the hospital.’

And, Jens thought, the question would become: could the prolonged good sex distract from the potential pain that Effie was going to have a family with someone else, and that he would have lost her, perhaps forever?

Just how long could Effie’s sexy promiscuity distract him from life’s pains? And was that all it was? A distraction?

Was real life passing him by while he was overly focused on sharing Effie?

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TRUTH

They were swimming. Since Effie's bump began to show, she'd taken more and more to the pool when she went round to see Jens. And recently, date night with Jens had expanded to three nights a week. He wasn't complaining. He didn't ask about how Emil was taking it, that she was spending more evenings out each week, but then he didn't ask about how Emil was responding as her pregnancy became more and more obvious.

Jens didn't ask about Emil at all, and more and more he knew it was because he was afraid about what would happen when Effie finally confirmed that the baby was Emil's. Effie was respecting Jens's wishes, though she often reminded him that at some stage, she would have to tell him.

Tonight, Effie was looking gorgeous in a one-piece swimsuit that was mostly black, but with the top part pink, so that it looked almost as though she was wearing a sports bra over a bodysuit. They were swimming lengths, but every time Jens passed her, he couldn't help but stop her for a long kiss.

It was nice, fun. They were both disappointed when they heard the doors to the pool area open, and shut, with the sound of voices instantly revealing that other people were coming in to use the pool, too.

‘You want to go downstairs?’ Effie whispered to Jens as they convened in the middle of the pool.

‘Of course.’

Jens felt his cock thickening. His wife was so horny these days—she said it was because of the way the change in her hormones was affecting her. They hadn’t been swimming for long, but as soon as they were in the privacy of Jens’s apartment, chances were she’d want to jump her husband.

Then, they were swimming slowly toward the edge of the pool nearest the changing rooms, when out of the female changing room came Andrea, wearing a blue two-piece swimsuit that wasn’t quite a bikini.

‘Oh, hey, Roomie!’ the blonde said, delighted to see Effie down in the water.

Effie gave Andrea a sharp look, and Jens was instantly suspicious.

‘Roomie?’ he said.

‘Oh, I’m so sorry,’ Andrea clasped a hand across her mouth with real regret.

Effie sighed. ‘It’s not your fault,’ she said, then turned to Jens. ‘You see? I told you it would come out soon enough. It’s a difficult thing to hide.’

‘Wait,’ Jens said, his heart beating at a thousand times per minute. ‘Just... wait. Why did you call her ‘Roomie’?’ Then, before either of the women got a chance to answer, Jens worked through his new information logically. He asked Effie, ‘You moved in with *Andrea*?’

Effie gripped the tiled edge and moved back and forth as though doing pushups against the side of the pool. ‘I *like* her,’ she said. ‘And I know I like her apartment because it’s the same as yours, virtually. *Ours*,’ she corrected herself. ‘And she has access to the pool...’

Andrea had taken a step back, and was holding her hands innocently behind her back as though hoping Effie would quietly forget that she’d let the secret slip.

‘So Emil... kicked you out?’ Jens said, and suddenly he felt a rush of warmth and hope—could it be true that this was because *he* was the father?

‘I walked,’ Effie said. ‘We had a fight...’

Jens felt the fear taking hold again. If she’d had a fight with Emil, it might still mean the baby was Emil’s. Had he told Effie to get rid of the baby? Had he refused to be a parent to the child if she kept it?

What if it was Emil’s baby, but Effie wanted Jens to be an adoptive father? That would be okay, wouldn’t it? The important thing was that Effie and the baby would be with him, they would be starting a family together...

At that moment, though, before Effie could say any more, someone else came out of the men’s changing room. Johan.

‘Oh, hey, cutie-pie,’ Andrea said to him with a big grin, moving over to take his arm. ‘Why don’t we go... to the other end of the pool for a little while, huh? Give these guys a little space...’

Once they were a few yards away, Jens prompted Effie: ‘You had a fight?’

Effie shrugged. ‘He said I was fat,’ she said.

‘He said you were *fat*?’

She made a melodramatically fake grumpy face, and then smiled broadly. ‘I thought I’d been doing pretty well hiding the bump from him,’ she said. ‘But... you know... clever lingerie only works so long.’

‘You told him you were pregnant, though, right?’

She shrugged, then shook her head. ‘I told him I was stressed at work. And... you know... I *have* been working late nights at least three times per week...’

‘You’ve been telling him you’ve been working in the office for *all* our nights together?’

‘He’s less suspicious about me working late at the office than going out with friends,’ she said. ‘So... I guess he figured I’ve been stress-eating, you know, eating a lot of crap. And he told me I’m *fat*.’

She pulled herself up, out of the pool, to sit on the edge above him as though to show him she wasn't really overweight.

'When were you going to tell him about the baby?' Jens asked her, feeling another wave of anxiety surging up his shoreline again.

'I guess... I would have had to tell him about now, anyway. I mean, I can't really hide this, can I? Not when I'm in bed with him.'

'But you'd be able to tell him if the baby was his, wouldn't you?' he said, then reasoned: '...Unless you had a feeling he'd want you to... get rid of it.'

'If it was his, I could have told him ages ago. When we had the test results back,' she said.

Jens felt his anxiety turn to out-and-out surprise. Maybe even shock. Had she just said what he thought she'd said?

He hesitated, not knowing what to say, not knowing what to ask. Would she think him stupid if he needed more clarification as to what she meant?

'It's *yours*, sweetie,' she said, the widest of smiles spreading across her pretty face, her white teeth, her bright eyes seeming to light up this end of the pool area.

Jens felt shock explode inside his chest. 'Mine?'

He laughed, and then he laughed some more, and whooped, and shouted, and cheered.

And cried a little, perhaps.

Effie slid back into the pool to wrap her arms around him and kiss him long and deep.

'I can't believe it,' he said.

She said, 'I don't think I would have been able to keep this a secret much longer, even if Andrea hadn't just let it slip...'

'You're *living* with her?' he asked her again.

Effie shrugged, 'Well, I guess now there's no point. I might as well just move back in with you, my sweet.'

‘Uh... Of *course*.’

By this stage, Andrea and Johan had swum back down to join them, to find out what all the clamor was about.

‘You told him?’ the blonde asked Effie.

‘I told him!’

‘Isn’t it great?’ Andrea asked Jens. Then she said, ‘You know, even if it wasn’t yours, she wouldn’t have wanted to stay with Emil much longer.’

‘No?’

‘I think she’s had enough of him,’ Andrea said.

‘Yeah, toward the end it seemed like we never had anything to talk about,’ Effie said.

‘Then why did you stay with him so long?’ Jens asked.

‘Did I ever tell you he has a *really* big cock?’ she laughed. ‘I’m going to really miss it.’

Jens said, ‘I know someone else who has a really big cock...’

Standing behind Andrea, Johan looked suddenly very self-conscious, and blushed furiously.

But his girlfriend, who wasn’t nearly so bashful, squealed, ‘Johan!’ Then she added, ‘Come on—let’s go downstairs and you can try it out.’

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EPILOGUE

The simple fact was that when Noah came along—and even in the months before he came along—neither of them had a hint of spare time or energy to devote to sexual thoughts.

There was so much to do, so much to learn.

For Jens, who had for so long isolated himself from society, for fear of the germs people carried, now had to face the full horror of *the diaper change*. He wasn't going to shirk his responsibilities, but when it came to his turn to do the honors, he dressed up in a waterproof poncho that made him look as though he was about to go on a trip on the *Maid of the Mist* under Niagara Falls. He wore gloves, a face mask. He used about two tonnes of wet wipes each time, triple-bagging everything.

He had Effie giggling at his over-the-top approach to keeping baby clean, but she was at least impressed that he even contributed. Both of them grew up with fathers who had kept firmly out of the diaper-changing type activities, for little reason except that their gender was treated very differently in those days.

When he held Noah in his arms, there was a constant threat of leakage from one direction or another. Poop shooting straight up the back of his diaper, pee sneaking out the sides. And there was never any guarantee of

protection from all the puking, although it was quaintly called ‘spitting up’ so as to not sound as bad.

If the whole adventure of Effie sleeping with other men hadn’t pulled Jens clear of his fear of germs, then the arrival of the baby did the rest of the hard work.

In the beginning, when the baby had to be fed every two hours or so, including through the night, they also had to cope with the complete obliteration of their sleep schedules. They thought they had it bad in the beginning, when at least the baby was sleeping 16 hours or so per day, and the two of them could snatch some sleep themselves. Later, Noah was sleeping less and less during the day, but still waking up several times at night demanding food.

Jens thought he was just about coping, but it was tougher on Effie, who was usually better able to comfort and quieten Noah because she was his mother—and so she would be called on more often than Jens to do so. And there was the fact that even if Jens was going to do a lengthy night shift, Effie would have to express the milk to enable him to do all that feeding himself—and that was tiresome in itself.

Effie had maternity leave for the first 14 weeks, and Jens took paternity leave for the first two weeks as well. Then, after 14 weeks, the two of them were able to divide up the rest of the year’s designated parental leave. But it still left Effie, in particular, completely exhausted.

After a while, they realized that even when Jens was on night duty, sleeping next to the baby monitor, ready to wake and get into feeding mode as soon as the baby started crying, Effie was woken by the baby’s crying nevertheless.

The sound of Noah’s crying had some kind of physical effect on her. She simply could not sleep any lengths of time around the baby.

When Noah got to about six months old, Effie was going crazy. She was very emotional, and often very depressed, constantly certain she was doing

everything wrong, and that she was a terrible mother. It took Jens a little while to connect her state to the severe lack of sleep that had been building and building.

His solution was elegant enough. For two nights each week—a Monday night and a Friday night—they would put Effie up in a nice hotel room to get some serious, solid, right-through-the-night sleep. Effie complained, to start with, that she felt vulnerable, not knowing what was going on with Noah every minute of every day and night. But Jens was turning into a fine father, and after a while, her fears subsided.

Meanwhile, that dose of unrestricted sleep twice a week had untold benefits on her, across the entire week. She was sharper, happier, and more stable in her dealings with everybody. Even when Noah's sleep patterns changed again, and made things a little easier to bear for everybody, they kept to having Effie stay at the Admiral Hotel for one night each week, giving her a nice, regular recharge to look forward to all the time.

Then one Saturday morning, when Jens and Noah came by to collect Effie from her usual weekly recharge session, she climbed into the car only to report to her husband: 'A guy at the bar last night was hitting on me. You know that?'

Jens had been instantly hard at that little nugget of news, a little surprised at the glint in his wife's eye when she told him that particular information.

She was interested in a little fun during her hotel stays?

'Well, you have a hotel room all to yourself every Friday,' he'd said to her. 'No reason why you couldn't make use of it. As long as you get a decent amount of sleep that night.'

'And you'd be okay with me doing that?' she'd asked.

'As long as you're doing it safely,' he said.

'Of course,' she'd grinned.

To start with, she only spent her evenings flirting with guys in the hotel bar. But later, as her confidence grew once more, she felt open to more. They arranged for Effie's parents to visit Copenhagen to take care of Noah for a weekend. Jens arrived at the hotel on Saturday morning ready to collect Effie, and found her in bed with a young gentleman.

'Who are you?'

'Who am I? *I'm her husband!* Who are you?'

The guy had grabbed his clothes and scurried out of the room, as fast as an antelope with a cheetah on its tail. Effie pulled off the bedsheet to reveal herself, naked other than a pair of little black lace panties and thigh-high black stockings.

'Are you mad at me, honey?' she asked, a wry smile spreading across her pretty face.

'Mad at you?'

'Yeah, you know. For *cheating on you.*' She stood up at the end of the bed, her hair messed up, her makeup smeared. Just as he liked it.

'Why would I be mad at you for that?' he grinned as he approached her, breathing in deeply to savor the smell of adultery that hung heavy in the air.

He pushed her gently so that she sat down on the bed, and knelt before her, parting her legs with his strong hands.

'My,' she said, delight plastered all over her face.

'He fucked you?' he asked her, ducking down to breathe the wicked scent from her lace-covered sex.

'A few times,' she said, catching her breath as he nudged aside her panties with his nose and pressed his tongue against her beautifully wet pussy.

'You... were careful?'

She smiled. 'We used protection, sure,' she said, tugging her panties out of his way. 'Along with my birth control. I guess I'm more careful now.'

It had been a long time since they'd done this. They'd spent so much effort on Noah's care that it almost seemed like another life when they'd enjoyed Effie's adultery like this. This was a brand new couple getting to experience the delights of consensual infidelity. The secret sex. The new relationship energy. The hot date. The reclamation. The traces of another man on your wife.

'Where did he come?'

'On my tits.'

Slipping her hard nipple into his mouth then, feeling so filthy to be taking his wife back like this, so soon after kicking out her date. Making her come with his mouth, and then turning her over to slide his big, hard cock into her from behind. Mating with her like the alpha-male of the herd taking back the female after her dalliance with a beta-male.

Feeling her so wet after her full night's adulterous sex.

Having her ride him, like she'd ridden her date, in just the way that had made her come with the other guy.

'Are you going to see him again?'

'Maybe,' she'd said, her skin glowing with perspiration. 'He did say he was a regular visitor in Copenhagen.'

For now, Jens was the only person allowed to come inside her. At least while they were talking about giving Noah a little brother or sister.

Jens lay back on the bed afterward, while Effie tried to grab a little more sleep. A smile spread across his face. To have a family of his own. And a sexy, naughty wife. It was like having his cake and eating it, too.

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